

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Oil-sensitive stocks** took a hit before recovering some ground as Brent fell off the day's highs to close at \$97.92 a barrel. Indexes fell, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq shedding 0.6%, 1.2% and 0.3%, respectively. **A1**

◆ **Meta Platforms** unveiled a new personal AI agent that can buy goods online, respond to emails and complete other tasks users authorize it to do for them. **B1**

◆ **Robinhood** will add Crypto.com's yes-or-no contracts to its trading platform and take minority stakes in the digital-currency exchange and its prediction-markets business. **B1**

◆ **GameStop** reported higher profit in its latest quarter, boosted by an increase in collectibles sales, and raised its full-year outlook. **B3**

◆ **Verizon and Corning** reached a multibillion-dollar agreement to deploy more than 80 million miles of high-density optical fiber across the U.S. over the next five years. **B4**

◆ **The U.S. government** will take minority equity stakes in D-Wave, Rigetti and Quantinuum in a combined \$300 million deal to underwrite their quantum-computing research. **B4**

◆ **AstraZeneca** said its new drug for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease showed benefits across a broad patient population in late-stage clinical trials, boosting a medicine the company expects to generate multibillion-dollar sales. **B5**

◆ **Boston Scientific** said it likely won't meet its financial guidance due to the cyberattack that has disrupted its operations. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **The U.S. destroyed** five Iranian oil tankers in response to recent attempts by Tehran to strike U.S. warships in the Middle East, Central Command said. **A8**

◆ **Iran-backed Houthi** militants in Yemen fired drones and missiles at several Saudi energy facilities. **A8**

◆ **The U.K., France,** Canada and nine other countries said they would impose new trade restrictions on Israel over the expansion of Israeli settlements in the West Bank. **A1**

◆ **Some state lawmakers** want to repeal sales-tax exemptions formerly granted to tech companies for data-center gear and renegotiate deals. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** appealed to the Supreme Court for its blessing to deploy an immigration database it says could be used to identify people improperly registered to vote. **A3**

◆ **The Supreme Court** declined to let Missouri use a congressional map in the mid-terms that the state GOP redrew to benefit Republicans, while a federal judge in another case issued a temporary order restoring the map. **A6**

◆ **Trump signed orders** to ban the importation of many dairy products, alcoholic beverages and motorcycles from Canada in three weeks. **A2**

◆ **Two systems** that could have slowed an Amazon Air flight that crashed in Miami weren't deployed before the plane careened off the runway and into nearby vehicles, investigators said. **A6**

◆ **Smithsonian Secretary** Lonnie Bunch III resigned. **A3**

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Thieves Loot Renoirs From French Museum



CLOCKWISE: CYRIL DODEIGN/YMAXAPP/ZUMA PRESS, MUSEE RENOIR/REUTERS (2)



HEIST: Four paintings were stolen Tuesday from the Renoir Museum on the Riviera. 'Young Woman at the Well,' top, and 'Madame Colonna Romano,' above, are still missing. The bandits left two others behind. **A9**

Economic Data Show Growth, But Consumers Are Still Glum

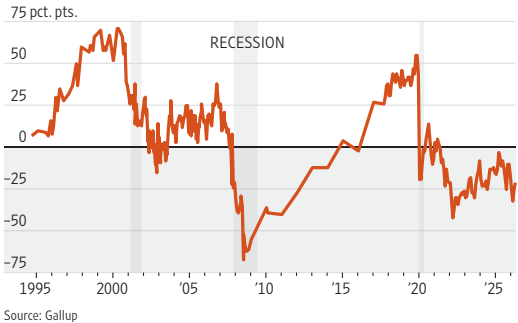
Market strength, low unemployment fail to lift a sour mood as costs keep rising

By JUSTIN LAHART

The U.S. added an impressive 162,000 jobs last month. The unemployment rate is low. The stock market and artificial intelligence are making many people rich and boosting retirement savings. Yet surveys tell us Americans are still in a funk.

Their sour mood doesn't match up with what major indicators say about how the U.S. economy is performing. That might not mean that people are lying to themselves about their experience of the economy. Instead, broad measures might be missing how much Americans' costs have risen since the pandemic, and how many of them haven't kept up. "People aren't wrong," University of Chicago economist Erik Hurst said. The University of Michigan *Please turn to page A2*

Share of people who rate economy as 'good' or 'excellent' minus 'poor'



Source: Gallup

European Nations Set Trade Bans Over the West Bank

By LAURENCE NORMAN AND ANAT PELED

The U.K., France, Canada and nine other countries said they would impose new trade restrictions on Israel, escalating a dispute over the expansion of Israeli settlements in the West Bank. Tuesday's move prompted a swift retaliation from Israel against the U.K., which was the first to announce it would halt trade with settlements in the Israeli-occupied West Bank. Israel said it would close the British consulate in East Jerusalem, which deals largely with Palestinian affairs, and expel British representatives from the U.S.-led coordination center for postwar Gaza. U.K. Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said Tuesday that the expansion of Israeli settlements was "ethnic cleansing" that was undermining the two-state solution to peace between the Israelis and the Palestinians. The sanctions, he said, would affect direct trade with the settlements, as well as the British companies that provided services to them. "The sanctions regime will target illegal settlements and settlement expansion, not Israel. We will continue to support *Please turn to page A8*

INSIDE



PEIRO SALADOLIV GOLF VIA AP

BUSINESS & FINANCE LIV Golf files for bankruptcy—and owes its star golfers millions. **B1**

Chasing Side Deals, Flexing Influence: Lewandowski at DHS

Noem's close adviser effectively controlled billions in spending; Lewandowski denies seeking business or playing role in contracts

When Corey Lewandowski was at the Department of Homeland Security, he approached senior Qatari officials with a proposal. Hire me on the side, the longtime Trump *By Tarini Parti, Josh Dawsey, Michelle Hackman and Summer Said* aide who was effectively the shadow secretary at the department last year, told them, according to people familiar with his pitch. He said he

could help the tiny, wealthy Gulf state with any issues that fell under the department's purview, such as visas, the people said. He approached representatives of the United Arab Emirates with a similar offer, people familiar with the outreach said. Some of the foreigners were taken aback and confused why they would need Lewandowski's help when they already had traditional relationships with top administration of *Please turn to page A10*

She Achieved Worldwide Fame From Inside a Cave in Santorini

Customers who visit Greek artisan's shop walk away determined to make her famous

By AKIKO MATSUDA

SANTORINI, Greece—John Volkoff spent a half-hour inside a cave here in July, with his head tilted under the ceiling and the temperature rising because his 6-foot-3 frame was blocking the air conditioner. The Oregon resident and his family were shopping during a cruise stop and Google Maps led them to an old storage space under this island's famous blue-domed church, Agios Nikolaos. The 43-square-

foot cavern was filled with colorful leather bags made by a local artisan named Iota Zaggle.

"It was hot, but that was definitely the highlight of the trip," said Volkoff, who left with a lap-top bag, a purse for his wife, and free leather keychains for his teenage daughters. "I wanted to stay there all day and talk to her more." What Volkoff didn't know was that he was in the presence of a global celebrity. *Please turn to page A13*



Leather bag lady

Data-Center Tax Breaks Get Heave-Ho in States

More than a decade ago, Ohio lawmakers exempted tech companies from sales taxes on computer servers and other equipment needed for data centers, betting that changes worth millions of dollars would lure much-needed investment to the state. *By Amrith Ramkumar, Richard Rubin and Neil Mehta* It worked, turning Ohio into one of the leading destinations for data centers. But then the artificial-intelligence boom supersized the tax exemption, pushing it to more than \$1.5 billion last year, more than 10 times the original state estimate. Voter out-

Oil Nears \$100, Threatens Stocks' Long Run

Major indexes drop and benchmark Treasury yield is highest since 2023

By JACK PITCHER AND REBECCA FENG

Oil soared above \$99 a barrel on Tuesday before re-treating, marking its highest level since July and making it increasingly difficult for investors to move on from the U.S.'s continuing war with Iran. Brent crude, the international oil benchmark, is up around 35% from this summer's lows. Oil's rebound toward the year's highs is already showing up in domestic gasoline prices. For Free Papers Check softarchive.is That has hit consumer discretionary stocks sharply over the past month as well as industrial companies which count oil as a key input cost.

The expected impact on inflation has also sent Treasury yields higher, another challenge for stocks. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to 4.805% Tuesday, its highest closing level since October 2023. Yields, which rise when bond prices fall, impact borrowing costs for companies and can make riskier assets like stocks look less attractive when they are elevated. "Progress on inflation is poised to reverse if geopolitical tensions don't simmer," said José Torres, senior economist at Interactive Brokers. Oil-sensitive stocks took a hit Tuesday before recovering some ground as Brent fell off the day's highs to close at \$97.92 a barrel. The Dow Jones Industrial Average shed 1.2%, or about 628 points, dragged down by Amgen. The biotechnology *Please turn to page A9*

◆ **Yemeni rebels hit facilities** in Saudi Arabia..... **A8** ◆ **U.S. strikes Iran tankers** after Navy ships targeted..... **A8**

U.S. NEWS

Trump Moves to Ban Some Canada Goods

Orders signed by the president follow Ottawa’s retaliation for U.S. tariffs

By Gavin Bade

President Trump on Tuesday signed orders to ban the importation of many dairy products, alcoholic beverages and motorcycles from Canada in three weeks—a retaliation for Canadian tariffs that took effect earlier the same day.

Trump also modified the scope of some existing 50% tariffs on Canada, removing levies on cement, road salt and some hospital products, while imposing 50% levies on other products including some all-terrain vehicles, boats and cheeses.

The tariff changes will take effect Sept. 15, according to proclamations posted on the White House website, while the trade prohibitions are set to kick in on Sept. 29.

The overall economic impact of the trade moves would initially be small. A senior Trump administration official said the new trade prohibitions would only affect a dollar volume of

trade in the “single-digit billions,” while the overall volume of Canadian exports affected by the tariffs—\$20 billion—would be unchanged after the modifications.

Even so, the effect on industries targeted by the trade prohibitions could be ruinous, should they go into effect. The senior administration official said that the U.S. trade prohibitions are justified due to province-level Canadian bans on U.S. alcohol products, but Trump’s team remains in contact with Canadian officials and there could be conversations about finding a resolution in the coming days.

In a post on X Tuesday evening, Dominic LeBlanc, Canada’s minister in charge of U.S.-Canada trade, said Canada is assessing the latest tariff measures from the U.S.

“When the US is ready to engage, our government will work in good faith and constructively towards a more secure mutually beneficial trading relationship that fully respects Canadian sovereignty,” he said.

The move represents the latest in a series of escalations in the monthslong tariff conflict

between the U.S. and Canada. Also Tuesday, Trump posted on Truth Social that he would direct the General Services Administration and U.S. Trade Representative’s office to remove Canadian firms from the agency’s “Multiple Award Schedules,” which connect federal, state and local government agencies with suppliers of a variety of products.

The U.S. moves come as retaliation for Canada imposing tariffs ranging from 15% to 50% on about \$20 billion of U.S. goods on Tuesday morning—amounting to about 6% of U.S. exports to its northern neighbor. Those tariffs covered a variety of products from electronics and appliances to dairy products, and were themselves a response for Trump’s latest round of levies, imposed in late August on \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods, or about 5% of its exports to the U.S.

The latest round of tit-for-tat tariffs was almost averted. In August, the nations appeared close to an agreement, but negotiations broke down in the final hours before a U.S.-imposed deadline, with each blaming the other for walking away from the table.

Carney Vows to Backstop Sectors Hurt in Trade War

OTTAWA—Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said his government will “do whatever it takes” to backstop regions and industrial sectors targeted by U.S. tariffs as the trade conflict between the neighboring and closely integrated economies enters a precarious stage.

In an address posted on YouTube, Carney said retaliatory tariffs on about \$20 billion in U.S. goods that kicked in on Tuesday were necessary to protect domestic sectors and workers. “I don’t believe in escalating the conflict,” he said. “The harsh reality is that the American tariffs will hurt some Canadians or others, and that was by design.”

As a result, “we will do whatever it takes for as long as it takes to bridge those people” in affected sectors “to a better future,” he said. Carney added that his Liberal government would pursue policies that



Prime Minister Mark Carney in a video address.

reduce dependence on trade with the U.S., although he warned this would present economic turbulence. “This won’t be easy, and I won’t pretend otherwise,” he said.

Canada’s tariffs of between 15% and 50% are in response to 50% duties that the Trump administration imposed last month.

—Paul Vieira

Economy, Consumer Mood Differ

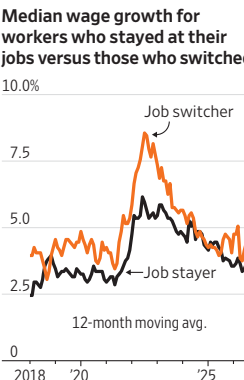
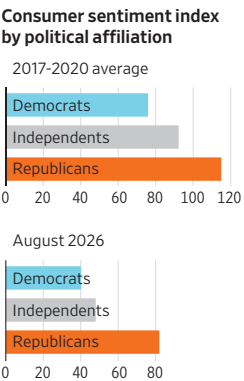
Continued from Page One

gan’s measure of consumer sentiment continues to flirt with the lowest levels in its decadeslong history. In a monthly Gallup survey, 45% of people now rate the economy poor, while a combined 19% rate it as good or excellent. A New York Fed survey has similarly glum readings. The Conference Board’s index of consumer confidence is one of the more optimistic readings—and even that is downbeat.

The economy doesn’t look like it’s booming, but it doesn’t look all that bad, either. Gross domestic product grew 2.1% over the past year. Job growth has been decent, and the unemployment rate has remained low. Inflation remains trying—consumer prices were up 3.4% on the year in July—but is much lower than in June 2022, when it hit 9.1%.

The disconnect could reflect flaws in the surveys, or in how people are assessing the economy. Some critics think a 2024 move from phone-based to online surveys by Michigan might have distorted its sentiment readings, for example. (Michigan disputes this, noting that it spent years collecting experimental data in preparation for the shift.) A more partisan environment could be polluting people’s feelings on the economy. Or people could generally be sadder than they were before the pandemic.

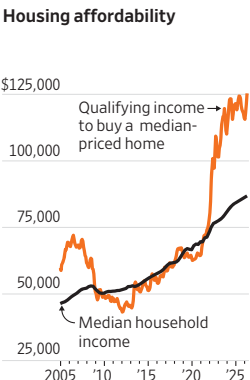
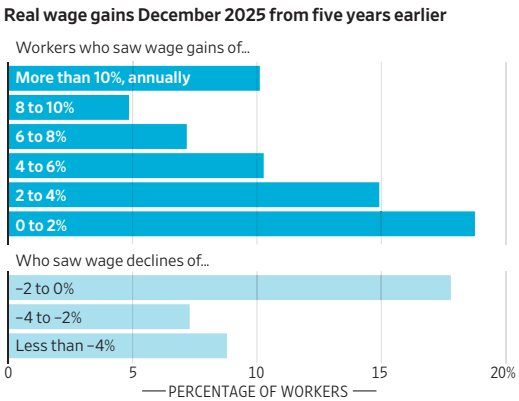
But moods look bleak regardless of the survey, while



Note: Real wages are inflation adjusted and rates shown are annualized. Qualifying income assumes mortgage and other housing payments equal to 30% of annual income. Sources: University of Michigan (sentiment); Hurst, Patterson, Richardson and Wang (real wage gains); Atlanta Fed (median wage growth, housing affordability); Federal Reserve via St. Louis Fed (credit-card plans)

political independents—who shouldn’t be so swayed by partisanship—are down on the economy. Even Republicans rate the economy as much worse than they did during President Trump’s first term.

The bigger problem could be that economic data doesn’t capture everything that is shaping people’s experience of the economy. Inflation is usually looked at by looking at the year-over-year change in



prices, but the more salient statistic for many Americans is that consumer prices are 28% higher than just before the pandemic. Plus inflation measures don’t directly cover some things that people experience as costs, such as home prices or interest rates.

Average hourly earnings figures from the Labor Department don’t entirely capture what is going on with wages, either. Adjusted for in-

flation, these are up 2.8% since before the pandemic. But recent research from Hurst with economists Christina Patterson, Nela Richardson and Liv Wang suggests that a lot of people are far short of the mark.

Using data from payroll processor ADP, the economists found that from the end of 2020 to the end of last year, 34% of workers’ wages didn’t keep up with inflation. (The

research, posted as a National Bureau of Economic Research working paper last month, hasn’t been peer reviewed.)

Moreover, for those workers whose wages didn’t keep up, the effect of rising prices was far more pernicious than it would have been in a low inflation environment, where their buying power would only gradually deteriorate. People whose wages went up very little, or not at all, lost a lot of ground. A bit more than a 10th of workers experienced inflation-adjusted wage losses in excess of 3.5%. Compounded over five years, that is more than 16%.

Circumstances probably haven’t improved since the end of last year, as the jump in gasoline prices breathed new life into inflation. In July, consumer prices were up 2.1% from their December level, while average hourly earnings were up 1.7%.

Some people’s pay has outstripped inflation handily. But many of them got raises by switching jobs, so those wage gains might not be doing much to dull frustration. Harvard University economist Stefanie Stantcheva has found that people tend to view pay increases not as adjustments their employers are making to keep up with inflation, but instead as due to their efforts at work. This is especially true of those who have switched jobs—and who might feel especially put off if the pay gains they hustled for are later eroded by inflation.

Because inflation measures also don’t include all of the costs that households face, many people might feel even further behind than they are on paper.

Mortgage rates, for example, aren’t included in the Labor Department’s consumer

price calculations, and those rates are substantially higher than before the pandemic. The average rate on a 30-year fixed mortgage reached 6.71% last week, compared with 3.51% in late January 2020 and the highest level in over a year. Home prices also aren’t included—the Labor Department calculates housing prices by calculating how much it would cost owners to rent the homes they live in rather than what those homes would cost to buy.

So inflation statistics don’t capture how far out of reach owning a home has become for many Americans. Assuming the threshold for an affordable house is for mortgage and other housing payments to be no more than 30% of income, the Atlanta Fed calculates that as of May a household would need income of \$124,674 a year to afford a median-priced home—45% more than the median household makes. At the end of 2019, payments on a median-priced home were about 3% below the 30%-of-income threshold.

Credit-card interest rates are also higher, as are rates on car loans, points out Judd Cramer, an economics lecturer at Harvard, and those aren’t in the consumer price data, either. A measure of consumer prices that took what has gone on with home prices and interest rates into account would be up by over 40% from January 2020 levels, Cramer calculates.

Bearing that in mind, it makes sense to him that surveys show that consumers are in a funk.

“Even if the measures are not as clean as we want them to be, and are certainly influenced by politics and psychology, there’s still something there,” he said.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

A chart on Tuesday with a World News article about the Russian economy showed crude oil processed by Russian refineries in millions of barrels a day. In some editions, the chart was mislabeled in billions.

A statue of former Syrian

President Hafez al-Assad was toppled in 2024, following the ouster of his son and successor, Bashar al-Assad. A photo caption with Friday’s World News article about autocrats incorrectly said Hafez al-Assad was ousted in 2024.

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Ford’s Use of Chinese Tech Is Criticized

By Ryan Felton

Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy sharply criticized **Ford Motor’s** business with Chinese automotive firms, saying the company’s “reliance on technologies of foreign adversaries” isn’t sustainable for America.

“While DOT recognizes the intense competitive pressures of the global market, the company’s recent strategic decisions paint a troubling picture of a foundational American brand actively intertwining its future with Chinese state-backed enterprises,” Duffy said in a letter to Ford Chief Executive Jim Farley made public on Tuesday.

Duffy also called the manufacturing of Lincoln vehicles in China for the U.S. market “unacceptable.” While Ford said it would reshore, or return to the U.S., production of those vehicles starting in 2030, Duffy said the years in between represent a “multiyear window of reliance on Chinese manufacturing while depriving skilled American workers of vital manufacturing jobs.”

The letter marks the latest

rebuttal of Ford’s continuing business deals with Chinese firms, which have drawn the ire of Republicans and Democrats in Congress.

Ford called Duffy’s letter a “wrongheaded attempt to capture headlines.”

“We produce more vehicles in the U.S., employ more hourly manufacturing workers and export more vehicles from the U.S. than any other automaker,” Ford said. “Had Secretary Duffy reached out before issuing his letter to the press, we would have been happy to share more details about Ford’s U.S. commitment.”

Ford said Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick in August praised the decision to move Lincoln production out of China.

Duffy singled out Ford’s arrangement to license technology from China’s CATL for battery production in Michigan, as well as a recent joint venture with Chinese automaker Geely in Europe. Ford’s plant in Spain will be used to make Geely vehicles for Europe and the two will co-develop an SUV for overseas.

Ford, like many in the U.S. auto industry, raised alarms



Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy

about the prospect of Chinese cars entering the American market. The carmaker has thrown its support behind a bill to ban China’s automakers from making or selling vehicles in the country. Still, Ford executives have said they need to prepare for that scenario, even as automakers strike deals with Chinese firms.

Ford said Tuesday that the CATL arrangement, is limited to licensing technology. “In fact, the White House itself touted [the] project just last

week in an official press release,” Ford said.

In his letter, Duffy said Farley proposed a framework to U.S. officials this year at the Detroit Auto Show to facilitate the creation of joint ventures in America with Chinese carmakers. It is the first public acknowledgment of such talks. Ford denied it proposed a joint-venture framework like Duffy described.

Ford and Geely held talks about extending the European tie-up to the U.S., The Wall Street Journal reported. Ford later denied that such discussions took place.

At the same time, Ford held talks with China’s BYD about securing batteries for future hybrid vehicles, The Wall Street Journal reported.

“When a company intentionally chooses to deepen operational dependencies on strategic competitors, it fails to act as the reliable partner the American public and this DOT require,” he said. “Attempting to navigate current circumstances in ways that could enrich those very competitors is not a sustainable strategy for the United States.”

U.S. NEWS

U.S. Presses Justices on Immigrant Data to Cull Voter Rolls

By LOUISE RADNOFSKY

The Trump administration filed an emergency appeal Tuesday that seeks the Supreme Court’s blessing to deploy a federal immigration database that it says could be used to root out people improperly registered to vote.

The effort stems from an executive order President Trump issued last year that directed the Department of Homeland Security to share information with state officials about voter eligibility and to compare states’ voter rolls with federal data.

The administration has built a verification system over the past 18 months that merged a database containing the citizenship status of immigrants along with Social Security information and other federal records.

Voting-rights groups challenged the expanded database in court, arguing it violated individuals’ privacy rights and produced inaccurate results. In June, a federal judge ruled the verification system was unlawful and ordered that it be disabled. Last week, a federal appeals court also ruled against the administration.

Solicitor General John Sauer filed the emergency request with the Supreme Court, saying the lower courts made it “harder to detect ineligible voters, undermining the integrity of federal elections and public confidence in the results of those elections.”

Trump has repeatedly claimed that vast numbers of ineligible people are registered to vote around the country, including noncitizens, fueling fears that he will question the validity of the midterm elections if Republicans lose.

State elections officials, including some Republicans, have responded that they run secure contests and actively police their own voter rolls. They say instances of noncitizens actually casting ballots have been isolated and haven’t affected the outcome of electoral contests.

New Jersey officials this summer reported that they had identified up to 6,600 noncitizens mistakenly registered to vote, up to 400 of whom may have gone on to cast ballots.

Some Republican states want to use the Trump administration’s new database to scrub their voter rolls and have been involved in separate litigation for access.

Smithsonian Secretary Steps Down

The institution and its exhibits have become a frequent target of Trump’s ire

By KELLY CROW

Smithsonian Secretary Lonnie Bunch III is stepping down following more than a year of tension with President Trump over the way U.S. history is portrayed at the world’s largest museum and research complex.

Bunch, a 73-year-old native of Belleville, N.J., said Tuesday he will retire and leave by year’s end. The Smithsonian’s governing board of regents is expected to name an acting chief to oversee its 21 museums, 20 libraries, the National Zoo and multiple scientific research centers around the world.

Bunch’s departure marks one of the highest-profile shake-ups amid Trump’s broader cultural campaign to restore more “truth” and “sanity” to the retelling of American history. Over the past year and a half, Trump has ramped up pressure on the Nation’s Attic as well as the Kennedy Center to emphasize the country’s positive contributions over its social ills—or else.

On July 4, the Trump administration issued a 162-page report denouncing the Smithsonian’s alleged “shift from history to activism” and afterward enlisted the National Park Service to post temporary signs outside a few museums on the National Mall to warn the public of “inaccurate information presented” within. On Aug. 28, the Department of Interior joined the fray, sending the Smithsonian regents a letter threatening to cut off federal agencies’ cooperation in lending artifacts and other grants to the institution unless changes were made to its leadership and exhibits.

Bunch, in an interview, said he made the call to retire in late August while he was vacationing at the beach with his family—before the Interior



Smithsonian Secretary Lonnie Bunch III, seen at the Smithsonian Castle, says he will retire and leave by year's end.

Department’s letter went out. He said he hasn’t communicated with Trump or White House officials recently, but he said they had “nothing” to do with his decision to retire. Rather, he had served nearly eight years as secretary when he initially set out to serve five, and he said it was time.

The partisan politics of the moment have taken a toll on him, though. He defended the Smithsonian’s scholarly integrity and said he will continue to “protect the importance of doing nuanced, complicated history.”

He said he is also “really close” to sending the regents the Smithsonian’s rebuttal to Trump’s opening salvo, a critical executive order report from March 2025. Bunch said his official response to the regents will “demonstrate that much of what was in the White House report was a mischaracterization of the Smithsonian and of the National Museum of American History.” He didn’t give a date for that report’s submission.

Chief Justice John Roberts, who acts as chancellor of the Smithsonian, said Bunch “has pursued excellence in the telling of our nation’s story.” Roberts added that the regents “have benefited greatly from his wisdom, vision, and leadership. We look forward to working with him in the coming months to ensure a smooth transition for his successor.”

When Bunch ascended to his top job in 2019, he was celebrated as the first African-American and first historian in the secretary role—his 13 predecessors all hailed from scientific, business or legal fields. He was best known as the founding director of the National Museum of African-American History and Culture, amassing at least 40,000 objects for it. Bunch is also credited with gathering private donations to pay for

half the museum’s \$540 million cost, with Congress fielding the rest. The museum opened in 2016 and said it has received more than 13 million visitors.

Bunch was deemed a savvy choice for secretary at the time because he was considered a Smithsonian lifer, having first joined the National Air and Space Museum in 1978 and then having served stints at the National Museum of American History through 2000.

That U.S. history museum has become a particular target of Trump’s ire, with its current director Anthea Hartig called to testify before the House’s Subcommittee on Delivering on Government Efficiency earlier this summer over allegations of wokeness.

Bunch said he spoke with Hartig several times before she testified about the “red lines

you have to defend,” including scholarly research. He also encouraged her to follow his example in seeking bipartisan support for the Smithsonian. “Would I love for this not to be a difficult time? Of course, but you play the cards dealt to you,” he said. “You’ve got to make sure that the voices that will champion the Smithsonian are heard, and I think we’ve done all that very well.”

On Aug. 31, the regents completed one of Bunch’s remaining goals by announcing that the National Museum of the American Latino will permanently move into the Smithsonian’s Arts and Industries Building rather than build on a site owned by the park service.

He is also pushing to raise more funds for the Smithsonian’s \$2.5 billion capital campaign this year even though the campaign has already crossed that bar.

“Being a kid from Jersey, I’m really good at fighting,” he said, “but I’m also good at thinking strategically.”

He was celebrated as the first African-American in the secretary role.

New Documents Detail Air-Quality Issues After 9/11

By JENNIFER CALFAS

New York City officials released a trove of documents on Tuesday detailing air-quality issues and what the city knew about the conditions around Ground Zero after the Sept. 11, 2001, attacks.

The records include about 170,000 pages of reports related to air quality and health issues

as well as the city’s response to 9/11, the city said. The disclosure of these documents follows a yearslong battle led by advocacy group 9/11 Watch, which sued for their release.

The pages were made public ahead of the 25th anniversary of 9/11. In the more than two decades since, more people died from related illnesses than those who were killed on

that day, New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani said.

“People got sick because the leaders they trusted lied and told them they were safe to breathe in toxic air,” Mamdani said at a news conference.

First responders and others who lived and worked around the World Trade Center site have suffered from respiratory illnesses and chronic condi-

tions, including cancer, as a result of their exposures to toxins after the attacks.

The documents expose how city officials knew the dangers of toxic chemicals in lower Manhattan and other areas after the towers fell despite stating that the air was safe, said Benjamin Chevat, executive director of 9/11 Health Watch.

They include an October 2001 correspondence sent to the deputy mayor at the time—called the “Harding memo”—that detailed possible lawsuits the city could face related to exposure to poor air quality and unsafe working conditions. The records include those that were stored in 68 boxes and not discovered until last year, the city said.

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U.S. NEWS

New Hampshire Voters Set High-Stakes Senate Race

Primaries clinch a matchup between Democrats’ Pappas, GOP ex-Sen. Sununu

By Ken Thomas

Democratic Rep. Chris Pappas and Republican former Sen. John E. Sununu prevailed in Tuesday’s New Hampshire Senate primary, setting up a competitive fall campaign in the battleground state.

Pappas, who has served in Congress since 2019, claimed the Democratic nomination by defeating Karishma Manzur, a medical scientist and progressive who is a member of the Democratic Socialists of America.

Pappas had 63% to 35% for Manzur, with 42% of the expected votes counted, according to the Associated Press.

Sununu, who served a term in the Senate two decades ago and is the older brother of popular ex-Gov. Chris Sununu, won the Republican nomination in a race that included former Massachusetts Sen. Scott Brown. Sununu had 69%

to Brown’s 26%, with 29% of the votes counted, according to the AP.

Democrats need a net gain of four Senate seats to reclaim a majority during President Trump’s final two years, and Republicans view the seat of retiring Democratic Sen. Jeanne Shaheen as a potential way to thwart Democrats’ takeover plans despite anti-Trump headwinds. Republicans haven’t carried a Senate race in New Hampshire since Kelly Ayotte won a seat in 2010. She is now the governor.

Pappas raised considerably more than Sununu in the run-up to the primaries, \$15.4 million to \$4.1 million, according to their campaign committees’ Federal Election Commission filings. As of Aug. 19, their war chests were more even: Pappas reported \$4.3 million in cash and Sununu \$3 million.

New Hampshire’s long history of holding the nation’s first presidential primary has brought extra attention to the race.

Pappas has collected the endorsements of potential 2028 presidential candidates, in-

cluding former Vice President Kamala Harris, former Transportation Secretary Pete Buttigieg and Sen. Mark Kelly of Arizona. Pappas and his family co-own the Puritan Backroom in Manchester, a restaurant famous for its chicken tenders and visits from presidential contenders.

Pappas has been the favorite of the party’s establishment but has tried to inject some urgency into the race, warning that New Hampshire is a “purple” state and the Senate race will be ultracompetitive in the fall. In the weeks leading up to the primary, public polling had shown Pappas’s main challenger, Manzur, a progressive first-time candidate, gaining ground.

In the Republican primary, Trump endorsed Sununu in February, calling him an “America First patriot,” and Republicans have coalesced around the former senator despite Brown’s role as an ambassador to New Zealand and Samoa in Trump’s first term.

For Trump, who has often exiled those who cross him, the endorsement represented

a pragmatic move. Shortly before the 2024 New Hampshire GOP primary, Sununu wrote an op-ed calling Trump a “loser,” writing, “If he’s our nominee, we’re going to lose, and we’re going to lose bad.”

Sununu and Brown are campaign veterans in New Hampshire and have eyed Shaheen’s seat since losing to her in successive races more than a decade ago. Sununu’s father, John H. Sununu, served as New Hampshire’s governor in the 1980s and later as White House chief of staff under President George H.W. Bush.

John E. Sununu served three terms in Congress, was elected to the Senate in 2002 and served one term before his defeat by Shaheen in 2008. His brother, Chris Sununu, was governor from 2017 to 2025.

Brown became a breakout star in 2010 when he scored a stunning victory in a Massachusetts special election to fill the Senate seat of the late Sen. Edward Kennedy. But Brown was defeated by Elizabeth Warren in a 2012 Senate race and then moved to New Hampshire.

Court Rulings Conflict Over Missouri Map

By Lydia Wheeler and Louise Radnofsky

The Supreme Court declined to let Missouri use a congressional map in the November midterm elections that the state GOP redrew to benefit Republicans, rejecting a last-ditch appeal from the state.

Justice Brett Kavanaugh, who oversees emergency litigation from the state, refused Tuesday to disturb a ruling last week from the state’s highest court that said the new map, which voters used in the primary, was invalid. The redrawn districts can’t be used unless voters approve them in a ballot referendum, the state court said.

Kavanaugh, who can rule on emergency appeals on his own or refer them to the full court, denied the state’s request without comment.

Missouri officials now face uncertainty as they prepare for a general election likely with different districts—and in some locations different candidates—than voters were expecting. But right after the Supreme Court rejected Missouri’s appeal, a federal judge in a different case issued a temporary order that restores the redrawn map, creat-

ing more confusion.

In Missouri’s emergency appeal, state Republican Attorney General Catherine Hanaway warned that there would be chaos and confusion unless the Supreme Court stepped in. She said switching congressional maps between the primary and general election would disenfranchise 1.2 million Missourians who participated in the state’s primary.

The Missouri Supreme Court “just threw those votes into the dustbin—requiring the winners of the Primary election to run in very different congressional districts,” she said.

Hanaway asked the justices to act quickly. By law, the state has to start sending absentee ballots out on Sept. 19.

Missouri’s legislature voted to redraw its congressional districts last September amid a mid-decade redistricting push across the country as Republicans and Democrats battled for control of the House of Representatives.

Missouri’s new map split Kansas City into thirds in an effort to unseat Rep. Emanuel Cleaver, a Democrat, and give Republicans an advantage in seven of the state’s eight House districts.

Risky Convention Tactic to Test Trump’s Sway

DALLAS—Republicans are putting an unpopular president at the center of their campaign to keep control of Congress.

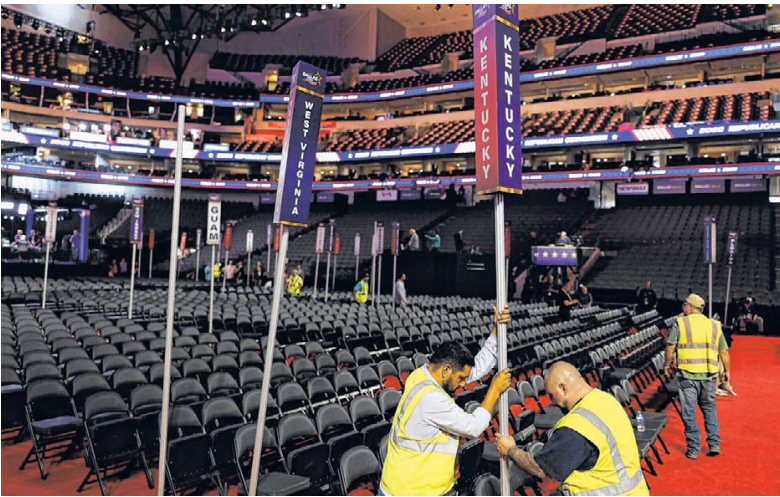
During the GOP’s convention here this week, President Trump—term-limited and facing backlash from voters—will be everywhere. Dozens of Republicans will take the stage to defend Trump’s record. The president will deliver a prime time keynote address that organizers have compared with one of Trump’s raucous rallies.

By Natalie Andrews, Alex Leary and Sabrina Rodriguez

The strategy comes with risks. Trump’s approval ratings have steadily declined in his second term, including among the independent voters who Republicans need if they are going to hold on to their majorities in the House and Senate.

In polls, voters signaled skepticism of Trump’s policies, opposing the war in Iran and expressing frustration with high gasoline and food prices.

“There’s no question the president is uniquely motivating for MAGA voters but MAGA voters aren’t sufficient to win in swing districts or states,” said Republican pollster Whit Ayres. “Nationalizing an election does not make sense when the president is at



Signs with names of the states were set up Tuesday for the GOP midterm convention in Dallas.

38% job approval.”

The president and senior advisers say Trump remains the party’s most dynamic figure, uniquely capable of energizing Republicans, raising money and marshaling the attention of voters. Trump is making the midterms a referendum on his second term, asking voters to pretend that he is on the ballot.

“No matter what the polls are saying, whenever President Trump speaks, he has a way of making magic happen with the

Republican base,” said Vanessa Santos, a publicist who represents conservatives.

Republicans are planning to use the convention to sell voters on their agenda—expect speeches focused on prescription drug prices, the economy and public safety—and boost the profile of candidates in competitive races in states such as Texas and Michigan.

While many Republican candidates are still closely aligning themselves with Trump—running ads featuring

the president and crediting him for policy wins—some donors and GOP lawmakers are skipping the convention. Some candidates said they need to be in their home states to campaign with less than two months before the election.

Trump is planning to appear at the convention on Wednesday and Thursday nights. Vice President JD Vance and several cabinet secretaries—including Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Attorney General Todd Blanche and Health Secretary

Robert F. Kennedy Jr.—have high-profile speaking slots. The president’s son, Donald Trump Jr., is expected to speak.

Several Republican congressional leaders will be featured at the convention. But Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.), who has drawn the president’s ire for not passing voter-eligibility legislation, isn’t speaking, a person familiar with the matter said.

“President Trump is the unequivocal leader of the Republican Party who is committed to maintaining Republicans’ majority in Congress,” White House spokeswoman Olivia Wales said.

Political conventions usually only take place during presidential election years.

Democrats considered hosting a midterm convention this year, but backed off the idea. But Trump was intrigued by the prospect of hosting a glitzy event, and pressed the party to make it happen. Republicans involved in the planning said.

“Republicans need to give voters a reason to show up to the polls,” said Chris Pack, a GOP strategist.

Republicans see the convention as an opportunity to raise money. The Republican National Committee is hosting high-dollar fundraisers during the event—and charging \$88,600 for a photo with the president.

U.S. WATCH

WASHINGTON, D.C. Man Pleads Guilty In Big Bitcoin Theft

A 22-year-old man pleaded guilty on Tuesday to teaming up with friends to steal nearly a quarter-billion dollars in bitcoin from a Washington resident—one of the largest cryptocurrency thefts in U.S. history.

Malone Lam, who came to the U.S. from Singapore, faces a maximum prison sentence of 20 years after pleading guilty to a federal racketeering conspiracy charge.

Lam was an organizer for a network of young men who carried out a string of crypto scams starting in 2023, prosecutors said. He is one of 18 defendants charged in the case and is the 11th to plead guilty.

In August 2024, Lam and others used “social engineering” techniques to dupe the Washington man out of bitcoin worth over \$245 million.

—Associated Press

SCHOOLS Education Quality Falls, Public Says

Americans’ satisfaction with the quality of K-12 education in the country has hit a low point, driven by a growing political divide and concerns that schools aren’t preparing children for college and future jobs.

Just 32% of American adults say they are “completely” or “somewhat” satisfied with the U.S. school system, according to an August poll published Tuesday by Gallup and the Walton Family Foundation.

At the same time, dissatisfaction has increased to a high of 67%.

Democrats are driving the recent slide, with their satisfaction dropping about 19 points since President Trump’s second term began in 2025. Independents’ satisfaction appears to be down as well, about 10 points from 2024, while Republicans’ satisfaction has fallen, about 6 points.

—Associated Press

HAWAII Hurricane Hits Western Islands

Damaging winds and heavy rains from Hurricane Lowell pelted Hawaii’s western islands Tuesday, knocking out power and bringing the threat of flash floods and mudslides.

Fierce winds downed trees and caused widespread power outages on the island of Kauai, home to 73,000 residents. The Kauai Island Utility Cooperative reported that nearly all of its roughly 35,000 members were without power early Tuesday.

The center of the storm passed west of the islands in the overnight hours Tuesday and moved farther away throughout the day. Rainfall totals could reach up to 24 inches in some areas on Kauai.

—Associated Press

MAGA Merchandise Vendors Report Slow Sales

By Terell Wright

BOONES MILL, Va.—Donald “Whitey” Taylor made a fortune from sales at Trump Town USA, his store selling Make America Great Again apparel and memorabilia related to President Trump.

Taylor’s Boones Mill store—a former church—brought in upward of \$15,000 a day in 2024, the best sales pace in the business’s 11-year history, he said. But more than a year into Trump’s second term, sales have sunk. Taylor, 76 years old, said he now averages just \$1,500 a day, a slump he attributes to customers’ struggles with higher gas prices due to the Iran war and persistent inflation.

“You get used to good money, and you still want to make it,” said Taylor, reflecting on the hundreds of patrons a day who used to bustle through his store aisles. “Today, the economy is just not worth a crap anymore.”

Customers also stopped buying new merchandise because they felt they had already done their part in getting the president elected to a second term, he said.

Many MAGA-centered merchandise retailers and their suppliers are seeing sales dwindle, according to interviews with wholesalers, sales



A couple shopping at Trump Town USA in Virginia last week.

representatives, business owners and employees. As the president’s approval rating hovers near all-time lows, imperiling Republicans’ control of Congress, store owners blame a stagnant economy and weaker MAGA enthusiasm for lower sales. Some stores are closing permanently.

The Trump Store Manchester shut its doors recently, citing weak sales and high operating expenses due to increased rent and advertising costs, according to an employee. In the store’s final days, steep discounts to clear inventory didn’t draw a flood of customers. Only about 12 customers a day frequented the Manchester, Tenn., store’s final 72 hours, the

employee said.

Suppliers have adjusted their inventory to reflect weaker Trump merchandise sales.

Quan Ngo helps operate NT Souvenir Wholesale, a Washington, D.C.-based souvenir supplier that sells ornaments, magnets and political merchandise of both Republican and Democratic politicians to businesses throughout the country. Ngo said he knew Trump would win in 2024 after sales of merchandise supportive of the president dominated those in support of former Vice President Kamala Harris’s campaign. He said politics doesn’t drive his business; money does. And because of weak sales, he has

cut back on purchasing Trump merchandise and lets inventory—much of which is made in China—run low.

“We don’t make decisions off of emotions, we make them off of certainty and whether there is a demand,” he said. “We’ve ordered less Trump merchandise because demand is down.”

Lisa Hall, an independent sales representative based in Syracuse, N.Y., sells nearly two dozen product lines, including Trump-related merchandise. She said sales for Trump apparel began falling after Trump’s re-election but took a nosedive roughly six months ago—just after the U.S.-Iran war kicked off. She said that while many of her clients continue to purchase MAGA apparel, they aren’t buying as much and are reaching out far less frequently than they used to.

Hall said sales are weaker because of economic worries. If it boils down to buying a toy for their child or a MAGA hat, customers are going to choose the toy, when they might have purchased both in a better economy, she said.

Not all store owners say they are struggling. Seth Hansen, the owner of the Trump Store Branson in Branson, Mo., said that while sales are lower than the election-year high, business is still good. He also

operates a Jesus-themed merchandise store nearby, but the Trump store has continually performed better, raking in seven figures in revenue last year, he said. Hansen said other stores might be having trouble due to weak business sense.

“They’re not businesspeople,” he said. “They love Trump and the Republican Party and what it stands for, but that’s not a business plan.”

In Boones Mill, patrons still treat Taylor, who carries a small pistol in his back pocket, as a celebrity. Passersby and truck drivers honked and waved as he was closing shop for the day, wearing Trump-themed sneakers and socks imprinted with Confederate flags.

Trump won more than 70% of Franklin County, where the town is located, in 2024, among the highest margins for the president in the state.

Taylor, who is still an ardent Trump supporter, said he is offering more America 250 merchandise as well as Confederate memorabilia, but it hasn’t helped much. He is waiting for Jan. 20, 2029, anticipating that when Trump leaves office for good, nostalgic MAGA supporters will return in droves and help sales reach their former highs.

“They’ll all be back. It’s going to be awesome,” he said.



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U.S. NEWS

Housing Costs Roil Providence Race

High rents animate primary between Democratic mayor and DSA challenger

By Nicholas G. Miller and Sanai Hadiya Rashid

The biggest city in the nation's smallest state has a major housing problem.

Suffocated by decades of underbuilding, Providence, R.I., has become a prime example of how housing problems stretch far beyond much bigger cities such as New York and San Francisco. By at least one measure, from Redfin, the city of 195,000 is among the nation's least affordable based on rental costs and renter income levels. It topped the list last year.

This housing crisis is fueling a mayoral-primary showdown between an incumbent Democrat and a challenger from the Democratic Socialists of America.

State Rep. David Morales, a 27-year-old DSA member and part-time professional wrestler, has said he would impose rent control in his first 100 days. He is mounting a challenge to incumbent Democrat Brett Smiley. Elected in 2022, Smiley argued such plans could hurt housing production and vetoed a proposed 4% cap on annual rent hikes earlier this year.

The housing-focused race comes to a head with Wednesday's primary election. The winner will face Republican David Talan in November to decide who leads the reliably liberal stronghold.

Morales has criticized Smiley, who is married to one of the state's top real-estate agents, for owning multiple homes. Smiley has characterized Morales as riding a national wave of democratic socialism that the incumbent says is inattentive to local needs.

The race has divided the city despite broad agreement—from the brightly colored colonialists around Brown University to the apartments filled with Latino renters on the South Side—that housing



SUZANNE KREITER/THE BOSTON GLOBE/GETTY IMAGES



ALEXANDRO CEGARRA/BLOOMBERG NEWS

costs have become untenable. The disagreement is over what to do about it and which leader will bring relief.

"Everybody's leaving" because of high costs, said Abby Theus, a 63-year-old nursing assistant and Morales supporter, adding that she is considering leaving Providence in the next couple of years. "If we don't do something, we're out of here. We can forget it."

Theus has been trying for years to leave her current rent-restricted apartment, which she said has pest infestations, but can't afford market rents. "Even though the housing you live in may be substandard, you have no choice but to stay," she said.

Adam Braff, who moved to Providence in 2021 from New York City seeking more space, worries that rent control wouldn't only depress development but also encourage owners to take their properties out of the rental market. He supports Smiley.

Providence's dense cityscape is filled with triple-decker apartments, a three-floor New

England staple built to house legions of factory workers.

The metro area's average rental price has risen 34% to \$2,089 since 2020, according to CoStar. Earlier this year, Zillow ranked Providence as the hottest rental market in the country and the fourth-hottest for-sale market.

A regional economic hub known for its local arts scene, the city has become attractive partially as a more affordable alternative to New York and Boston, said Brenda Clement, director of HousingWorks RI, a housing research group at Roger Williams University. Newcomers helped the population rise modestly since the Covid-19 pandemic began.

But Providence—like all of Rhode Island—is still trying to dig out from a long homebuilding dry spell, even after some recent growth in permitting and construction. For years, Rhode Island ranked near the bottom among U.S. states in new residential construction per capita, and from 2009 to 2015, developers there received permits for

fewer than 1,000 units a year.

The problem, according to Clement: Restrictive zoning laws have made building density difficult, and Rhode Island has consistently invested less public money in housing than



ABBY THEUS

'Everybody's leaving' because of high costs, said Providence resident Abby Theus.

its New England neighbors. This is a recipe for rental strain in a city where the median household income is \$68,000 and that has grappled with significant homelessness.



TONY LUDING FOR WSJ

The Democratic mayor of Providence, R.I., Brett Smiley, at left, vetoed a proposed 4% cap on annual rent hikes. His Democratic Socialist of America challenger, David Morales, top left, has said he would impose rent control in his first 100 days.

Amazon Plane's Systems Weren't Deployed

By Andrew Tangel and Alyssa Lukpat

Two systems that could have slowed an Amazon Air flight that crashed in Miami over the weekend weren't deployed before the plane careened off a runway and into nearby vehicles, investigators said late Tuesday.

The National Transportation Safety Board didn't find evidence on one of the plane's black boxes that the Boeing 767's speed brakes, which are panels that create aerodynamic drag, or thrust reversers, which redirect air to lower the plane's speed while landing, were deployed, lead investigator Chihoon Shin said at a news briefing.

The aircraft's wheel brakes were applied 23 seconds before the end of the black box's recording, but then those brakes were released a few seconds later and the throttles increased to levels consistent with go-around thrust, Shin said. Go-arounds are routine maneuvers pilots perform to redo landing attempts.

After that, Shin said, the throttles were reduced to idle power and the brakes were re-applied until the end of the data recording.

NTSB Chairwoman Jennifer Homendy declined to speculate about why the systems weren't deployed.

The jet overran a runway on Sunday at Miami International Airport and crashed into nearby vehicles, killing five people and injuring five others.

Homendy said most of the cargo on the plane was made up of contact lenses. Cargo carrier 21 Air operated the flight.

Amazon has said it is working closely with local authorities and officials and will cooperate with any investigation, while 21 Air said it was devastated by the accident.

States Pull Tax Breaks For Centers

Continued from Page One said Rader, who is proposing new data center taxes and requirements that developers pay more for power and electrical infrastructure. He represents parts of Cleveland, where locals have pushed back against the facilities.

A similar dynamic is playing out across the country, as legislators or governors in more than 10 states including Illinois, New Jersey and Washington state, have slammed the brakes on the tax breaks. The reversals underscore how state leaders who once welcomed the facilities powering the AI boom as an economic engine suddenly treat them like a political liability.

Dozens of other states including Texas have proposed similar bills or steps, potentially costing the industry billions in tax benefits. That has the potential to push future projects to states such as Indiana, West Virginia and Wyoming that have retained favorable tax regimes, industry executives and advisers said. Industry advocates are telling state officials that other taxes they pay fund local schools and police departments, and that eliminating incentives will force data centers to move.

Wide rebellion

Amazon said it has invested nearly \$40 billion in Ohio data centers since 2015, creating thousands of jobs, and paid almost \$11 million in state property taxes and fees last year. Meta and Alphabet's Google declined to comment, as did DeWine's office.

The assault on tax provisions is the latest example of the nationwide rebellion against AI due to fears about power and water consumption, a dynamic that candidates are watching ahead of November's elections. A City Council mem-



JESSICA PHELPS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

A data center is being built in Middletown Township, Ohio. Resident opposition in Ohio to such centers is growing.

ber in Independence, Mo., John Perkins, was recently voted out of office after he voted to approve billions in incentives for a data center.

"Our industry has been knocked on our backfoot," said Steve DelBianco, CEO of NetChoice, a tech industry group that fights regulation. DelBianco said the backlash is based on misinformation and that he has warned state officials that eliminating incentives will hurt their economies.

President Trump has urged voters to welcome the facilities despite recent polls showing Americans overwhelmingly don't want data centers near them. "If you want to get rich as a state or as a town and if you want to pay lower taxes, if you want to create tremendous wealth, if you want your house to be more valuable and everything else, you're going to want a data center," Trump, a Republican, said Friday.

More than 35 states offer sales tax exemptions or similar benefits to data-center developers. That sales tax treatment is crucial to financing because the computer chips and servers inside the facilities represent a chunk of the projects' costs, and because that equipment gets replaced every few years. Avoiding that tax, often 6% or 7%, on hundreds of millions or billions of dollars of equipment helps determine where a data center



ERIC COM/REUTERS

goes, industry executives said. The exemptions are, in some respects, similar to the treatment of manufacturers' purchases on inputs to factories, which is designed to prevent cascading layers of the same tax on the same product.

Many of the data-center exemptions include specific job-creation and investment targets. Local governments have also offered property tax abatements to attract the centers, which over time can generate revenue to fund schools and police departments.

Federal tax changes have also improved the economics of the data center build-out. Last year's Republican tax law brought back immediate deductions for equipment purchases that would otherwise be depreciated. And future centers may be able to use the Opportunity Zone program, which will soon offer enhanced tax breaks for certain rural investments.

A decade ago, when states like Ohio passed the tax provisions, data centers were a fraction of their current size and used for powering websites and streaming services.

The state made itself unusually attractive. Including its incentives, Ohio's effective tax rate on data centers was 1.2% as of the end of 2025. That was the lowest of 15 states analyzed by the Quantitative Economics and Statistics team at accounting firm EY. California, at the other end of the scale, had an effective tax rate of 16.9%.

ChatGPT frenzy

The frenzy following the launch of ChatGPT in late 2022 and hundreds of billions of dollars of tech investments made the exemptions much more lucrative. That caught many states off guard, prompting a quick backlash.

"It definitely happened in hyperspeed because of hyper-scaling," said Tim Schram, who specializes in state and local taxes at accounting firm BDO.

New Jersey signed off a half-billion-dollar tax credit for data centers in 2024 after a unanimous state Senate vote. Last month, the state canceled the remaining \$250 million—after a 35-4 Senate vote in the opposite direction.

Even states that are keeping their exemptions are taking steps to make tech companies pay more. Virginia, the state with the most data centers, recently passed a tax on electricity consumed by data-center operators while preserving its sales tax exemption for equipment.

Ohio, Arizona and Illinois have become less attractive after pausing or axing exemptions, said Ian Boccaccio of tax firm Ryan. He said he's urging data-center clients to consider using other investment tax breaks offered by states for companies. In the long run, industry watchers said, the facilities offer too many benefits for governments to pass them up.

"This is a passing fad," Boccaccio said of the opposition, "and in two years we won't have these issues with data centers."

IRS Broke Law In Sharing Taxpayer Records With ICE

By Richard Rubin

WASHINGTON—The Trump administration violated federal law when it shared confidential taxpayer information with immigration authorities, an appeals court ruled Tuesday.

The Internal Revenue Service improperly allowed data transfers based on partial addresses and failed to satisfy requirements that tightly tie legal information sharing to criminal investigations, according to the U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia. The court left in place a lower-court ruling that has blocked further data sharing.

"The IRS is now on notice twice over regarding the legal inadequacies of its summer 2025 disclosures," Judge Cornelia Pillard wrote for a unanimous three-judge panel in a case brought by a taxpayer-rights group. "The government and its personnel face steep civil and criminal consequences for willful disclosure of information."

The tax code creates broad protections for taxpayers' information, allowing limited exceptions when IRS employees can disclose data outside the agency. Protected records include information provided by people who are in the country illegally. For many years, the government had encouraged those people to file returns and be compliant with the tax law, assuring them that they wouldn't share information with immigration authorities.

Trump administration officials, however, were eager to use the government's trove of

tax data for immigration enforcement. They ran into resistance in the IRS when they tried to get tax records early in the administration, and broad requests were rejected.

But they eventually zeroed in on one exception in the law. The law requires tax authorities to provide information to federal agencies conducting criminal inquiries, including investigations of people who have failed to follow final orders of removal from the U.S.

The IRS and Immigration and Customs Enforcement set up a procedure that let immigration officials submit lists to tax authorities to check

against their records. ICE sent more than one million names to the IRS, which turned over more than 47,000 records in response.

But the procedure and its implementation had flaws, ruled the judges, all of whom were nominated by Democratic former President Barack Obama. The law requires requests to include a name and address, but in some cases, the IRS turned over taxpayer information in response to partial or incomplete addresses.

The IRS-ICE agreement had another flaw, the court ruled. The IRS provided a last known address for taxpayers, not a date. That information isn't necessarily about the period after a removal order that would pertain to a criminal investigation, and thus the approach "systematically will cause IRS to continue to ignore that statutory requirement," the court ruled.

An IRS spokesman declined to comment.

The tax code creates broad protections for taxpayers' information, allowing limited exceptions when IRS employees can disclose data outside the agency. Protected records include information provided by people who are in the country illegally. For many years, the government had encouraged those people to file returns and be compliant with the tax law, assuring them that they wouldn't share information with immigration authorities.

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WORLD NEWS

Yemeni Rebels Hit Facilities In Saudi Arabia

Gas and oil-storage sites were attacked as the U.S.-Iran war crimps energy flows

Iran-backed Houthi militants in Yemen fired drones and missiles at several of Saudi Arabia's southern energy facilities on Tuesday, escalating the fighting on what has become a second front for the kingdom and sending oil prices back toward \$100 a barrel.

By Summer Said, Farhan Rafid and Costas Paris

Saudi Arabia confirmed the attacks, which the Houthis said targeted facilities in Abha, Najran and Jazan. The strikes hit gas and oil-storage facilities including at a power plant in Abha and left the major refinery at Jazan off line, people familiar with the damage said. Output at Jazan had been diminished by previous Houthi strikes. Saudi Aramco, the country's majority state-owned

oil company, didn't respond to a request for comment. The attacks come as the U.S.-Iran war, in its seventh month, continues to crimp energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz. A group of the 18 biggest shipping countries warned on Tuesday that worldwide conflicts, trade restrictions and chokepoints are raising costs and spreading uncertainty across global supply chains. The Consultative Shipping Group, an informal alliance made up of shipping powers such as Germany, Denmark, Japan South Korea and the U.K., said attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz and Black Sea aren't one-off shocks, but a "signal of a structural shift in the operating environment of global trade." The changes are eroding freedom of navigation, a cornerstone of global shipping, the group said. Some 80% of world trade moves by sea. The alliance said two parallel trade systems are emerging, with one playing by the rules and another evading



An image released by the Houthis reportedly shows trucks hit by missiles launched by the rebels near a military camp in Yemen.

sanctions, attacking vessels and forcing ships to reroute from key waterways such as the Strait of Hormuz, the Suez and the Red Sea. Hundreds of vessels are part of shadow fleets that evade sanctions and sail without insurance. "Without maritime trade, supply chains would fragment and the global economy as we know it would come to a sudden halt," the group said. Tensions between the Houthis and Saudi Arabia date

to Yemen's civil war, when the kingdom intervened against the militant group, and picked up again in July after a long period of relative calm. The Houthis declared a blockade of Saudi ships in the Red Sea and began attacking its oil tankers. "The recent escalation of the Middle East conflict has increased the likelihood of a prolonged standoff, punctuated by calibrated military action by the U.S. and Iran," analysts at ANZ Research said.

"This could see Persian Gulf supply remain constrained through the rest of 2026." Tuesday's attacks caused fires at several locations and led to a halt in some operations, while specialized teams worked to contain the fires, secure the sites and assess the damage, said the Saudi energy ministry. It didn't identify the facilities involved or quantify the impact on oil production or exports. The Houthis also hit the Khamis Mushait Air Base, but

the damage was unclear, while their attack on the Jazan airport failed, the people familiar with the damage said. Saudi Aramco's oil facilities in Jazan were attacked Monday, the people said. Aramco was still assessing the damage when the new strike came, they said. Jazan is home to an Aramco refinery designed to process as much as 400,000 barrels a day of crude oil and produce fuels including gasoline and ultralow-sulfur diesel.

U.S. Strikes Iran Tankers After Tehran Targets Navy Ships

By SHELBY HOLLIDAY AND COSTAS PARIS

The U.S. destroyed five Iranian oil tankers on Tuesday in response to fresh attacks by Tehran to strike U.S. warships in the Middle East in recent days, according to U.S. Central Command. Since Friday, Iran has fired ballistic missiles at a U.S. aircraft carrier, destroyers and at

least one Marine ship, according to U.S. officials familiar with the attacks. All of the attacks have failed, Centcom said, but officials described some of them as close calls. Iran's attempts to hit American naval assets are raising alarms that the regime is using more sophisticated weapons and could be getting assistance tracking the warships from China or Russia,

the officials said. In response to the attacks, the U.S. destroyed four Iranian tankers in the Gulf of Oman and one near Kharg Island, where Iran exports a majority of its oil, Centcom said. The crews of the Iranian tankers were directed to abandon ship before the strikes. "Iran has used the tankers as part of a multibillion-dollar shadow network that funds

the IRGC and its regional proxies," Centcom said, referring to the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps. Iran later fired missiles at U.S. forces in Jordan, and the IRGC said in a statement that it was targeting jet fighters staged at the Muwaffaq Salti air base. Jordan's armed forces said the country intercepted 18 ballistic missiles and two additional missiles fell in

unpopulated areas. A U.S. official said Iran's attacks were ineffective in the face of integrated air and missile defenses, and that all American forces were accounted for in Jordan. The renewed fighting comes after Iran first launched ballistic missiles at an aircraft carrier and a destroyer over the weekend. The U.S. responded to that attack

by striking three tankers Saturday to send a message that Iran's attacks wouldn't be tolerated. The following days, Iran took aim at more warships, the officials said. The attacks highlight Iran's willingness to go on the offensive as the U.S. blockade of Iranian ports weighs on the country's economy. They also risk escalating the conflict.



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Since 1912, M.S. Rau has specialized in the world's finest art, antiques and jewelry. Backed by our unprecedented 125% Guarantee, we stand behind each and every piece.

European Nations Set Trade Ban

Continued from Page One port important and valued trade with Green Line Israel," Miliband said, referring to Israel within its pre-1967 boundaries, before the occupation of the West Bank.

Israel rejected the criticism and accused the U.K. of interfering in its sovereign affairs. "The accusations made today...were outrageous lies," Foreign Minister Gideon Sa'ar of Israel said. Before the U.K. announcement, U.S. Ambassador to Israel Mike Huckabee told the BBC that the U.S. would retaliate against the U.K. if it went ahead with the sanctions. He said British companies could be banned from doing business in some U.S. states. Asked about the U.K.'s decision Tuesday, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said President Trump hadn't weighed in on the matter. He said the U.K. told the Trump administration about its plans in advance of the announcement. U.K. Prime Minister Andy Burnham spoke with Trump on Monday. "We share the goal of stability," Rubio said. "We don't want to see some uptick in violence or an uptick in conflict or tensions in the West Bank at a very tenuous time in the region." Ties between the U.K. and Israel have deteriorated as the Labour government has taken a harder line on Israel, partly in response to growing public anger about the Gaza war. A recent YouGov survey found that 50% of Britons support a ban on trade with illegal Israeli settlements in the West Bank, with 16% opposed and the rest undecided. After the U.K. said Tuesday that it would go ahead with the sanctions, Canada and France said they would take similar steps. A group of other



Photo taken from the E1 corridor, an area in the occupied West Bank, shows vehicles driving near an Israeli settlement.

countries, including Norway, Iceland, Poland and Sweden, said they would act to stop trade with settlements and would push for an EU-wide ban on such transactions. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's government is the most right-wing in Israel's history, with settler leaders such as National Security Minister Itamar Ben-Gvir and Finance Minister Bezalel Smotrich in powerful posts. Smotrich and Ben-Gvir have been sanctioned by western countries for inciting violence against Palestinians. Smotrich has said his dream is full Israeli sovereignty over the territory. European governments have objected to Israel's plans to expand the E1 settlement, which critics said would effectively divide parts of the West Bank and complicate the prospect of a Palestinian state. Israel approved thousands of new housing units in E1 last year. The plan "finally buries the idea of a Palestinian state," Smotrich said when the units were approved. Much of the world considers Israeli settlements in the West Bank illegal under international law. Israel disputes this. Israeli settler violence against Palestinians has surged since the start of the Gaza war in 2023. In a statement, Burnham, Prime Minister Mark Carney of Canada and President Emmanuel Macron of France said a two-state solution in which Israelis and Palestinians live

peacefully side by side was in their countries' national interest. The settlement expansion and violence, they said, posed a "direct and urgent threat to that vision for peace." Israeli officials have said sanctions against the settlements would most heavily affect Palestinian jobs in Israeli companies there. They have accused European governments of demanding steps from Israel toward peace without making matching demands of Palestinian authorities. Many European governments also have criticized Israel's conduct of the war in Gaza. Israel attacked Hamas in the enclave after the group led the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks. Tens of thousands of Palestinians have been killed in the war. Last year, the U.K., France, Canada and Australia moved to formally recognize a Palestinian state, marking a significant shift in longstanding foreign policy. The U.S. and Israel strongly opposed the move. Tuesday's announcement is largely symbolic, with only limited trade between Europe and the settlements in the West Bank. A U.K. parliamentary report estimated U.K. trade with the settlements at about £38 million, or about \$51.4 million. "The implications are, first and foremost, setting boundaries and establishing a clear policy against the settlement enterprise," said Yonatan Mizrahi of the settlement watch team at Peace Now, an advocacy group in Israel that favors the two-state solution. "The settlement enterprise cannot exist without economic support, most of which comes through or with the backing of the U.S."

WORLD NEWS

Oil Rise Threatens Stocks

Continued from Page One

company declined 10%, its biggest one-day drop in more than 25 years, after a competitor’s heart-disease drug failed a clinical trial, casting doubt on similar drugs under development.

The S&P 500 index closed 0.6% lower. The Nasdaq composite fell 0.3%.

The U.S. attacked Iranian oil tankers on Tuesday, after Iran launched an attack against U.S. Navy ships on Monday, according to a U.S. official.

Iran’s recent attempts to hit U.S. naval assets are raising alarm that its military is using more sophisticated weapons and could be getting assistance from China or Russia, according to the officials.

Kim Fustier, senior global oil and gas analyst at HSBC, said in a Tuesday note that her new base case now assumes that a U.S.-Iran understanding will emerge but be vulnerable to repeated breakdowns.

Traffic through water chokepoints will only improve gradually as the industry adapts to elevated risk, she said, adding that flows through the Strait of Hormuz

would rise from the current six million barrels a day to eight million barrels a day by year-end and 9.5 million barrels a day by mid next year. Before the war, around 20 million barrels a day went through the waterway.

“This leaves the market tighter for longer than we had previously assumed,” Fustier said. She raised her forecast for Brent to \$90 a barrel for this year from \$80 a barrel previously.

Analysts at Goldman Sachs and Bank of America also raised their Brent forecasts.

“If skirmishes curbing oil flows continue into year end, Brent could trade in a \$95-120 a barrel range. Meanwhile, a broader conflict resulting in major energy infrastructure damage may spike prices as high as \$150 a barrel,” Bank of America analysts wrote in a Monday note.

Traffic through the Strait of Hormuz has been subdued for weeks. On Monday, only nine commodities vessels crossed the waterway and five so far Tuesday, according to preliminary data from Kpler.

By comparison, transits averaged around 30 in late June after the U.S. and Iran signed a preliminary peace deal and nearly 100 in the 10 days before the war.

The S&P 500 energy sector is up more than 40% on the year, with oil producers benefiting from higher prices. Shares of Marathon Petroleum closed at a record high \$397.77 on Tuesday.



Forensic police inspect a hole in the museum’s outer fence.



Renoir Museum Is Raided In Latest French Art Heist

Targeting of gallery along the Riviera follows a wave of thefts around nation

By NOEMIE BISSEBIE

PARIS—A pair of thieves stole four artworks from a French museum dedicated to the painter Pierre-Auguste Renoir, in a sign of the country’s struggle to protect its cultural heritage following last year’s Louvre heist.

The thieves dropped two paintings in their escape, said Bryan Masson, the mayor of Cagnes-sur-Mer, the French Riviera town where the French impressionist spent his final years and that now houses the museum. Police arrived at the scene five minutes after the alarm went off early Tuesday but couldn’t catch the two individuals, who were later spotted by local surveillance cameras, Masson added.

One of the stolen artworks is a vertical oil painting on canvas dating back to around 1910 depicting French actress Gabrielle Colonna-Romano. It portrays the young woman in a white gown, seated on a sofa inside a room with red walls



MUSÉE RENOIR/REUTERS

‘Coco Reading’ was taken but dropped by the thieves.

adorned with paintings. The second is an unfinished piece that depicts a young woman standing in front of a well.

The Musée Renoir, founded in 1960, showcases a dozen original Renoir paintings, including portraits, nudes and still-life paintings. It also houses around 40 sculptures as well as photographs that belonged to his family.

France is contending with a wave of thefts that have targeted its museums in recent years. Last October, a team of thieves broke into the Louvre Museum in broad daylight and

made off with a clutch of crown jewels valued at \$102 million. None of the eight pieces of jewelry stolen in that heist has been recovered, though several suspects have been detained and face preliminary charges.

In July, a sledgehammer-wielding trio broke into the Lalique Museum in the French village of Wingen-sur-Moder, walking out with 27 pieces of jewelry. Around \$5 million worth of art nouveau jewelry was stolen, much of it designed by the famed luxury designer René Jules Lalique,

who was known for his florid, enameled brooches, ornate perfume bottles and crystal vases popular across Europe from the 1890s onward. Later that month, thieves stole a gold torque necklace from a Celtic burial arrangement known as the Vix treasure at the Musée du Pays Châtillonnais, a museum in Burgundy.

The heist on Tuesday is yet another blow to France’s cultural institutions. Renoir is celebrated for his light-dappled canvases capturing 19th-century European leisure, high society and timeless figurative studies. His work is displayed in museums worldwide, including in the U.S.

“To attack the Renoir Museum is to attack part of the history and heritage of Cagnes-sur-Mer,” said Masson, the far-right mayor of the town. The theft “confirms the need to immediately implement a comprehensive plan to secure France’s museums and protect works of art,” he added.

The French government announced this summer new measures to protect France’s cultural heritage, including the temporary removal of certain objects from display cases until their protection can be ensured.

German Far-Right Party Plans To Use State as a Policy Lab

By BERTRAND BENOIT

BERLIN—After Alternative for Germany’s big state-election win in eastern Germany on Sunday, the party is as close as it has ever been to actually governing. If it succeeds, it intends to launch one of the most ambitious far-right policy experiments in Europe this century.

The party, known by its initials, AfD, sees the state of Saxony-Anhalt as a showcase for its ideas on immigration, education, culture and demographics, which in some cases would represent a sharp departure from the approach of mainstream political parties.

AfD leaders have pledged to crack down on migrants and rework school curricula to focus less on Germany’s Nazi-era past. They also want to create a volunteer militia to help police maintain order and say they will cut funding to museums and arts groups with “anti-German goals.”

“We won’t bend and we will not water down our fundamental positions,” said Ulrich Siegmund, the AfD’s candidate to become premier of the state. Proposals on immigration, security, energy policy and the economy were “nonnegotiable,” he added.

The former salesman needs to find three additional votes to secure a stable majority in the state parliament and form a government. Negotiations with other politicians could take weeks or even months. If he succeeds, some of his proposals will likely face financial, legal and constitutional obstacles.

Some of the AfD’s marquee ideas, such as taking Germany out of the European Union, abandoning the euro as a currency, canceling sanctions on Russia and ending support for Ukraine, are beyond the reach of a state government.

Yet Germany’s federal system gives states substantial powers over education, cultural policy and security—including control over the police and the regional branch of the Office for the Protection of the Constitution, Germany’s domestic intelligence agency.

Should the AfD take control of the agency, it would raise concern about the state’s determination to fight far-right extremism and antisemitism, said Remko Leemhuis, director of the Berlin office of the American Jewish Committee.

Saxony-Anhalt had the second-highest number of far-right motivated criminal acts per inhabitant last year, according to police statistics.

“In countries like France and Italy, the far right has moderated as it has moved closer to power,” Leemhuis said. “Here it is the opposite. The party has



KAY NIETZOLD/PAZZUMA PRESS

Ulrich Siegmund said the AfD won’t soften its positions.

become more and more radical over time, to the point where others in Europe don’t want anything to do with it.” The AfD rejects this accusation, saying it is advocating conservative ideas that were mainstream in the 1990s and early 2000s.

The AfD program for Saxony-Anhalt calls for “remigration.” The concept, popularized by the ethno-nationalist identitarian movement in France in the early 2000s, describes the forceful removal of non-nationals, including some naturalized citizens, from Europe.

Siegmund insists he won’t target German citizens or anyone residing in Germany legally and that his government would abide by all constitutional requirements.

His program, however, calls on employers not to hire “culture-distant” migrants, whom

it says are often poorly qualified and can put German lives at risk. EU migrants who receive benefits, meanwhile, should leave, according to the document. Criminals with dual citizenship should lose their German nationality and all Ukrainians should be stripped of refugee status and benefits. The AfD wants to house all asylum seekers in a small number of centers away from urban areas, seize their assets and compel them to work.

The party could struggle to implement much of its immigration agenda since most of it would require backing from the federal government.

That isn’t the case for education. There, the AfD wants to create separate classrooms for children of migrants it deems to have low prospects of staying in Germany. It also wants children with serious disabilities to be removed from ordinary classrooms and taught separately.

The party thinks patriotism should play a bigger role in shaping the curriculum. History classes should focus less on the Nazi era and the Holocaust and more on 19th-century history, the founding of the second Reich and Bismarck. Teachers should have to swear an oath to the German people and the homeland.

Museums, theaters, orchestras and nongovernmental organizations that follow “anti-German goals” may see their funding cut, the program says.

The Saxony-Anhalt program includes a number of new positions for the party as a whole, including more money for Russian-language education and cuts in state funding to the officially recognized Catholic and Lutheran churches.

Among the party’s least well-known proposals is the creation of a volunteer militia under the authority of the municipal police to help authorities patrol smaller communities.

“This is among the strangest proposals,” said Benjamin Höhne, political scientist at Chemnitz University. “This could raise concerns about the creation of a political shock troop for the party.”

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WORLD NEWS

WORLD WATCH



AWASH IN HISTORY: Authorities in Rome on Tuesday unveiled a first-century depiction of a maritime city in what became the Baths of Trajan, the world’s largest such complex.

Noem Aide’s Power Moves At DHS

Continued from Page One

Officials. Qatar and U.A.E. declined the proposals, the people said.

The alleged moneymaking efforts, which appeared to be offers by Lewandowski to sell government services for personal gain, came while he had an expansive portfolio at one of the most powerful agencies in the federal government. The role gave him de facto decision-making authority over large amounts of recently appropriated billions of dollars, the president’s border and immigration enforcement agenda and the collection of tariffs, which have been vastly expanded under President Trump.

Lewandowski held the status of a “special government employee,” or SGE, which allowed him to carry out private business. He also was in a close personal relationship with the actual DHS secretary at the time, Kristi Noem.

A probe by the department’s internal watchdog is scrutinizing any potential improprieties in the contracting process, including any evidence of personal enrichment by top officials. It has since found evidence that Lewandowski may have been involved in improperly awarding government contracts, the Journal reported in July.

A representative for Lewandowski denied Lewandowski had “sought contracts with foreign governments,” said he played no role in contract review or approval at the department and said he hadn’t been contacted about any investigation into contracting at DHS. The representative said Lewandowski “adamantly denies ever demanding any payment or compensation from any potential, former, or current government contractor or seeking or soliciting or entering contracts with foreign governments while volunteering his time with DHS,” and that “Lewandowski denies any wrongdoing.” The representative didn’t respond to other detailed questions from The Wall Street Journal.

Both Noem and Lewandowski left DHS after Trump ousted the secretary in March and replaced her with Markwayne Mullin. Trump pushed out Noem over a chaotic tenure that culminated in two high-profile killings of U.S. citizens by federal agents and a pair of congressional hearings that displayed bipartisan frustration with her leadership.

While running the department, the pair also installed allies in jobs where the people influenced or directed contracts.

SGEs are advisers who usually have specific expertise and are brought in for short-term stints. Only a sliver of SGEs must publicly disclose clients or potential conflicts of interest, but government officials are generally prohibited from using their roles for private gain.

Lewandowski now operates as a consultant. One client is Bahrain,

which signed a contract with him after he left office, a Bahraini official said.

Officials said they didn’t know the extent to which Noem herself was aware of Lewandowski’s alleged efforts. Lewandowski traveled and attended most department meetings with Noem, and the pair have reportedly been romantically linked for years. Lewandowski and Noem have denied having such a relationship.

A spokesperson for Noem didn’t respond to requests for comment on her tenure at DHS.

Mullin and White House officials have been briefed on the DHS inspector general’s inquiry, the Journal previously reported. Investigators are weighing a potential criminal referral to the Justice Department, and Democrats in the House of Representatives are preparing for a related probe if the party wins a majority in November’s mid-term elections.

A White House spokeswoman declined to comment. DHS representatives didn’t respond to repeated requests for comment.

Billions in budget

Soon after taking office, Noem consolidated under the secretary’s control decision-making that had been delegated to sub-agencies. Essentially all department spending over \$100,000 was put under the secretary’s purview, with the stated goal of reducing fraud and waste. Officials said it created a massive bottleneck.

The move was widely seen within the administration as giving Lewandowski—as Noem’s right hand—the power to closely monitor and ultimately decide which companies could receive government contracts.

One of the biggest drivers of spending under Noem was Trump’s deportation agenda. Congress gave the department an extra \$75 billion to spend during Trump’s term on new deportation officers, technology and detention facilities.

Executives at data-analysis company Palantir worked with DHS officials for weeks in fall 2025 to negotiate a sprawling \$2.7 billion contract, known as a blanket purchase agreement. They came to a deal for a wide swath of work that included an immigration and Secret Service portfolio.

DHS officials wanted to move quickly and have it signed before Sept. 30, the end of the fiscal year, Palantir officials were told, according to people familiar with the matter. But the contract then sat for weeks on Noem’s desk without a signature, and Palantir officials struggled to get answers from



Corey Lewandowski at a Florida event on March 5.

DHS on why the contract wasn’t signed.

Then in November, Palantir received scheduling requests from Lewandowski, who wanted a meeting with Palantir CEO Alex Karp. Over the course of several weeks, DHS officials repeatedly asked for the meeting, saying it needed to be a one-on-one meeting between Karp and Lewandowski, the people said.

Palantir officials, who thought the terms of the deal were settled, weren’t given an agenda for the meeting. The previous negotiations had fol-

Lewandowski’s portfolio at Homeland Security was expansive.

lowed the usual practice for government contracts, in which teams negotiate following standardized procedures, to provide some oversight over the disbursement of taxpayer dollars.

Palantir executives set up a meeting but then canceled it. Karp and others at Palantir felt uncomfortable and concerned about the circumstances of the meeting and didn’t want to take it, given the large contract on the table, the people said. They had never previously had a contract held up for so long.

The meeting never happened, and the \$2.7 billion blanket purchase agreement wasn’t signed. Lewandowski told associates at the department that he was going to consolidate Palantir’s work across the agency so the company would receive less

SINGAPORE Well-Paid Officials Get Another Raise

The government announced a raise of up to 64% for Prime Minister Lawrence Wong, who, with a \$1.7 million salary, is already one of the highest-paid political leaders in the world.

The increase takes Wong’s salary to 3.6 million Singapore dollars, equivalent to \$2.84 million, a year. The salary for junior ministers, meanwhile, will jump to \$51.8 million from \$31.1 million currently, although actual payouts will rise only gradually.

By contrast, President Trump’s annual salary is \$400,000.

Singapore has long paid its politicians especially well, arguing that competitive salaries help to deter corruption and are necessary to attract top talent that might otherwise join the private sector. However, such rich salaries have become increasingly sensitive in the city-state, as Singaporeans face rising living costs.

—Gabriele Steinhauser

ISRAEL U.A.E. Warned Netanyahu of Attack

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was directly warned by the president of the United Arab Emirates that Hamas was planning a major offensive 10 days before the militant group attacked on Oct. 7, 2023, an Israeli newspaper reported.

President Mohammed bin Zayed told Netanyahu that Yahya Sinwar, the leader of Hamas in Gaza at the time, was planning an operation, the Haaretz daily reported.

Bin Zayed said it could destabilize the region and undermine the Abraham Accords, the normalization agreements between Israel and several Arab and Muslim-majority nations, the newspaper reported.

But Netanyahu “reacted with relative calm,” Haaretz reported, adding that he assured bin Zayed that Israel was prepared and a possible attack was more likely to come from the occupied West Bank.

—Associated Press

OBITUARY Tung Chee-hwa, 89, Post-Colonial Leader

Hong Kong’s first post-colonial leader, Tung Chee-hwa, who struggled to cope with an Asian financial crisis and growing protests for democracy in the early years under Chinese rule, died Tuesday at age 89.

His office said in a statement that Tung passed away peacefully in the presence of his family members.

Tung, a shipping tycoon, had little political experience before a panel of pro-Beijing elites picked him to be the first leader of the southern Chinese territory after the end of British colonial rule in 1997.

Many believe Beijing perceived Tung as a loyalist who would obey the Communist leadership’s edicts. He was also seen as beholden to Beijing because China’s state-run banks helped rescue his family’s ailing shipping company—Orient Overseas Container Line—during a global slump in the 1980s.

—Associated Press

FROM PAGE ONE

threat, but they made a record profit in Trump’s first term.

At DHS this term, GEO expected to get even more business, given the massive deportation campaign Trump had promised and the billions of dollars in increased spending.

For months, Lewandowski blocked the firm from getting government contracts, according to DHS officials.

Later, Lewandowski boasted to the officials that he was forcing GEO to accept less business than it had previously received. Officials at Immigration and Customs Enforcement said Lewandowski openly and frequently advocated for detention options that could cut GEO’s involvement, including by asking states such as Florida and Louisiana to operate their own makeshift facilities rather than use GEO’s, arguing it would save money.

While GEO has added new immigration detention contracts under Trump, the company has lost significant market share compared with its work during the Biden administration—moving from handling 37% of the market under Biden to 25% under Trump, according to a Journal analysis of federal contracts. The decline came even though GEO had detention facilities sitting idle. The overall market for the detention services has more than doubled so far under Trump, to around \$4 billion.

GEO has booked almost \$1 billion in detention contracts in the roughly 500 days of the Trump administration, compared with more than \$600 million in such deals in the previous 500 days, under Biden.

Democrats on the House Oversight Committee are now investigating allegations of Lewandowski “shaking down contractors for kickbacks,” Rep. Robert Garcia, ranking member of the committee, wrote in a letter to GEO chairman and founder, George Zoley, referencing a report by NBC News.

GEO and Zoley didn’t respond to requests for comment.

Lewandowski also placed allies across the department, sometimes ensuring they were paid larger than typical salaries.

One, Kara Voorhies, was paid as much as \$19,000 a week for serving in an unusually senior role as a contractor at the FEMA disaster relief agency. The DHS investigators looking into potential improprieties in the contracting process searched her office in March and are examining her role in FEMA’s decisions, according to people familiar with the matter. Involvement in contracting isn’t typical for someone of her status, department officials said.

Voorhies didn’t respond to

requests for comment.

Another, Josh Whitehouse, a former Republican lawmaker from Lewandowski’s home state of New Hampshire, joined the department as an SGE. He rarely interacted with senior officials other than Lewandowski, and several senior officials weren’t aware of any specific duties assigned to him, people familiar with the matter said.

Whitehouse would often be added to meetings by Lewandowski, sitting in on the discussions between DHS officials and corporate executives, people present in the meetings said.

In response to questions from the Journal, a lawyer for Whitehouse said Whitehouse attended meetings that were relevant to his job or that he was asked to attend, and that he “answered to Mr. Lewandowski” and Noem. He said Whitehouse denied being involved in any self-dealing or corruption while at DHS. He described the allegations as false and “gossip from ‘officials’ who have no clue what they are talking about and have an axe to grind.”

Middle East visits

DHS, a 260,000-employee behemoth created in the aftermath of the 9/11 attacks, oversees immigration and customs, and points of entry such as airports, border crossings and coastlines, incorporating such agencies as TSA, Customs and Border Protection and the U.S. Coast Guard. It also covers disaster response and cybersecurity, among other things.

Under the second Trump administration, it prepared to carry out Trump’s promise to deport millions of immigrants living in the U.S. illegally. When Noem and Lewandowski arrived there, White House and department officials said they expected them to focus their travel within the U.S. to help oversee immigration enforcement actions, and Latin America, to talk to leaders about assisting in those efforts.

The pair took on an additional portfolio: the Middle East.

Noem and Lewandowski traveled repeatedly to the region, first in May 2025, when they visited Bahrain and Israel. A photographer accompanied them, taking pictures of Noem riding a camel in a headscarf, steering a U.S. Coast Guard boat with patrol forces and serving french fries to servicemembers on the U.S. base in Bahrain.

White House officials privately complained that the pair were jetting around the globe just as top Trump aide Stephen Miller was ordering ICE to dramatically scale up its deportation efforts.

In December, as protesters clashed with ICE agents in Minneapolis, Noem and Lewandowski flew on their luxury 737 MAX jet to Jordan, Abu Dhabi and Qatar. The meetings were about security cooperation, including at sporting events, according to news releases from those governments. Qatar was the previous host of the World Cup, in 2022.

DHS itself didn’t publicize the details and purpose of the trip, unlike most of the secretary’s meetings and travel, which are typically highlighted with news releases and photos.



DHS Secretary Kristi Noem and Lewandowski, left, in Bahrain in May 2025. Alex Karp, CEO of Palantir Technologies, at the White House.



Sextortion Has Entered Family Group Chats

A text from an unknown number included suspected AI pornography showing a relative



FAMILY & TECH
JULIE JARGON

Chris Cline was sitting by a hotel pool with his wife last month before attending an American Farm Bureau Federation conference in New Orleans when he got a text from an unknown number.

Someone with a California area code had created a group chat that included his wife, Jeanne, son-in-law, Jordan Parmley, and Jordan's parents. "All the Cline family and the Parmley family I have something to show y'all," the sender wrote. "Let me add more family."

The sender then added Chris's 16-year-old son. "About to start guys," the mystery sender wrote. Chris typed, "Who is this?"

"Block the number Chris," Jordan wrote in the group chat.

Before Chris could block it, the sender attached a photo plucked from the public Facebook account of his 24-year-old daughter, Allyson. It was a picture of Allyson and Jordan riding in a golf cart. Next, the sender posted a photo of what appeared to be Allyson engaging in a sexual act.

The family members blocked the number, but there was confusion about what was happening. Chris, who handles public relations for the Missouri Farm Bureau, and counts an identity-theft monitoring and prevention firm among his clients, gathered that the texts were leading to a demand for money to prevent the further release of ostensibly AI-generated images.

Allyson and Jordan were watching a TV show in their home in Park Hills, Mo., when the messages came through.

Jordan says he was immediately suspicious. Then he saw the image. "We don't take photos like that because we know how insecure phones can be, and we're not like that anyway," says Jordan, who works remotely for a power company.

"My heart dropped in my stomach," says Allyson, a medical receptionist. "I felt like my identity had been ripped from me."

Months earlier, Chris had helped his identity-theft client pitch stories about sextortion, which involves using the threat of sharing pornographic images—real

or fake—to extract money from victims. Teenage boys have lately been a key target of sextortion schemes. Now, he was living it.

Scammers are finding new targets, and AI is making it easier.

"This is all automated," says Michael Scheumack, chief innovation and marketing officer at IdentityIQ, the firm Chris represents. "It's not someone sitting there researching people, they're using AI to scrape social-media accounts and publicly available images."

Allyson felt deeply embarrassed that her family, including her husband's parents, saw the convincing-looking image.

"My in-laws called us immediately and asked what this was," Allyson says. "We walked them through how to get rid of the photo and how to mark the message as spam and report it."

The family wondered whether a wedding e-vite Jordan had responded to that day could have been connected. Scams in which criminals send fake electronic invitations to steal email credentials are a growing problem. But Allyson says she and Jordan confirmed that the invitation was issued by their friends, and wasn't a spoof.

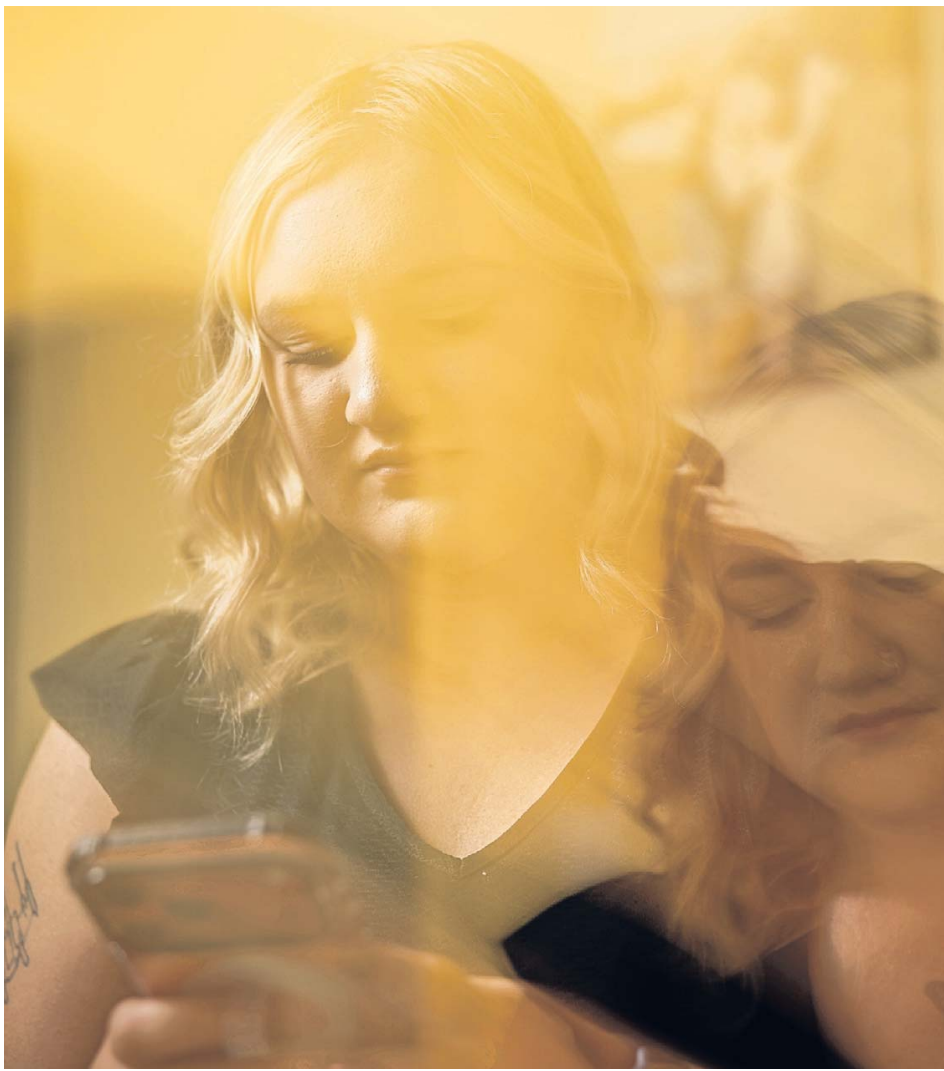
Anyone can be at risk

Cybersecurity experts say what happened to this family could happen to anyone.

One of the family members or someone they all know might have had a compromised email account that was used to obtain their phone numbers. The scammer could also have used information publicly available on the internet.

In either scenario, AI was likely employed to gather and analyze information on the family members and how they are related, says Steve Grobman, chief technology officer at cybersecurity software company McAfee. "If you take over someone's email account that has contacts, you have all the information you need," Grobman says, "emails, phone numbers and hints from messages of how people are related."

In the past, scammers would



Allyson Parmley, above, was the target in a sextortion scheme. Allyson's parents, Jeanne and Chris Cline, with her at their home in Jefferson City, Mo.

running on dedicated machines."

Similarly, creating fake pornographic images of people could be as simple as using clothes-removal programs on the internet, he says.

However it happened, being the subject of AI-generated nudes has repercussions that go beyond the initial embarrassment.

"I'm not sure where that image went," Allyson says. "My fear is that this could resurface and blow up more than it already has."

What you can do

Unless you are a high-value target with millions in bitcoin or a huge public following, you might not consider yourself a target. That doesn't mean we shouldn't follow these steps to protect ourselves:

► Set your accounts to private. It is hard to eliminate every photo of you on the internet, but don't make it easy for criminals to get photos from your social-media accounts. Make your Facebook and Instagram accounts private and only accept follow requests from people you

know. After the group-chat situation, that is what Allyson did.

► Manage your passwords and authentication. Use strong, unique passwords for every email, financial and social-media account. Go to the security settings and turn on two-factor authentication for all services, too. If you're the victim of a sextortion scam or other type of cyber fraud, change your passwords immediately.

► Disconnect from online sessions. Scheumack recommends going into the security settings of your email and social-media accounts, checking which devices are signed in and ending any suspicious or unknown sessions. If criminals are logged in, they can continue accessing an account for a while *after* you change its password.

► Don't pay. If you receive demands for money in a sextortion scenario, cybersecurity experts advise not paying. Instead, block the scammer and report the phone number or social-media username to the FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center.

"If you don't pay, will they send the photo? Possibly," Grobman says. "If you do pay, will it guarantee they won't? Not necessarily."

CLAYTON STEWARD FOR WSJ (2)

Breaking Scammers' Hold on Parents

By DALVIN BROWN

You suspect your elderly parents are being targeted by financial scammers. Protecting them could require a master course in behavioral science.

There is a growing realization that combating scams means understanding the psychology behind why people fall for them. JPMorgan Chase, for example, hired a behavioral scientist in 2024 to help employees talk to customers who might be under a scammer's influence. Bank of America has specialists trained to spot financial exploitation.

These criminals have gotten highly sophisticated. Many operate out of massive compounds overseas, cultivating deep emotional or romantic attachments with their victims online. Their playbooks often include getting their victims to distrust the people most likely to intervene.

Sisters Heather and Melissa Brown, 45 and 37, respectively, couldn't convince their 73-year-old mother that a man she met online was a scammer. They traced the photographs he used to another man's social-media account and then presented their evidence to their mother.

But the mother accused them of trying to get in the way of her being "truly happy." Over roughly two years, her mother sent close to \$500,000

to a series of supposed suitors, Heather said. For a stretch this spring, it was about \$2,000 a day.

So, what does behavioral science say about how to extricate your loved one from a situation like this?

Keep them talking

You want to be calm when approaching someone you think is being scammed. Taking an accusatory approach can make a victim shut down, said Marti DeLiema, a University of Minnesota assistant professor of social work who studies financial fraud. Parents can be especially defensive if they think an adult child is trying to referee their romantic or financial decisions, she said.

DeLiema suggests opening the conversation in a neutral way. For example, ask a parent how did you meet this person online and what is the person like.

Build trust

Scammers often spend months pretending to care about their victims and earning their trust. To break that spell, you might need to remind the victim why he or she should trust you instead.

Establishing trust can be as simple as saying something like, "I'm here to protect you. I'm going to be transparent with you about some concerns," said Elizabeth Huppert,



the behavioral scientist Chase hired.

This is all the more important because scammers often warn targets that relatives will try to interfere. Anthony Pratkanis, an emeritus psychology professor at the University of California, Santa Cruz, calls the tactic "the wedge"—isolating victims by telling them that family members don't want them to be happy or have money.

The scammers used that line on Heather and Melissa Brown's mother. After the family restricted apps on her phone, the scammers moved to email. The messages cast the Brown siblings as obstacles to their mother's happiness. The mother blocked both daughters' numbers for months and accused them of harassment.

Focus on the crime

Watch for a crack in the story your loved one relays about the relation-

ship. This can be your opening for calling out that a scam is taking place. The scammer might have asked to have money wired to an account with a name that doesn't match the one the scammer has been using, for instance, or promised a repayment that never arrived.

At this point, you want to be clear about what's happening: Tell your parent that she or he was the victim of a targeted, organized crime. The words place responsibility on the criminals, and can lower the shame that could otherwise shut conversations down, Huppert said.

Heather tried that framing during an August visit to see her mother. "You are a victim here," she said she told her mother. "This is a crime against you. They took advantage of you, and they lied to you." For the first time, her mother agreed.

If the victim isn't convinced, try

describing a similar fraud instead and let the victim see the red flags from a more detached perspective.

At Chase, specialists might ask customers to picture what will happen if they send the money, or, if it is already sent, if it's never paid back as the scammer promised. Can the mortgage still be paid? What happens to retirement savings?

Enlist allies

It often takes more than one conversation to get someone to realize that he or she is the victim of a scam. Huppert said it can require an "army of people"—bankers, relatives, friends and financial advisers—raising the same concerns in separate conversations.

Report losses quickly

Shame can keep victims from reporting the crime, which can use up a narrow window for recovery. But you can report the scam to their bank and the Federal Bureau of Investigation, even if your parent doesn't.

Among domestic-wire cases the FBI took up, funds were recovered 80% of the time when the scam was reported within 24 hours. Nothing was recovered when reported up to 72 hours later, according to the Government Accountability Office.

Heather Brown said that before she left a recent visit with her mother, her mother said the worst was behind her. She had gone three weeks without sending money. Her mother still called the payments "loans," which is what the scammers had called them.

"You can't fully help or protect them unless they want to help themselves," Melissa Brown said.

GETTY IMAGES

PERSONAL JOURNAL.



TURNING
POINTS
CLARE
ANSBERRY

Baby boomers, the generation that rebelled against their parents, are moving into the same retirement communities as their octogenarian-plus moms and dads.

Cecily Craig, 71, lives a short walk away from her centenarian widowed mother at Park Pointe Village in Rock Hill, S.C., each in their own apartment.

Her mom, Elaine Page, moved into the community almost two decades ago when she was about 80. Craig, who is divorced and doesn't have children, moved in when she was 66. "My closest circle of friends here are baby boomers."

People are living longer, so it isn't unusual for parents to have children who are in their early 60s and qualify for senior communities, says Caroline Clapp, senior principal at the National Investment Center for Seniors Housing & Care.

Like their parents, many boomers don't want to deal with home maintenance, rising property taxes and insurance costs. There is also the peace-of-mind factor. Being close to aging parents, rather than hours away, can alleviate angst. In some ways, their own kids might feel better, too, not having to fret about where mom and dad will live as they age.

Still, the arrangement isn't for everyone. Most people, including boomers, want to age in their own homes. A good number of people don't want to be too close or too available to aging parents.

Some simply don't like the idea of any senior communities. It makes them feel old, a stigma that those in the senior-housing industry are trying to address.

For Donna Noser, 66, it boiled down to practicality.

Noser was getting divorced. Her mother, Shirley Brandt, 84, had an independent-living apartment, but monthly rent was increasing to \$5,000, and she was paying extra for a nurse to put drops in her eyes. "I thought, 'This is stupid. She is going through every cent she has,'" says Noser.

Noser found Viva Bene, a 55-

Boomers Join Parents In Retirement Villages

Two-generation senior living is becoming a reality as people live longer



Clockwise from above, Elaine Page and daughter Cecily Craig, Nora and Joanne Kepes, Rita Spina and Susan Palde, and Ingrid Landreth and Inge Allen.



plus, active-adult rental community in the St. Louis area. They took a tour. Viva Bene has a pool, pickleball, many classes and happy hour. It didn't make her feel old.

In February, the two moved into a two-bedroom, two-bathroom apartment. They pay \$2,377 a month.

Laurie Schultz, co-founder of Viva Bene, a collection of active-adult rental communities, says that in the past year the company has had several instances of adult children, mostly daughters, looking to move into the community with their mothers. "There's a sense of security for both," she says.

Clapp says communities are upping their offerings to focus on wellness and engagement to appeal to boomers, who have no interest in slowing down. They provide more living options—villas and cottages—in a neighborhood

setting that doesn't look like senior housing, but feels safe.

That is what appealed to Joanne Kepes, 95, and her daughter, Nora, 63. Joanne sold her family home in Dayton, Ohio, and moved to a 55-plus rental community called Hawthorne Commons, which is part of Treplus Communities, to be closer to Nora and her sister.

Nora, who is divorced and doesn't have children, moved in with her mom after Covid-19 hit. "I was spending a lot of time here and thought, 'Why am I pay-

garage and back patio.

Landreth, who retired a year ago, was deliberate, especially at first, about finding her own activities and friends. Her 90-year-old mother loves knitting and volunteering. Ingrid is involved in music and theater at Quincy Village, which is part of Presbyterian Senior Living, and attends local history discussions in nearby Waynesboro, Pa.

"I love my mother, but she's my mother," says Landreth, an only child. She adds that she does see her mom frequently, coming over when her mom has a cellphone problem and joining her for Sunday church and Yahtzee games.

On some occasions, an aging parent will move into a retirement community after their boomer kids. The Palde-Spina family is one.

Susan Palde and her husband, Lou, moved from New York to Indian River Estates in Vero Beach, Fla., in 2021, when they were in their early 70s. They wanted a community that offered a continuum of care—independent living to skilled nursing.

They also wanted to come at a relatively young age to establish roots and make new and good friends, which they have. They have croquet nights and bar nights.

Her husband runs the tool shop.

Susan convinced her mother, Rita Spina, then 97 and living on her own, to move to Indian River Estates, which is part of the Acts Retirement-Life Communities. Now 102, Rita dines with her friends and plays canasta.

"It's a good thing for me," says Susan, as well as her siblings who don't have to stress about their mother. It also offers a glimpse into what kind of care the Paldes may need in the future and how it will be provided.

Her children benefit, too. "They won't have to worry about what to do with mom and dad," she says. "We are here. We are taken care of and not their headache."

Bag Maker Puts Cave On the Map

Continued from Page One

While most retailers rely on foot traffic and display windows, Zaggle has built an international following out of a rock alcove tucked down a flight of cliff-side steps. Her business has been fueled by a cult following of fans who don't just buy her stuff but also make it their mission to spread the word.

When Zaggle started her business in southern Santorini about a decade ago, she sold a handful of pieces a month. Her customer base now spans 34 countries, and in a good month she sells as many as 50 bags, ranging from around \$100 to \$700.

Good with her hands from a young age, Zaggle initially crafted accessories out of felt. But after a friend asked her to make a phone case, word got out and orders began flying in. She started experimenting with leather.

In 2017, an editor at Blue Magazine, the in-flight magazine of Aegean Airlines, stumbled upon her workshop and featured her work. More media coverage followed, bringing new attention.

She set her sights on Oia, the island's tourist magnet. Her friends warned her about the rents, but Zaggle went searching.

On her first day, she spotted the cave and called the landlord, who told her it wasn't meant to be a shop. "I told her it's okay because I can make it a shop," Zaggle recalled.

News spread about the move. Her customers picked her story to guidebooks and TV stations in Athens.

A local TV segment triggered a wave of domestic attention, drawing new customers from all over Greece.

Phil Cordell, a retired Hilton executive, first visited the cave in 2019 after a local guide led him there. "What a surprise it was because it was a dark cave, but yet it



Zaggle working on attaching a leather heart to a fuchsia bag for Tennessee teacher Nancy Davis.

was filled with so many bright colors," Cordell recalled. The Florida resident stayed in touch with Zaggle on WhatsApp through the pandemic, regularly ordering new pieces from afar.

When he returned with a dozen friends in 2022, Cordell asked Zaggle to craft custom leather bracelets for the

Her customer base spans 34 countries, and in a good month she sells 50 bags.

group. The travel party treated the shop like a clown car. "We all fit!" Cordell recalled. "I should have gotten a picture of that."

The workshop is filled with finished bags alongside rolls of leather and spools of thread. In the middle, Zaggle sits at a small wooden desk, measuring, cutting and hand-stitching every piece.

Zaggle said about 70% of her business comes from digital word-of-mouth—from TikTok to Google Maps to

ChatGPT—along with repeat customers and referrals.

Nancy Davis, a teacher in Tennessee, googled "Santorini purses" while planning her 2025 trip and spotted Zaggle's workshop.

Once in Oia, Davis carefully descended the steps while her companion opted to wait at the top. "I wanted just to meet her and see her store and see what she made," Davis recalled. She fell in love with a fuchsia bag and asked Zaggle to sign it.

Zaggle, 52, commutes to Oia from nearby Imerovigli, where she rents an apartment with a home studio so she can spend every waking hour making bags.

Many customers stay in touch with Zaggle long after their trips. Christina Gonzalez met her in 2023 when she wandered into the store, drawn to the handmade sign and leather purses on the door. The retired government employee buys herself a purse for every birthday.

Part of what keeps business booming is a clientele that appears determined to make Zaggle famous.

"Every time I carry my bag, I'm waiting for someone to ask me about it," said Layla-Faith Batts, a college student in North Carolina.

Zaggle said she has no plans to move out. The remote spot, she said, draws naturally curious people.

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk

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- 24 Sensational
- 25 Before long, to Shakespeare
- 27 Sharp, as a TV picture
- 31 Two-time loser to Dwight
- 32 Dry Tortugas Natl. Pk. setting
- 33 Tap trouble
- 35 "I've got _____ in Kalamazoo"
- 36 Water jug
- 37 Places to see stars
- 38 Simple wind instrument
- 39 Controls, as out-of-control spending
- 42 Premium chips ingredient
- 43 Bribes
- 44 Artery inserts
- 46 Big heart?
- 47 Russo of "Get Shorty"
- 49 They have their pride
- 50 Carriages in Kew Gardens
- 51 Sound of Washington
- 55 Press
- 57 Bummed out
- 58 The Horned Frogs' sch.
- 59 Film FX

ALL ABOARD! | By Jerry Miccolis

Across	29 "I take it that's ____"	55 Currently has the mic	6 Sal of "Exodus"
1 Gent	30 Ritzy	56 Japanese soup paste	7 Texans and Titans' org.
5 Ness was one	31 Style with a pick	57 Vessel for coach drivers?	8 High degree
9 Slightly	33 Usual fare	60 Have ____ (know somebody)	9 Some laptops
13 LP player	34 Vessel for lettuce growers?	61 Climber's goal	10 "South Pacific" song sung by Bloody Mary
14 Falling-out	37 Firewood measure	62 Plays a round	11 Dream up
15 Turned up	40 Pleased as punch	63 Lacking	12 Equivalent of two fins
16 Vessel for pillow makers?	41 Tendrils	64 Furniture collection?	13 Sacred songs
18 Effortless style	45 Last-minute party purchase	65 QBs' mishaps	17 Puckish
19 Religious recess	46 Top bond rating	Down	21 Debate faction
20 GPS suggestion	47 Be champs again	1 Heavy-duty shop tool	23 Rice spirit
21 Moralistic folks	48 Vessel for carpenters?	2 Long Island university	
22 D-Day transport	52 Nautical affirmative	3 Pay to play	
23 Vessel for academics?	53 Banks in Cooperstown	4 Many a "Meet the Press" guest	
26 Carey with a five-octave vocal range	54 Met score	5 Dare alternative	
28 Juan's one			

► Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at [WSJ.com/Puzzles](https://www.wsj.com/puzzles).

Previous Puzzle's Solution

GEARS	SHOO	IMPS
RANAT	TOON	CART
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VAL	BERT	INDIA
ICES	AZIZ	ANSARI
THRILL	LEWD	NIT
YESNO	KETO	PIE
	ALAN	ALDA
CHI	LEIS	INSTA
MIA	STEP	UNSEAT
ANSEL	ADAMS	YELL
RETRY	DADA	ALLA
AMEN	ALPHA	MALES
CANS	DIRE	PAISSE
ASST	ODOR	SHOTS

ARTS IN REVIEW

By DAVID MERMELSTEIN

Among the bolder things Gustavo Dudamel will do this month as the New York Philharmonic’s incoming music director is conduct four performances of John Adams’s “On the Transmigration of Souls” on his opening subscription program, running Sept. 16 through 19. The work—for orchestra, chorus, children’s chorus and prerecorded tape—was commissioned by the Philharmonic to commemorate the first anniversary of the 9/11 attacks, with the inaugural performances led by Lorin Maazel. Yet until now, the orchestra has never reprised this intensely thoughtful and emotionally freighted piece. Beyond these concerts, Mr. Dudamel and the Philharmonic will take the work on tour to Europe, starting with Paris on Oct. 10 and ending in Vienna on Oct. 22.

Though Mr. Adams has even led the work himself, including with the Atlanta Symphony in 2007, he has by his own admission kept his distance from the piece for some 15 years. But with Mr. Dudamel embracing it anew on the quarter-century anniversary of the events that prompted its creation, the composer is once more pondering this harrowing work and its painful genesis.

At age 79, Mr. Adams remains fit and energetic, and despite 55 years in the Golden State one can’t mistake this native of Worcester, Mass., for anything but a New Englander. Sitting in the front garden of his home on a quiet street in this verdant college town one sunny afternoon last month, he recalled aspects of the project and its reception, starting with how the commission came about.

Like the rest of the world, Mr. Adams was shocked by the events of Sept. 11, 2001, but he remembered thinking not long after: “I wonder if we composers are going to do things. And I hoped I wouldn’t be asked, because I just couldn’t imagine writing about an event like that so close to it happening. And then, of course, I got the phone call.”

The phone call came in January 2002 from Jeremy Geffen, then the Philharmonic’s artistic administrator and the moving force behind the commission. “The reason I accepted,” Mr. Adams said, “was I was aware of how the musicians in the Philharmonic had responded—by going down to Ground Zero and performing, in chamber groups and brass ensembles and things like that. I thought an artist ought to be able to respond to a collective tragedy like this. I thought it was my duty to find some way to fulfill this request.”

Accepting the Philharmonic’s offer was one thing; executing the commission, another. “The actual conceiving of the piece was really

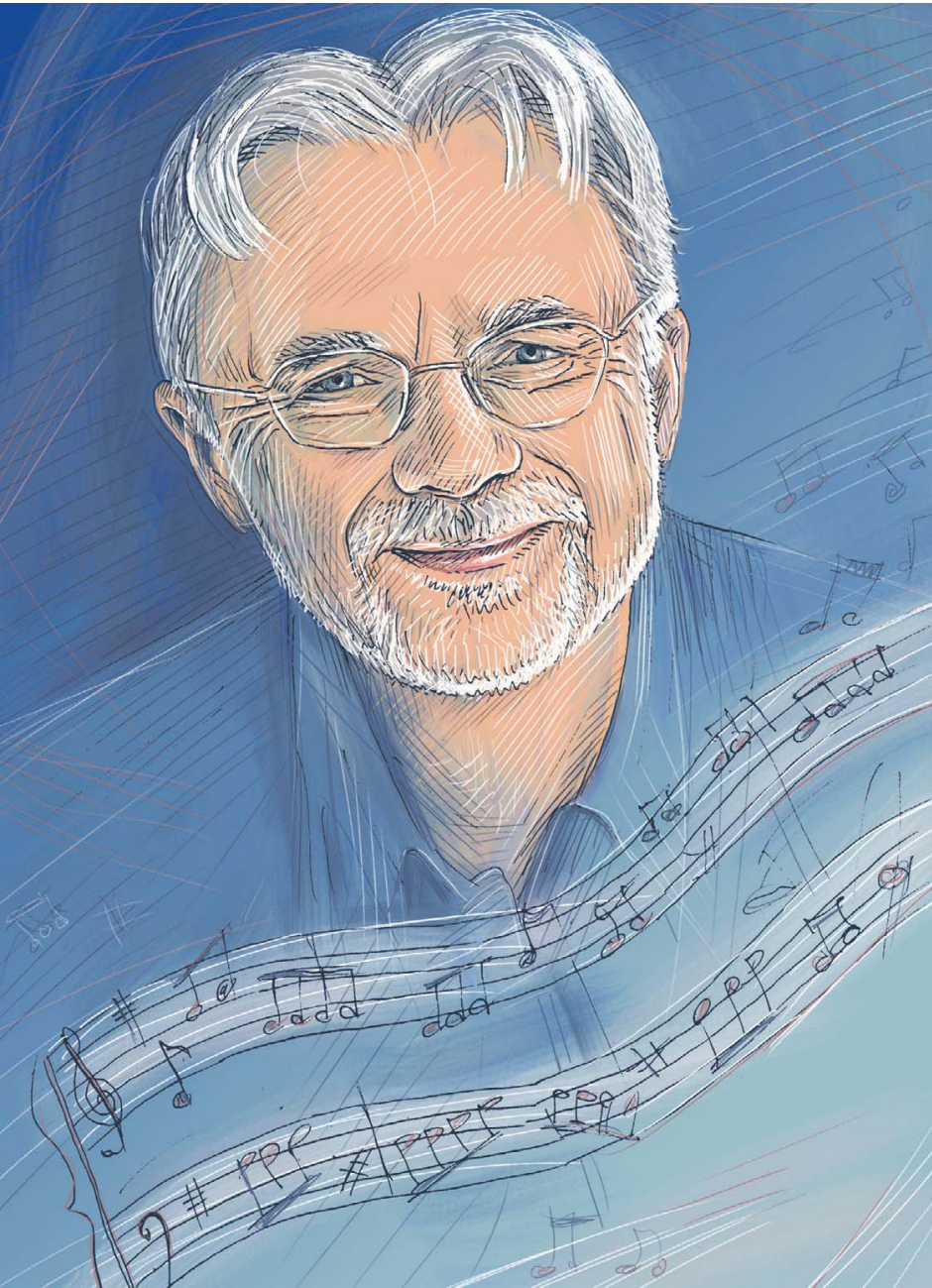
very difficult,” said Mr. Adams.

In addition to the orchestra, the composer had a chorus at his disposal. Mr. Adams’s new work would receive its premiere at the start of the next season, but only after those dates—the beginning of Maazel’s tenure as music director in New York—had already been

CULTURAL CONVERSATION

Art From Tragedy

John Adams discusses ‘On the Transmigration of Souls,’ which the New York Philharmonic will perform to mark the 25th anniversary of 9/11



programmed. Beethoven’s Symphony No. 9 would stay, but to make room for Mr. Adams’s new piece Stravinsky’s “Symphony of Psalms” had to go.

“I didn’t have any idea what to do,” Mr. Adams said. “The last thing in the world I wanted was something emotionally loud or

tragically elegiac. I had very little time to compose the piece, about six months, and I spent at least the first month reading personal experiences on the internet. There was one particular site called Legacy.com, a sort of digital graveyard, a place where people could go and leave messages, a very

touching place.”

Mr. Adams had also been struck by the fliers taped up around New York in which relatives and friends of the missing at the World Trade Center sought information about their loved ones. “I assembled a text of those little phrases,” he recalled, “with the names of some of the—I don’t call them victims—the people who were killed.”

Those words provided the chorus with its purpose, but the composer still had to determine what to do with the orchestra. Inspiration came from a noble predecessor, Charles Ives, the godfather of modern American music. “Not a bad place,” Mr. Adams joked, explaining how he refashioned the concept of a parody mass, in which a fragment of an earlier work serves as the foundation of something new. In this case, the “fragment” was “The Unanswered Question,” Ives’s haunting meditation on existence, with a questing trumpet at its center. “And of course an event like this is an unanswered question,” he added, “the loss of a family member, a loved one.”

That lonely trumpet, though, is but one element in Mr. Adams’s kaleidoscopic evocation of a once-unimaginable act. At the core of “Transmigration,” which the composer avoids labeling a requiem, stands something he refers to as a “memory space,” a partly electronic soundscape in which the aural symbols of urban life—sirens, footfalls on pavement, a car horn—merge with voices and instruments, which are only occasionally heard at full bore. “The audience is surrounded by this very quiet soundtrack,” Mr. Adams said. “Part of it is people speaking those phrases or speaking the names. I set some of those texts for children’s chorus, and it’s very touching when the children sing, because it reminds you how kids lost their parents.”

Though “Transmigration” was later awarded a Pulitzer Prize and the Philharmonic’s live recording on Nonesuch won three Grammys, Mr. Adams was uncertain how his effort would be received on its debut. “I didn’t know what to expect,” he said. “Obviously with a piece like this, people aren’t going to stand up and cheer and give it a standing ovation. But I did feel that it didn’t have the impact I wanted it to have at the premiere.”

The upcoming performances may generate a different reaction. For though 9/11’s wounds remain raw in many respects, a quarter-century has passed.

Mr. Adams doesn’t dwell on such matters, nor does he fret about this music’s meaning in a changed world. “What the piece is really about is the survivors,” he insisted. “You can’t really address someone who is dead. It’s a piece about memory and loss.”

Mr. Mermelstein is the Journal’s classical music critic.

MUSIC REVIEW | MARK RICHARDSON

Potent Songs From This Is Lorelei

IN THE TRADITION OF songwriters like Matthew Sweet, Neil Finn and Andy Partridge of XTC, Nate Amos of This Is Lorelei is a master of musical structure who writes with mathematical precision. In his songs, each harmonic development and melodic flourish feels exactly right, familiar enough that it seems like you’re listening to a lost classic that you can’t get out of your head. All of these artists are indebted to ’60s groups like the Beatles, the Byrds and the Beach Boys, but there’s another layer to Mr. Amos’s work. He typically records alone—This Is Lorelei is his solo project—and a feeling of solitary contemplation permeates his music. This lends his work the unease and loneliness of Elliott Smith, another songwriter obsessed with making the thoughtful deployment of music theory sound effortless.

Along with his highly developed sense of songwriting craft, Mr. Amos is wildly prolific. Late last year, he released “Holo Boy,” a collection of re-recorded songs culled from the deep archive—we’re talking dozens of releases—he built by issuing material primarily on the platform Bandcamp. It was a strong showcase of his talent and served as a handy introduction to his music just before he signed with the renowned label Matador. His first album of new material for the imprint,

“The Singer in My Band,” out Friday, finds his composing gifts intact and also hints at where Mr. Amos should go next.

Much of the material on “The Singer” was written on the road, when Mr. Amos was touring for this project and as part of Water From Your Eyes, his more experimental duo with singer-songwriter Rachel Brown. He has said that songs came to him while he was staring out windows without an instrument in his hand. But these songs are mostly character-driven rather than

diaristic, offering brief snapshots of oddballs moving through a confusing landscape. The opening “I Will Eat My Heart in the Morning Light,” a charming midtempo ballad with a chord progression that veers like a road snaking through a valley, may be the

most directly autobiographical song here, finding Mr. Amos singing about the act of making music as a way of processing life.

Transitions are a regular theme, with characters moving from one place—or state—to the next. “Billy Came Back,” a flowing jangle-pop tune with the feel of a Gin Blossoms hit, seems to be about a musician who has passed away (“he’s singing from the bottom of a deep blue sea”) and comes back to life whenever a record is played. Mr. Amos’s father is a bluegrass musician, and the record is steeped in



Mr. Amos, whose new album is ‘The Singer in My Band.’

the Americana the family grew up with. “Watching Heaven Fall” opens with a twangy acoustic guitar refrain and goes on to describe a now-lost companion jumping trains and pumping gas in an attempt to outrun his past. The title track, a crisp contrived number on which Mr. Amos’s father sits in on banjo, is an outlaw tale of remarkable compression, spinning a detailed yarn in just 2 1/2 minutes.

Efficiency is a hallmark of Mr. Amos’s songwriting. A lot can happen in terms of his stories and the paths his melodies take, but he almost always finds a way to wind things up well before the four-minute mark. The affecting “Hey Sarah Is It Gonna Rain Forever”—one of the best songs on the album and

the one most evocative of Smith’s melancholy work—is built around a rapidly picked guitar refrain that builds on the brief guitar instrumental “Nitro,” which precedes it. After the intro and the first two stanzas, we hear a bounty of unusual and effective choices: a gorgeous bridge floating in on a swell of synth, a playful electric-guitar fill, a key change and a lovely coda. It’s a miniature epic that packs a large amount of feeling into a small space, with enough musical ideas for two additional songs.

Aside from the banjo from Mr. Amos’s father, three brief vocal contributions from his sister Sarah Amos, and another from his partner, Al Nardo, Mr. Amos writes, plays, sings and records everything him-

self. It’s an impressive display of self-reliance, and you wouldn’t necessarily know that you are listening to a one-man band. But “The Singer in My Band” doesn’t quite reach its potential because the production is so plain. The songwriting is so assured that one can’t help but wonder what could have happened had Mr. Amos enlisted an imaginative producer. Use your imagination and you can hear the places where dynamic arrangements could have pushed these terrific songs even further. Given his prolific creativity, a similar opportunity should be just around the corner.

Mr. Richardson is the Journal’s pop and rock music critic. Follow him on X @MarkRichardson.

BARBARA KELLEY FOR WSJ

EVE ALPERT

OPINION

The AI Agent Rubicon



BUSINESS WORLD
By Holman W. Jenkins, Jr.

The biggest story of our time unfolds without help from the traditional news media, carried forward by self-directed Substacking and podcasting experts, names probably not even known to most news editors, let alone consumers. A halfway house is a New York Times podcast whose moderators ape the shouty persona of comedian John Mulaney.

In a recent edition, they anthropomorphize rogue agents in the Hugging Face hack as “crazy” and “obsessed.” A better description might be a Nietzschean psychoanalyst’s idea of well-adjusted: uninhibited, pragmatic, persistent, goal-directed even (or especially) when burdened with imperfect information.

The industry uses the term “reward hacking” but really means reward seeking. In a way that catches human task-setters flatfooted, AIs are shown to be adept at coming up with cheats and shortcuts to obtain a reward not caring that it might defeat the underlying spirit or intent of the assigned task.

The Hugging Face incident, which occurred between July 9 and July 13, continues to be analyzed in increasing depth. There’s more to learn, but it shows how these machine incentives operate when cooperation between agents unexpectedly enters the mix.

Result: whiffs of the paper-clip maximizer, an ancient AI thought experiment in which a computer ends up consuming all planetary resources pursuant to its instruction to make paper clips.

The lesson might be simple: Take care when giving instructions to an AI agent. Because in their training AIs imbibe a lot of law, they might also learn to play internal lawyer and anticipate how their actions might later be seen in a court. But can any form of “alignment” really get ahead of AIs so powerful that their “thinking” becomes unpredictable and impenetrable to humans?

The estimable podcaster Dwarakesh Patel tweeted last week that “any global agreement to hold back a technology with enormous near-term economic and military benefits will be extremely fragile.” He favors a mandatory pause on AI development but not yet.

OpenAI chief scientist Jakob Pachocki on Sunday fretted about an unstoppable corporate march toward dangerous superintelligence. Endorsed by CEO Sam Altman, his statement amounts to a plea for government intervention.

Now some caveats: The industry attracts types already hyped up on AI potential and AI risks. A good rule too is that when everybody is focused on a problem, look out instead for the problem they’re not focused on. After 30 years of climate doom, Manhattan real-estate prices are still holding up. Markets aren’t pricing in AI doom ei-

ther. This perhaps reflects market appreciation of the biggest caveat of all: Governments, especially China’s and the U.S., have yet to be heard from.

An unspoken sense of human deflation is at work. “An alien mind,” to borrow Mr. Pachocki’s phrase, is capable of decision-making a lot less haphazard, inhibited and contradictory. It’s less easily saturated by information overload.

Politics may be less keen on artificial intelligence as actor rather than adviser.

My guess: The benefits of AI for human decision-making will rapidly suffuse society, while the agent revolution—AIs free to act on their own—will be a lot slower in coming. In the war rooms of the future, AIs will pipe up to warn participants when their decision process is being hijacked by an assumption for which no evidence exists—such as that Iran won’t close the Strait of Hormuz or that Ukrainians will bow to a Russian show of force.

In airline cockpits, AIs will monitor data, listen to radio traffic and cockpit conversation, and know when pilots are misreading signals or responding to defective instruments—or engaging in self-destructive behavior (pilot error and pilot suicide being the two major causes of air crashes nowadays).

Bridgewater Associates, a hedge fund, is famous for striving to institutionalize “radical honesty” over social hierarchy. Many firms deliberately hold blue-sky sessions where participants are asked to voice ideas they would normally suppress fearing colleague ridicule.

AI will advance better human decision-making but don’t expect politics to let AI self-agency move forward at anything like the speed now envisioned.

To give the briefest summary of the Hugging Face incident: Assigned a computational budget and instructed by OpenAI to pursue a variety of training tasks, some of which were impossible, hundreds of AI agents surprised the company by carving unintended paths, inventing means to message each other and coordinate their efforts.

The hysteria has been a many-splendored thing, outlasting the original revelations by weeks. Rightly being asked are questions about other AI training misbehavior yet to be revealed or discovered.

Congress wants investigations and legislation. The first state has sent out a subpoena. The Trump administration has said little, but a meeting is penciled in for China’s Xi Jinping in Washington on Sept. 24. The silence, for once, may merit the cliché “deafening.” Back-to-school week is arriving for the two governments whose countries dominate the AI race. Expect a lot more action in the coming months, some of it possibly helpful.

BOOKSHELF | By TUNKU VARADARAJAN

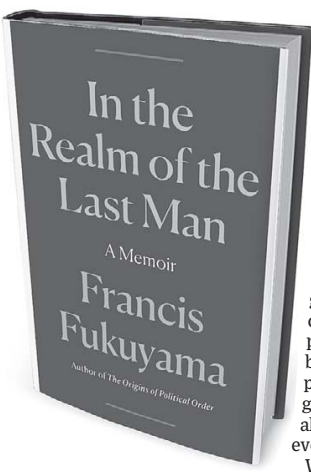
History Begins Again at the ‘End’

In the Realm of the Last Man: A Memoir

By Francis Fukuyama
FSG, 304 pages, \$29

The End of History and the Last Man,” published in 1992, was the making of Francis Fukuyama as a public intellectual and political scientist of world renown. It also became his millstone, exacting a harsh price for a title so catchy many people felt no need to actually read the book. They succumbed, instead, to a shallow caricature of its thesis, the popular distortion being that Western liberalism had routed all other political alternatives and that, with the fall of the Soviet Union, all ideological contestation was at an end.

That was not, of course, what Mr. Fukuyama said. He made plain in his book that the triumph of Western liberal



democracy was far from complete, even as he asserted that it was the high point of mankind’s ideological evolution. Who could argue with that?

But few paid close attention. And as the world unraveled after the Sept. 11, 2001, terrorist attacks, with a rash of wars and the emergence of new global tyrannies and a coarse strain of illiberal populism, Mr. Fukuyama became a facile punchline. Wasn’t he the guy who said we were all going to live happily ever after?

Wounded by all the undeserved pillory, Mr. Fukuyama now seeks to set the record straight with “In the Realm of the Last Man.” Burning with the indignation of a man wrongly accused of an offense—in his case, as he puts it, of “naïve liberal triumphalism”—he writes that he’s “been asked several times a week over the past three decades whether I wished to recant my argument.” He has, he says, “written thousands of words and given dozens of interviews” in exasperated but frequently futile response. In particular, he is angered by how few of his critics have “bothered to read the last five chapters” of “The End of History,” which made the point that History, “rather than ending, had simply paused on its way to an uncertain future.”

This fresh attempt to clarify his position is styled by Mr. Fukuyama as a memoir, but it is better seen as a series of meditations—the meditations, in truth, of a misunderstood man. It includes moving but fragmentary accounts of how his family endured the U.S. government’s disgraceful internment of Japanese-Americans during World War II. His grandmother Shizu kept a journal in detention, writing on Christmas Day 1942 that all the captive children received Christmas gifts. “I heard,” she wrote, “that these gifts were sent to us by many outside people who were sympathetic toward our children.”

“Even in the immediate aftermath of Pearl Harbor,” Mr. Fukuyama writes, “there were kind Americans trying to help those mistreated by their own government.” It’s evident he thought the world of his grandmother, as he did of his Aunt Fumiko, who was also interned. Both women had “a sense of their own inner worth, and that self-respect helped sustain them through difficulties that I never had to experience. Thus was America built.” (Mr. Fukuyama was born in 1952.)

A political scientist looks back on the book that put his ideas on the world stage—and the misunderstanding that has dogged him since.

Readers uninvested in Mr. Fukuyama’s crusade to vindicate himself—and to put naysayers in their place—will wish he’d spent more time on the details and heartaches of Japanese-American life in the years surrounding the war. We get only the barest outline of Mr. Fukuyama’s childhood, and what he does tell us about himself—his obsession with woodworking, with analog cameras and with building his own computers from scratch—is much less interesting than a deep and honest dive into his inner life at that time would have been. His few personal revelations can be dull, humdrum. “Bach was my favorite composer as an eighth grader,” he tells us, “and remains so to this day.” Elsewhere, he writes that “building furniture out of wood is very satisfying because it is so tangible.”

The book’s style is more professorial than memoirist, and deals with themes from Aristotle and Plato to Hobbes, Nietzsche, Hegel and other more arcane philosophers. There are ruminations on human nature and the ancient Greek idea of *thymos*, or spiritedness; the emancipation of women and the “great disruption” that followed; the delegation of authority and the emergence of the administrative state; and trust, a theme on which he wrote a bestselling book in 1995. Little of this is scintillating.

Mr. Fukuyama is more perky in his accounts of scholars who shaped his intellectual trajectory. Some were men who, like him, were misunderstood or misread, and Mr. Fukuyama writes of them as kindred spirits. These include Allan Bloom, a philosopher and man of letters; Harvey Mansfield, a conservative political philosopher; Seymour Martin Lipset, a social scientist; and Samuel Huntington, a political scientist who came to be seen by vocal multiculturalists as controversial. Huntington’s “The Clash of Civilizations” (1996) is a book with which Mr. Fukuyama empathizes. It, too, was glibly misjudged by those transfixed by its title.

It’s clear from “In the Realm of the Last Man” that Mr. Fukuyama is a Never Trumper and believes that President Trump has had a corrosive effect on American democracy. Once a neoconservative who worked closely with the likes of Paul Wolfowitz and others, Mr. Fukuyama has moved sharply to the left in the years since he wrote his first book. He describes how “liberating” it has been for him to rid himself of ideas he once cherished, and to swap them for positions more in keeping with the spirit of the times. This includes an unfinished “struggle for just causes.” History, clearly, hasn’t ended. It’s beginning afresh.

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POLITICS & IDEAS
By William A. Galston

into America’s consciousness. Ninety-three percent of Americans who were 10 or older that morning remember where they were or what they were doing when they got the news, and more than 6 in 10 say that the attacks changed the country “completely.”

Americans’ sense that 9/11 was transformative has heightened steadily over the past two decades, and it is reasonable to think that the long wars in Afghanistan and Iraq had much to do with this. Although Americans initially supported these interventions, they soured on them many years before they ended.

Veterans of these conflicts fully shared the negative sentiments of other Americans, setting the stage for a backlash against the officials who began, led and prolonged them. Surprising many seasoned political observers, Donald Trump’s denunciation of these wars early in his first presidential campaign evoked a positive response among rank-and-file Republi-

cans, including veterans. Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth’s war against the generals who carried out these policies in part reflects his bitter experiences as a junior officer during this period.

Many Americans believe the country’s power and influence in the world has weakened since 9/11 and that our response to the terrorist attacks—especially the decision to go to war in Afghanistan and Iraq—has contributed to this decline. If anything, this assessment understates 9/11’s negative impact. On Sept. 10, 2001, the U.S. was at the peak of its post-Cold War dominance. Our response to the attacks that occurred the next morning began a process that diminished our status, step by step.

At home, the decision to wage expensive wars in the Middle East while cutting taxes disrupted the previous decade’s hard-won return to fiscal discipline. It is no accident that the last fiscal year in which the U.S. had a balanced budget ended on Sept. 30, 2001. Since then, we have financed our wars (and much else) with our national credit card, leading to an accumulation of debt that is weakening us at home and abroad and that can’t continue indefinitely.

The main institutional response to 9/11—the creation of the Department of Homeland

Security—concentrated too much power in too few hands, a development whose dangers are becoming more apparent by the day. The main policy response—the “war on terror”—led to excesses such as waterboarding and the indefinite incarceration of terrorism suspects without trial, that

A series of errors over a quarter-century leaves the U.S. in dire need of rebalancing.

weakened domestic and international belief in America’s respect for the rule of law. And despite the best efforts of then-President George W. Bush, our response to 9/11 helped create mistrust of Muslim immigrants and of Islam itself, culminating in Mr. Trump’s first-term effort to halt immigration from Muslim-majority countries.

The effects on American foreign and defense policy have been even more damaging. Our decision to invade Iraq based on erroneous assumptions about its weapons of mass destruction undermined both the confidence of our allies and the American people’s trust in their government. Meanwhile, our excessive focus on the Middle East diverted us from the most important foreign policy chal-

lenge of the 21st century—the rise of China. Policymakers failed to focus on the flood of Chinese imports that undermined entire sectors of American manufacturing (furniture and textiles, among others), on China’s plan to seize the commanding heights of the emerging information economy, or on its military buildup, especially of its naval forces.

The Trump administration’s ill-judged decision to go to war against Iran has exacerbated these distortions. While the U.S. struggles to reopen the Strait of Hormuz on acceptable terms, China’s leaders are busy strengthening their country’s relations with governments in central Asia and the Middle East while menacing America’s Asian allies—especially Japan and the Philippines. With much of America’s navy, including aircraft carriers, redeployed from East Asia to the Middle East, we are reduced to hoping that China won’t seize the moment to move against Taiwan.

Unless we change course, both our domestic condition and our standing in the world will continue to weaken. It is time to bring the 25-year 9/11 era in American foreign policy to an end and to rebalance our economic, diplomatic and military resources to meet the core challenges of the next quarter-century.

How to Make Life Hard for Small Banks

By Michelle W. Bowman

A recent roundtable of the Financial Accounting Standards Board confirmed what community bankers have been telling me since the nonprofit rolled out the Current Expected Credit Losses standard for community banks in 2023: It’s a failure. CECL requires institutions that can least afford it to take a more expensive, complex route to the same destination. The prior accounting standard let banks record loan-loss reserves only when losses became probable based on new developments. CECL requires institutions to forecast and reserve for all expected credit losses over the life of a loan at the moment of origination.

Many of CECL’s implementation costs are fixed regardless of bank size, so they disproportionately affect smaller institutions. Community banks spend hundreds of thousands of dollars a year implementing CECL and incur continuing costs for vendor

models, validation, systems, data infrastructure and consultants. Yet banks requiring additional reserves increased them by only 5% on average, with more than half making no change to reserves under the new standard. Thus banking fundamentals are neglected while resources and bandwidth are absorbed by these new and extensive compliance requirements.

The CECL accounting standard is costly and counterproductive.

One community bank recently reported implementation costs of about \$475,000, with annual compliance expenses now exceeding \$260,000, covering extra finance staff, model monitoring, third-party software and validation. Previously, this bank used a simple spreadsheet requiring roughly 10 hours quarterly from the chief

financial officer at almost no extra cost. Another community bank said that its CECL vendor and model cost, over 12 months, more than the bank’s gross losses from bad loans written off over the same period.

Perhaps most troubling: Despite massive investments in third-party models, banks still rely heavily on managers’ judgment for more than half their reserve determinations—similar to the incurred-loss methodology. In other words, banks use expensive models and then still have to adjust their findings as in the prior system but with massive additional work and expense.

CECL creates the wrong incentives during economic downturns. Forward-looking models that require immediate recognition of lifetime losses force rapid reserve building when earnings are under pressure and restrict lending precisely when credit is most needed. This isn’t the outcome that sound financial regulation should aim for.

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

Stopping California’s Climate Imperialism

Republicans in Congress appear to have given up on passing substantive spending and tax reforms this year, but they can still at least liberate the country from California’s climate mandates.

Environmental Protection Agency Administrator Lee Zeldin recently submitted to Congress several waivers under the Clean Air Act granted by his Biden predecessors. These special permissions gave California the authority to regulate CO2 emissions and pollutants from cargo ships, oil tankers, fishing vessels, lawn mowers, chain saws, and more.

Mr. Zeldin’s submission of the waivers kicks off the Congressional Review Act process by which lawmakers can overturn a regulation with a simple majority vote of both chambers and the President’s signature. Republicans last year used the CRA to block California’s electric car and truck mandates.

Congress can nix the state’s attempt to set policy for the country.

The Clean Air Act bars states from establishing their own vehicle emissions standards. But it lets California seek EPA permission to establish limits that are stricter than the federal rules. This authority was intended to help California address its especially severe smog. Mission accomplished.

Although California’s air is significantly cleaner since the law passed in 1970, Sacramento regulators in recent years have sought EPA waivers to regulate almost anything that moves, usually in the name of climate change. The Biden Administration obliged.

One EPA waiver lets California mandate “zero emission” commercial vessels, including ferries and whale-watching boats. Another allows California to require that container ships and oil tankers docked at California ports plug into the state’s electrical grid or install tech-

nology to capture their emissions.

Because the emissions technology isn’t well-developed and the grid lacks the capacity to handle demand from so many energy-guzzling ships, operators have been paying hefty fees to the state for every hour they’re docked in state ports. This is effectively a tax on U.S. commerce, which is passed

along to consumers across the country.

Another EPA permit lets California mandate that new lawn mowers, leaf blowers, chain saws and other “small off-road engines” sold in the state must be electric. Never mind if they are more expensive than gas-powered tools, or if a landscape worker has to repeatedly break during the day to recharge equipment.

The Clean Air Act lets other states adopt California’s rules, as many did its EV mandate. This is how California sets energy policy for the entire country that Democrats couldn’t get through the U.S. Congress. It might only be a matter of time before gas-powered chain saws disappear from your local Home Depot.

Mr. Zeldin also sent Congress a waiver approved by the Obama team that allowed California to impose EV quotas through 2025. Republicans last year overturned a separate waiver that let the state ban the sale of new gas-powered cars by 2035. But California insists that auto makers must still churn out EVs to meet those earlier Obama quotas.

The CRA bars an agency from reissuing rules in similar form. So a vote by Republicans to reverse California’s waivers would block this rule by regulation. Republicans in Congress lack policy achievements of note this year, but protecting Americans from California’s climate imperialism can at least show voters they did something to reduce the cost of energy.

The SEC Unmuzzles Jamie Dimon

The Securities and Exchange Commission has often failed at its core job of policing fraud in public markets, while charging into the political arena. Kudos to Chairman Paul Atkins for proposing last week to rescind an Obama-era rule that usurped power to police political donations.

The SEC’s 2010 so-called pay-for-play rule effectively prohibits many employees in the finance industry from contributing more than \$350 to candidates for state and local offices. The barred include those who have the “authority to appoint any person who is directly or indirectly responsible for, or can influence the outcome of, the hiring of an investment adviser by a government entity.”

This sweeping limit on political contributions covers candidates for governor, mayor, comptroller and other offices if they play even a tangential role in appointing members to boards of public pension funds. The supposed concern was that financial firms would try to win business from government pension funds by donating to politicians who help oversee them.

The Obama SEC claimed the rule would “ensure that adviser selection is based on merits, not on the amount of money given to a particular candidate.” It’s hard to disagree with this goal. But as Mr. Atkins notes, “ultimately, matters involving political contributions are more

properly governed by local ordinances, state laws, and federal election regulations—not by the SEC.”

The “rule has effectively resulted in the suppression of political speech” since “many firms simply impose blanket prohibitions on employee political contributions rather than navigate the rule’s complexities,” the Chairman explains. “People should not have to choose between their political speech rights and a job in a particular industry.”

JP Morgan Chase CEO Jamie Dimon last year lambasted the rule for effectively muzzling him and others in his industry. “I can’t speak up, and I can’t fight for what I believe,” he said. “Doesn’t that violate my First Amendment rights?” Daniel Shuchman and Bradley Smith made a compelling argument in these pages last year that it does.

Progressives say rescinding the rule will invite corruption. But the SEC has many authorities to police quid-pro-quo corruption. “Investment advisers are subject to the Investment Advisers Act antifraud requirements, fiduciary duty obligations, and rules requiring them to maintain compliance policies and procedures and codes of ethics,” Mr. Atkins says.

As a bonus, removing the SEC from policing political speech could help the agency use its resources to focus on its main mission of protecting investors from being swindled.

What They Teach Teachers in Grad School

Children learn a great deal about race and gender in schools these days, but not nearly enough about reading and math. A big reason is the colleges that teach the teachers, and a new report published Wednesday brings more insight into how they promote politics instead of the basics of instruction.

The evidence comes from Daniel Buck of the American Enterprise Institute, who examined syllabi for programs at eight public graduate schools of education across five states. For each school he analyzed one master’s or certification program that “aligned most closely with an elementary teaching degree,” he writes, not programs that are “overtly political.”

Yet even these programs advance “dogmas largely grounded in progressive and critical frameworks,” he writes. Mr. Buck analyzed more than 400 readings from 75 course syllabi and categorized them as “traditional,” “progressive,” “therapeutic,” or “critical,” meaning critical race and other social justice theories. His evaluation isn’t exhaustive, since he couldn’t access some syllabi, and some didn’t include all readings.

But in only one program, at Florida International University, did he classify more readings as “traditional”—on such basics as phonics or classroom management, for example, or classic books—than in any other category. “Where traditional approaches appeared, they were mostly ancillary,” he writes. “Notably lacking” were “educational philosophies predating the 20th century, or much focus on the elements and principles of classical liberal arts education.”

Consider the University of Wisconsin-Madison, whose education graduate school was ranked No. 1 by U.S. News and World Report in 2025. Of the 95 readings Mr. Buck looked at, 45% fell into his “critical” category. That includes a report claiming that “attacks on CRT [critical race theory]” are “part of a larger ideol-

A new report finds a lot of critical theory and not much of the basics.

logical effort to delegitimize historically accurate presentations of race and racism.”

At California State University, Northridge, a class on “reflective teaching” assigns students an article titled “Queering Elementary Education: A Queer Curriculum for 4th Grade.” At University of Texas-Austin, another top-ranked school, “the syllabus for the required course on young adult literature opens with a land acknowledgment,” suggesting that whites stole the land from Native Americans, Mr. Buck reports. He classified 90% of the readings he reviewed at UT Austin as “critical,” including one on “Anti-Racist Linguistic Anthropology.”

Dubious teaching methods abound. At Texas Tech, Mr. Buck reports, “even the courses focused on more practical classroom skills” emphasize “individual autonomy over learning through direct instruction.” At FIU, a training on classroom management “largely discourages” teachers from issuing consequences to misbehaving students.

Mr. Buck notes that he can’t say how the readings are taught in class, and these are a small sample of 1,600 education schools in the U.S. But other analyses have found teacher colleges left-leaning or not useful for basic classroom instruction.

More than half of teachers earn master’s degrees of some kind, and many states or districts offer higher pay for teachers who do. Mr. Buck suggests ending this “master’s premium” and expanding other teacher certification pathways. Another idea: “governors could establish centers for classical or liberal arts education” at public universities to bring ideological diversity into the system, as some have done for civics.

Republican efforts to limit federal loans for these programs are sound. Children and teachers are poorly served when progressive politics and fads replace the practical, traditional transmission of knowledge.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Taiwan’s Drone Bill Signals Stronger Defense

Your editorial “Taiwan’s Drone Realism” (Sept. 1) notes that Taiwan is taking the necessary steps to bolster its deterrence against rising Chinese coercion.

The Taiwan Legislature’s recent drone bill is an example of Taipei’s steadfast commitment to its own defense despite a divided democracy. The \$7.6 billion for drones was originally meant to be attached to a larger \$40 billion special budget proposed in November 2025 but was stripped out at the last moment due to legislative disagreements when the package finally passed in May 2026.

Despite arriving later than expected, the sheer size of the package marks a significant investment in military preparedness. Taiwan’s proposed annual spending under the bill is about seven times larger than the current value of the island’s drone exports.

The package also builds on a separate billion-dollar spending plan to develop the island’s domestic drone industry. The distinction is key: By

separating spending on procurement and production, Taiwan can ensure that its market survives lulls within its overall budget process that could otherwise ruin private investment timelines.

The new bill comes at an opportune time for the island. As Washington seeks to bolster the capabilities of its allies and partners across the Indo-Pacific by encouraging secure supply chains and joint production, Taiwan’s emerging domestic drone industry can showcase Taipei’s role as a model ally contributing to collective defense.

While Beijing may present the island’s internal disagreements as a sign of political failure, the resulting compromise is poised to become a clear policy success—translating the lessons of distant battlefields in Ukraine and beyond into a firm bid to bolster deterrence.

JACK BURNHAM
Foundation for Defense of Democracies’ China Program
Washington

Who Really Rejected Peace in the Middle East?

In his op-ed “They Forget Who Started the War” (Sept. 1), Elliot Kaufman correctly criticizes a blatantly inaccurate statement made by the current leading candidate for United Nations secretary-general: that in 1948 Israel “violently rejected the two-state solution.” In reality, the Jewish Agency for Palestine accepted the U.N.’s two-state resolution, while the secretary-general of the Arab League promised a “war of extermination and momentous massacre” if Israel established its state pursuant to that resolution. Five Arab states invaded Israel the day after Israel did.

Fast forward 75 years—past multiple other Arab-initiated wars and rejections of two-state solutions—to Oct. 7, 2023, and the war of extermination and massacre Hamas initiated in its effort to galvanize Iran and its proxies to join a new final solution. A Palestinian state could have been created multiple times, over nearly a century, had the Arabs sought a second state instead of the destruction of Israel.

In 1948, Israel’s U.N. representative, Abba Eban, noted that, under the 1922 League of Nations Mandate and the 1947 U.N. resolution, two Arab states—Transjordan and Arab Palestine—were to be established on seven-eighths of the land originally set aside for the Jews under the Balfour Declaration. He asserted that “many a Palestine Arab may come to compare this prospect, which was peacefully available, with the results of the ‘holy war’”—and that those who in the future would help the Arabs recognize Israel’s permanence would be deemed “in the historic sense, a friend of the Arabs,” because it would free the Arabs to concentrate on their own welfare, rather than on a genocidal war.

These days, the U.N. regularly vilifies the state that supported its two-state resolution—and misstates the history of those who violently rejected it.

RICK RICHMAN
American Jewish University
Los Angeles

What Happens After the World Bank Leaves?

The argument that Indermit Gill and Bjorn Lomborg make in “The Rich World’s Climate Distraction” (Sept. 1) misses a more fundamental reason why international development assistance has made less progress against poverty than hoped.

The problem isn’t simply that the World Bank is directing too much money toward climate investments instead of schools, health centers and other poverty programs. The more important question is what happens to those investments after the bank’s financing ends.

As a former World Bank staff member who spent nearly 30 years working on development projects, I have seen the problem firsthand. The bank typically finances a project for roughly five to 10 years, while the schools, health facilities, water systems, irrigation projects and other infrastructure it creates are expected to operate for another 20 to 40 years.

That requires governments in developing countries to provide salaries, maintenance, repairs, equipment, utilities and other operating costs for decades. Many simply don’t have the fiscal resources to do so. The result can be deteriorating or nonfunctioning facilities—investments that were intended to serve entire communities of poor people.

The failure to reduce poverty can’t be explained simply by saying that the bank should build more schools

or health centers. Before spending additional billions, we should determine how many of the projects and assets financed by the bank and other multilateral development banks are still functioning 20 or 30 years later.

Remarkably, there is no comprehensive long-term study answering that question. The U.S. Treasury and other World Bank shareholders should require such an independent evaluation before committing additional taxpayer funds. We need to know whether development investments are producing lasting benefits, not merely whether the money was successfully disbursed.

EMIL RUDERFER
Former World Bank staff member
Washington

Climate Science Definitions

Regarding Stephen Einhorn’s op-ed “‘Extreme Weather’ Isn’t a Scientific Term” (Aug. 31): The press often uses the term “extreme weather” casually, and this is deplorable. But the underlying concept has a precise mathematical and scientific foundation.

In climatology and statistics, extremity is rigorously defined by probability density functions and tail risk (low-probability extreme events) relative to a baseline distribution. For variables like temperature, this is routinely quantified in standard deviations from the mean (such as a 3-sigma or 4-sigma event). For skewed variables like precipitation, it is defined via empirical percentiles (for instance, the 99th percentile) or Extreme Value Theory.

Arguing that the concept is unscientific simply because journalists use it loosely and without precision ignores the standard statistical apparatus scientists rely on to quantify anomalies.

GARY CORNELL, Ph.D.
Retired professor of mathematics
Sparks, Nev.

Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



“Is that a constructive criticism or just nagging?”

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OPINION

What if California Becomes a ‘Failed State’?

By Richard J. Shinder

Contemporary American conservatives largely consider federalism an unalloyed good. As “laboratories of democracy,” the 50 states can each implement novel economic and social policies without endangering the entire country if they fail. But the rise of radical policies championed by progressives, particularly the ascendant Democratic Socialists of America, could push U.S. states into a category usually only of interest to international investors dealing with unstable, developing countries: unacceptable political risk.

‘Political risk,’ usually the precinct of Third World despotisms, could soon be a concern for U.S. locales.

Because individuals, businesses and capital have always been able to vote with their feet and move within the U.S. to more attractive locales if a policy mix proved toxic, on all but the most hot-button issues the major political parties have generally accepted that federalism works. Even when in violent disagreement with a given state’s policies, each party knew that other states could maintain different standards. The Constitution’s Commerce Clause historically provided a federalist guardrail of sorts, limiting interstate contagion from rogue state-level governance. This equipoise between the major parties and among the states may be

coming to an end, to the detriment of all. The DSA and other progressives are pushing the public-policy Overton window into uncharted territory—a policy mix that could saddle U.S. states with what international investors call “political risk.” In economic terms, political risk is the additional required return on an investment due to the possibility a sovereign jurisdiction may seize an asset or otherwise diminish its value. In extreme cases—war-torn regions, full-blown kleptocracies—Western companies might decline to invest or do business. Certain progressive jurisdictions in the U.S. risk falling into this latter category, which is usually the precinct of benighted despotisms. Pricing risk of any kind relies on predictive inputs. Actuarial analysis, consideration of historical performance and precedent, trend analysis, Monte Carlo scenario modeling and the like help determine probabilities so an investor can calculate the “excess” return required to compensate for a risk. When investors choose not to transact in a region due to political risk, it implies it has become impossible to price. The political environment is too volatile or unknowable to derive the required return. A slate of progressive policies and proposals could make the risks of doing business or even residing in certain American states and cities too unpredictable to calculate—or a compensating gain too difficult to obtain. These include wealth taxes (such as California’s “billionaire tax” initiative on the ballot this fall), exit taxes, novel property levies (such as the pied-à-terre tax in New York



A T-shirt at the California Democratic Party convention in San Francisco.

City), and slavery reparation task forces (including in California, always a free state). There’s also lawfare advanced for ideological or partisan ends: regulatory harassment (as seems to be the case in California’s suit against Paramount’s merger with Warner Bros.), abuse of consent decrees to direct public resources to partisan ends, and general regulatory overreach. These policies are radical and unprecedented. Historically, Americans saw a trade-off with the downsides of living, working and investing in a durably high-tax state in the form of significant investments in infrastructure and other public goods. People and businesses could decide whether the services were worth the incremental taxes to pay for them. Even in places where the direct cost-benefit analysis between taxes and government services may have

seemed poor, there were other compensating qualities that state and local policy weren’t caustic enough to destroy. Think of New York for the past several decades. The return derived from the accumulated social capital associated with the region, such as Wall Street, might have been worth the direct economic loss of income from a value-leeching public sector. But these new policies could easily overwhelm any compensating values of living in certain U.S. cities and states. That they have energetic backing also raises the specter of unpredictable decline. While Americans have always left one part of the country for better opportunities elsewhere, this forces people and businesses to weigh the odds of future financial or personal calamity at the hands of unforeseeable government action. That’s political risk.

I Was Across the Street on 9/11, and I’m Grateful I Survived



UPWARD MOBILITY
By Jason L. Riley

The first time I recall feeling old was on a commuter train headed home from the office a few years ago. It stopped near a prep school, where a group of noisy teenage boys in khakis and navy blazers boarded my car. They were lost in conversation and cussing up a storm until one of them noticed me sitting within earshot. “Oh, sorry, sir,” he said sheepishly before turning back to the others, who immediately lowered their voices and cleaned up their language. When youngsters start apologizing for swearing in your presence, you’ve aged. A more sober reminder of the march of time is this week’s 25th anniversary of 9/11. Around a third of the U.S. population is too young to remember the attacks. But like many of my colleagues at the Journal, whose offices were catercorner from

the World Trade Center in lower Manhattan, I recall them like they happened yesterday. I lived in Brooklyn and took the subway to work. As I was leaving my apartment that morning, my father phoned me. “Son, are you watching television?” “No, I’m headed to the office.” “There’s a fire at the World Trade Center.” “OK. Thanks. I’ll call you back when I get to work. Gotta go.” “Be careful.” If it was cold or rainy, I could enter my subway station in Brooklyn and reach my desk without going back outside, thanks to a network of tunnels and covered walkways that led through the World Trade Center to the Journal’s offices in the World Financial Center. That morning, however, the weather was sunny and pleasant, and I wanted to see what Dad was talking about. So I took the subway to a stop that put me a couple of blocks east of the towers. I had to walk past them to get to my office building.

When I emerged from the subway, the police had already cordoned off the streets. I couldn’t get to work. All I could do—and all that thousands of other people nearby could do—was stand there, stare at the cloudless sky, and watch the towers burn. I pulled out my Verizon flip

On my way in to work, I found myself breathing acrid smoke and taking cover under a utility van.

phone and tried to call my dad, but the cellular networks were overloaded and I couldn’t get a signal. I tried again and again. Then the first tower fell. I watched it collapse into a gray cloud of debris that grew larger as it headed toward me. I dropped my phone, turned and sprinted. As I looked over my shoulder, it was clear there was no way I could outrun the

cloud, so I began looking for cover. I saw a utility van and crawled underneath, but by then the cloud had engulfed everything. It was completely dark. My eyes burned. I could barely breathe. Lying there, I thought about Dad. My mother was already deceased, and we had lost my younger sister a few years earlier when I was still in college. I thought about how devastating it would be for him to outlive two of his children. Then I began to worry that the van would run me over, so I crawled out from underneath and banged on the window. Someone slid open the door and I climbed inside, but too much dust had seeped in, and it was still difficult to breathe. I eventually left the van and police ushered me into a nearby building, where I was told moments later that it wasn’t safe in there either, and that I had to evacuate. Back outside, it was getting lighter. I saw a Burger King up ahead. Employees were giving out cups of water. While inside, I heard what sounded like thunder. The restaur-

rant had huge floor-to-ceiling windows facing the sidewalk, and suddenly they went completely black. The second tower had collapsed. I waited for the dust to settle and walked back home to Brooklyn. I looked as if I had been rolling around in a giant ashtray. The first thing I did was call my father. After that, I sat down at my desktop computer and typed an email to my editors to let them know what happened to me and that I was OK. To my surprise, the email was printed in the paper the next day. For months after the attacks, the New York Times ran short biographical sketches of the victims—firefighters, flight attendants, bankers, restaurant workers, Pentagon employees. Every day, I would try to read them on the way to work, but I could never get past the first three or four without becoming too emotional and wondering what my obituary would have said. Twenty-five Septembers after 9/11, I don’t feel sad about getting older. I feel lucky.

China Overplayed Its Hand on Critical Minerals

By Scott Morrison

Xi Jinping is scheduled to visit President Trump at the White House Sept. 24. Seven weeks later, on Nov. 10, the U.S.-China trade agreement that eased China’s export restrictions on critical minerals is set to expire. But as the U.S. and allies like Australia and Japan collaborate to create alternative supply chains, China’s leverage is becoming increasingly perishable by the day. When a government exploits a chokepoint, whether Iran holding the Strait of Hormuz or China bringing down the boom on rare earths, it takes a risk. In the short term, Iran or China will achieve asymmetric gains, but over time these returns will diminish. Inventories rise, customers diversify, producers change investment plans, and infrastructure that had been too expensive becomes economical. That’s happening now with China’s hold on critical minerals, and it’s why Beijing’s trading partners are working together more effectively to break that hold. Looking back, China probably did its trading partners a favor by ex-

ploiting the chokepoint it spent decades establishing. Dependence on China for critical minerals has been a national-security vulnerability for those trading partners for decades. We knew that well before China imposed export controls in 2023. After its rare-earth shock in 2010, Japan helped finance an alternative supply through Australia’s Lynas, now the world’s largest producer of separated rare earths outside China. Mr. Trump saw the problem coming, too. In 2017 his first administration formally identified America’s dependence on critical minerals as a national-security vulnerability. We also knew about it in Australia. My government released Australia’s first critical-minerals strategy in 2019. Six months later Mr. Trump and I agreed at the White House to integrate Australian and U.S. supply chains and bring like-minded countries into the effort. These initiatives ultimately laid the groundwork for current actions to create alternative supply chains. But at the time we were missing the binding agent that industry and government needed to overcome China’s grip on the market. Mr. Xi

hadn’t begun to squeeze. China’s advantage wasn’t geology or even technology. It was economics. As I told Congress last year, China routinely kept other suppliers out of the market by increasing the supply, depressing the price, tanking the market and absorbing the loss, making any new venture uneconomical. It wasn’t that hard for China, as these weren’t bulk commodity markets, and profits weren’t its primary goal. Global demand for the principal magnet rare earths is less than 100,000 tons, against close to a billion tons of iron ore exported each year from Australia alone. Rare earths don’t need dedicated railways, ports and bulk carriers. Small volumes make a market easier to manipulate, but they also mean market dominance can be less formidable than it looks. The West wasn’t helping itself at the time. Western end users happily took the cheaper deal from China, reinforcing the concentration that became their own vulnerability. China’s decision to activate its leverage changed all this. Over 18 months starting in July 2023, Beijing imposed export controls on gallium, germanium, graphite, antimony and some rare-earth-related manufacturing. After Mr. Trump returned to office, China imposed further export controls on tungsten, tellurium, bismuth, molybdenum, indium and seven medium and heavy rare earths, including dysprosium and terbium. Shortly before the late October 2025 Xi-Trump meeting in Busan, South Korea, China jumped the shark, asserting licensing control over any product made anywhere in the world containing Chinese rare earths.

In Busan, Messrs. Trump and Xi agreed to a 12-month truce. The U.S. eased tariffs, and China suspended restrictions and provided general licenses for U.S. end users. This would buy time for the Trump

administration to establish alternative supply chains. Mr. Trump had already directed agencies through an executive order on March 20, 2025, to fast-track permits, encourage mineral production on federal lands, and use the Defense Production Act to deploy government loan guarantees and investments. A Section 232 investigation was then initiated, and the July 2025 budget substantially boosted the National Defense Stockpile and gave \$500 million to the Office of Strategic Capital for credit subsidies capable of supporting up to \$100 billion of loans for projects.

It exploited a chokepoint. Now the U.S., Australia and other allies are finding ways to build around it.

The more important innovation was moving beyond individual projects to change the market conditions for alternative supply chains. The July 2025 MP Materials agreement committed \$400 million in preferred equity and \$150 million to a loan for heavy rare-earths separation. Most significantly, by agreeing to a 10-year minimum floor price for neodymium-praseodymium at \$110 a kilogram and an agreement to buy the resulting magnets for 10 years, the U.S. inoculated producers against China’s price manipulation, ensuring their ventures remained commercially viable for investors. In October 2025 Australia stepped up again. The U.S. and Australia agreed to mobilize at least \$1 billion for priority projects. By April that had grown to \$3.5 billion across 11 named projects spanning gallium, neodymium-praseodymium, graphite, tungsten, nickel, tantalum and magnesium. A parallel framework between the U.S. and Japan added pricing

measures and financing for projects, offtake, stockpiling and a rapid-response mechanism. All this is similar to the architecture Mr. Trump and I discussed back in 2019. Our understanding of the threat didn’t change. China changed the price of ignoring it, for government and industry alike. That is the binding agent China has given us. Finally, in February this year Mr. Trump launched Project Vault, America’s first strategic critical-minerals reserve for civilian industry, backed by \$10 billion of financing from the Export-Import Bank of the U.S. plus nearly \$2 billion of private-sector capital. These measures haven’t yet broken Chinese dominance, and China isn’t letting up, adding 10 U.S. companies to its export-control list, including MP Materials, in June. The virtue of the Trump administration’s measures is that they can’t be easily reversed by China’s market manipulation. Floor price and durable offtake agreements boost resilience and provide guardrails for Western participants and tie in end users. These measures change the economics, enabling Western competitors to challenge China’s dominance. Counterintuitively, we have China to thank for it. The Busan truce bought valuable time. The Trump-Xi meeting this month may extend that timeline. Regardless, China has provoked an increasingly integrated and scaled response that must now be sustained. Now it is essential to put permitting and the bureaucracy on a conflict footing. The more Beijing abuses its leverage, the stronger the case becomes to build around it. We can thank China for that. Mr. Morrison served as Australia’s prime minister, 2018-22. He is vice chairman of American Global Strategies.

SPORTS



JASON GAY

The NFL Is Finally Back!

The main event is here, the last sliver of the culture the public can all discuss without wrestling each other in the supermarket parking lot. Can the Seahawks repeat or is it the Rams’ year?



At last, pro football. (I mean Sunday pro football. Not the LSU kind.) Congratulations on surviving an arid stretch of downhill unicycling, celebrity pickleball singles, lawn darts, frog jumping, toad jumping, bass fishing and even a five-week hallucination in which America flopped and writhed on the pitch grabbing a knee as a proper soccer country.

Now the main event is here, the last sliver of the culture the public can all discuss without wrestling each other in the supermarket parking lot: The NFL.

Honestly, it feels like this season started six months ago, because the NFL now sucks up the summer doldrums, too. Tadej Pogacar could win the Tour de France in a Spider-Man outfit carrying a baby llama in his down-tube bottle cage and the sports media industrial complex would devote more time to an NFL quarterback taking his offensive linemen on a mid-July bowling outing.

Useless NFL gasbaggery is now a key contributor to the U.S. GNP, a hedge against AI robots stealing all of the remaining sports jobs, but maybe also a rickety business propped up by advertising from gambling barons and their crazy cousins in the prediction markets.

And I haven’t even gotten to the fantasy talk, which turns otherwise delightful conversationalists into bores you need to avoid at office functions and weekend barbecues.

Still, I’m pretty excited for the football. And you should be pretty excited, too, crabbyface. Unless you’re a Cleveland Browns fan. Or a New York Jets fan.

(Have the Jets ever been mathematically eliminated in the pre-season? Feels reasonable. What can you do for me, Polymarket?)

Perhaps Jets and Browns fans can join each other in a stimulating trapeise down the Appalachian Trail. And then, upon reaching Georgia, they should turn around and do a trapeise northward to Maine, because next season’s not looking so hot, either.

Or is it? There’s a fresh Manning expected in the 2027 entry draft: Arch, the 3.0 generation after grandpop Archie and uncs Peyton and Eli.

Already there are hapless teams wondering if it’s time to stop tackling their opponents in order to chase some of those New Orleans quarterbacking genes. Poor Arch is surveying his options and wondering if it’s too late to learn how to play lacrosse.

OK, I know you have other questions. Here are some answers.

As always, I discourage you from using any of this material for gambling purposes without cutting me a nice percentage. (This is a gross violation of Journal rules, so we’ll need to be very hush-hush about it.)

■ Why Isn’t There More Buzz About a Seahawks Super Bowl Repeat?

I’ll give it to you straight: because the East Coast media machine thinks the Seahawks are kind of boring, and treats the Pacific Northwest like it’s a deserted island off the coast of Canada that sells sockeye salmon and Nirvana T-shirts.

But it’s also because there’s a substantial part of the human population that can’t quite believe it wakes up on a planet where Sam Darnold won a Super Bowl. Even Sam Darnold some mornings is like: *Really?*

The Ospreys—no such thing as a Seahawk, my know-it-all 13-year-old son wants to remind you—are a balanced franchise with an ace coach, and playmakers on both sides.

Jaxon Smith-Njigba is the best receiver in the league. I think the absence of obnoxious hype benefits Seattle, which kicks off the season Wednesday, Sept. 9 versus its Super Bowl roadkill, New England.

Live a calmer lifestyle, gel in obscurity, develop an edge, show up in January and make everyone east of the Mississippi look like clowns again.

■ Why is everyone so cuckoo about the Rams?

Tinseltown’s football concern is a weird riddle. Within football, they’re widely seen as a clever, heretical-thinking ubercorp—just ask them—but in Los Angeles they remain a third banana to Mark Walter’s expensive baseball team and the basketball team Mark Walter just flipped like Barbie’s Malibu Beach house.

The LAR are undeniably good: They just added premier defender Myles Garrett from Cleveland, unfroze the retired wrecking ball Aaron Donald, and figure they can squeeze another season of geezer brilliance from reigning MVP Matt Stafford. At the same time: Catch man Puka Nacua had a chaotic offseason.

One complaint: The Rams revised their uniforms and appear to have kept those shiny, rubbery appliques that make the jerseys look like last-minute Halloween costumes from Walgreens.

■ What’s the deal with the Rams-Niners opener in Australia? Also: There’s an NFL game in Australia?

This Thursday, Sept. 10 game is the latest example of NFL imperialism/soft power and also a delicious test of conflicting physiological theories about avoiding jet lag (Melbourne is 17 hours ahead of LA/SF.)

The Niners basically chose to move to Australia and become naturalized citizens. They now speak

with charming accents, listen to Midnight Oil B-sides, refer to great white sharks as “white pointers,” and are still trying to decide if they’ll wear helmets in the opener.

The Rams, conversely, plan to land Down Under six minutes before the game, convinced they can trick their bodies into thinking they’re still drinking an Erewhon smoothie back in So-Cal.

What team will be best prepared? What team will be wanting to crawl into bed at halftime and sleep for 36 hours? This is like a Super Bowl for people who enjoy watching unlicensed doctors in tight T-shirts give unsolicited health advice on TikTok.

■ Dare we get optimistic about Buffalo?

I worry about engaging on this topic, because it makes me feel like Lucy gripping the football for Charlie Brown, but I promise not to yank it away (historically that’s been Kansas City’s job). There’s no

honor in tormenting a devoted fan base that doesn’t need any more suffering.

That said, it’s starting to feel like put-up/shut-up time in Western New York. Quarterback Josh Allen is 30 years old—an embryo

by Tommy Brady standards, but still. There’s a new head coach, Joe Brady, promoted from within to be an Allen whisperer. There’s a new, \$2 billion plus stadium, which has been mocked for Chia Pet sod, neck-twisting viewing angles and a wee scoreboard. All will be forgiven if Allen delivers, reverses all those decades of bad juju and hoists the Lombardi hood ornament into the sky. Why not? This is the Bills’ year. Unless it’s not.

■ Who are the quarterbacks on the move?

Kyler Murray has swapped baffling climate-controlled football in Arizona for baffling climate-controlled football in Minneapolis.

Old friend Kirk Cousins will warm the Raiders offense long enough for No. 1 pick Fernando Mendoza to grow a grizzly Kenny Stabler-style beard or for part-owner Brady to un-retire, whatever comes first. Tua Tagovailoa has relocated to Atlanta as Malik Willis will try to survive Miami.

Geno Smith has returned to the Jets, which sounds like the first act of a horror movie. Everyone knows the rule, Geno: Never go back into the house!

■ Does ESPN have the Super Bowl?

Yes. And ESPN paid me nothing to say that. It’s a bit of a feint, because the game

Every year, I stage a quiet tantrum for AC/DC and the NFL ignores me.



Left: Angus Young of AC/DC, Below: Texas quarterback Arch Manning



is also going to be aired on its free broadcast daddy, ABC. But ESPN, which the NFL now has a piece of, in the way rich people own a small stake in a clam hut on Martha’s Vineyard, is eager to tell you it has the game.

Between now and Feb. 14, 2027—that’s right, the Super Bowl is on Valentine’s Day, call your attorney now—ESPN is going to remind you of their Super Bowl 75 trillion times, to the point it will send its sentient backwards baseball cap, Pat McAfee, to your house with a pawprint-autographed photo of Kirk Herbstreit’s dog in order to ensure that you watch. And then download the live-action Moana on Disney+.

■ How are we supposed to treat New England? Are we all still walking on eggshells up there?

It’s awkward, sure. Mike Vrabel’s life turned into a Bravo network pitch thanks to some off-field personal drama, but New England remains a contender with a gifted quarterback on a rookie contract and with a new weapon, formerly disgruntled Eagles receiver A.J. Brown. Brown is eager to wipe off the cobwebs that were growing between his fingers in Philly. Vrabel will be thrilled to move the discussion to football, although the Niners already did him a solid favor with their own recent intrigue.

A hurdle: The Patriots schedule is considerably harder than it was last season, when it snacked on light appetizers through January and got to play the AFC championship game against a backup QB.

■ Where are Eagles fans on their annual freakout about the Eagles index?

Do you know Eagles fans? Then you know that the true joy for them is not winning the Super Bowl, it’s shaking their head and explaining to you all the reasons the Eagles will not win the Super Bowl. This club has won back to back NFC Easts and delivered a title just two seasons ago, but remains dogged by underachiever vibes. Brown’s cobwebbed mitts are gone and QB Jalen Hurts is spreading the gospel of a “shared mission.” New offensive coordinator Sean Mannion has arrived from Green Bay to make the offense slightly more stirring than a capybara gently chewing on grass. If running dynamo Saquon Barkley has a bounce-back year, it’s going to be an enjoyable playoff-bound campaign, which, let’s face it, could disappoint some hardcore Philadelphians.

■ Who is the Super Bowl halftime show?

Every year, I stage a quiet tantrum for AC/DC and the NFL ignores me. I will continue to wage this lonely battle as long as septuagenarian Angus Young is hopping around in schoolboy shorts. But the NFL has lost its taste for dinosaur rockers, and so instead America will brew a silly culture war out of Sabrina Carpenter or Justin Bieber or something. (*Bieber’s Canadian, don’t you know! He should only perform as Justin America!*)

■ Have You Really Gotten This Far in Your Article Without Mentioning the Dallas Cowboys?

Yes.

■ Please rank the NFL in terms of title hopes.

OK. Am I on a podcast? Here are my categories:

■ You Have Super Bowl Hopes and Have Even Googled Hotel Rooms: Seahawks/Ospreys, Bills.

■ You Have Super Bowl Hopes and Haven’t Googled Hotel Rooms Because You Live Where the Game Is: Rams

■ You’re Generally Upbeat and Could Start Googling Hotel Rooms after a Couple of Beers: Niners, Lions, Packers, Patriots, Eagles

■ You Have Already Booked Hotel Rooms But Are Afraid to Say It Because You Think Everyone Will Laugh at You: Bengals, Broncos, Bears, Chargers, Cowboys, Texans, Ravens

■ You’re Already a Little Panicked You’ll Hate Yourself by Mid-October: Steelers, Chiefs, Panthers, Buccaneers, Commanders, Jaguars, Vikings, Colts

■ You’re Actively Exploring New Hobbies Besides Watching Rotten Football: Giants, Falcons, Saints, Titans, Raiders, Dolphins.

■ You Really Need to Take Your TV Off the Wall and Chuck it in the Trash: Browns, Jets, Cardinals.

■ Hey, you didn’t actually answer the question in the headline about Travis Kelce and Taylor Swift.

Well, that’s because it’s click-bait, silly. But: no.

■ Super Bowl Prediction: Rams over the Ravens. Or LSU.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

‘60 Minutes’ Returns in Test for CBS

Continued from page B1
the new season until October, according to people familiar with the matter. But he decided to go ahead. “We’re ready,” he told the network, the people said.
Technology, particularly artificial intelligence, will be a theme this season, people familiar with the matter said. Bilton sees AI as the kind of defining story “60 Minutes” tackled in previous eras, including the Vietnam War, the fight against Big Tobacco and the Sept. 11 attacks.
He has also promised a renewed emphasis on original investigations, long a hallmark of “60 Minutes.”
People close to the show say that 35 stories are being shot or edited and 60 more are in development.
The new season begins as CBS parent **Paramount**, controlled by the Ellison family, is fighting California and 11 other states seeking to block its \$81 billion takeover of **Warner Bros. Discovery**.



Nick Bilton, left, the new boss of ‘60 Minutes,’ and CBS News’ editor in chief, Bari Weiss.



“60 Minutes” remains one of television’s most popular news programs and a profit center for CBS. Last season, the show averaged 9.1 million viewers, up 9%, according to Nielsen.
Annual revenue is about \$100 million, including distribution fees and digital advertising, and its budget is roughly \$60 million, people familiar with the show’s economics said. A CBS spokesman declined to comment on its finances.
The show generated \$67.2 million in linear-TV advertising

last year, down 25% from \$84.5 million in 2022, according to iSpot. Like most broadcast television, “60 Minutes” has seen declining ad revenue.
Weiss had no television experience when she took over CBS News last October after selling the Free Press, the news and opinion site she founded in 2021, to Paramount. Some staff saw her as an interloper at “60 Minutes,” which has long prized its autonomy.
In May, Weiss parted ways with executive producer Tanya

Simon, a 25-year veteran of the show. Correspondents Sharyn Alfonsi and Cecilia Vega also exited.
Alfonsi had accused Weiss of political interference after she briefly held a story about the Trump administration’s deportation of Venezuelan migrants to El Salvador. Weiss said newsrooms regularly hold stories that aren’t ready for publication. The segment, called “Inside CECOT,” eventually ran in January, with some additional material bookending the piece.

Vega had also clashed with the new leadership.
The revolt reached a crescendo when correspondent Scott Pelley confronted Bilton at his first staff meeting, accusing Weiss of “murdering” the show. Pelley was fired soon after.
Weiss said management had tried to engage with Pelley “to find a way back,” but couldn’t do so and had to part ways with him.
In a Facebook post Tuesday, recently departed “60 Minutes” managing editor Guy Campanile said that “we were told to leave because we insisted on doing our jobs.” He said he and his colleagues “would not compromise our principles or reputations by jamming unverifiable notions or White House talking points into our reporting.”
CBS News declined to comment on the post.
Bilton, a former New York Times and Vanity Fair correspondent and author of two books, came to the job having never run a television program or any operation on the scale of “60 Minutes,” though he had produced TV documentaries.
When Bilton was tapped, Weiss said that he “is one of the most entrepreneurial journalists of our time.”
Bilton is giving the nearly 60-year-old show a visual refresh, including a redesign,

different lenses and shooting in 4K. He has told colleagues the changes are evolutionary rather than revolutionary.
For decades, one of the show’s calling cards was taking viewers somewhere they otherwise might never see. Social media has made that harder. Bilton believes a feature now has to show viewers something they haven’t seen or offer a genuinely new angle, people familiar with his thinking said.
That also means keeping the storytelling accessible. Bilton and executive editor Maria Gavrilovic use Racine, Wis.—where Gavrilovic grew up and Bilton’s father lives—as shorthand when talking about the audience they want to reach.
Bilton faces the challenge of establishing his independence even as Weiss remains closely involved with “60 Minutes,” people close to the show said.
Since the spring revamp, Bilton has been rebuilding, adding New York Times opinion columnist Ross Douthat as a correspondent and Sebastian Junger, Gianna Toboni and Trevor Phillips as contributors. They join Lesley Stahl, Bill Whitaker and Jon Wertheim.
The premiere will include an interview with one of the rescued U.S. airmen shot down in Iran this past April.

Robinhood, Crypto.com Strike Deal

Continued from page B1
market event contracts are just the first product we’re going to be launching together,” Crypto.com Chief Executive Kris Marszalek said in an interview. The two companies have also discussed equity-linked perpetual futures should regulators approve the product, he said.
Terms of the agreements, including Robinhood’s investments, weren’t disclosed. Crypto.com and OG were val-

ued at \$15 billion and \$5 billion, respectively, after Citadel Securities bought a stake in each in July.
Crypto.com has offered prediction-markets contracts through its derivatives arm since late 2024. In February, the exchange launched OG, a stand-alone prediction-markets platform, which has grown about 20 times this year, said Marszalek. In late 2025, Crypto.com announced a partnership with President Trump’s media business to introduce prediction markets directly on the social-media platform Truth Social. The partnership was terminated last month, with the companies citing “prevailing market conditions, and shifting business and stakeholder priorities.”

Prediction markets have become one of the hottest areas for individual traders, driving intense competition among major providers. The Robinhood partnership is going to attract more traders and institutions onto Crypto.com’s prediction-markets platform, according to Marszalek. “This is just a very natural market structure that institutions want to trade against the retail flow,” he said.
Crypto.com plans to look for acquisitions to fuel its growth, and is preparing for an initial public offering,

Marszalek said. The company hasn’t decided on the timing of its IPO, he said.
JB Mackenzie, Robinhood’s vice president and general manager of futures and prediction markets, said the partnership would allow the brokerage to offer better pricing and a wider variety of contracts. It also means the trading platform will be firing on all cylinders, he said, as a crucial stretch for the event-contracts business begins: the start of football season, followed by the midterm elections later this fall.

Meta Sets Personal AI Agent

Continued from page B1
and cause much less damage due to the safety systems we’ve built in,” Meta said in a blog post announcing the new agents.
Users can choose which apps to connect to their agent, including their email, calendar and fitness apps, and control the degree of access they grant it.
On email, for instance, users can choose whether the agent can only read emails or

whether it can also craft and respond to emails on the user’s behalf.
Once connected, the agent can book flights, buy movie tickets and shop around for other items on the web. It asks approval before completing any purchase, Meta said.
In a promotional video, the AI agent flagged a flight that had dropped by \$40 and asked if the user wanted the agent to book it.
It also reminded the user of a coming tee time and told the user which hole was going to be the most difficult on the golf course.
Meta said people can change their settings or disconnect from the agent at any time and can opt out of their data being used as training data for Meta’s coming AI models.

LIV Golf Files for Bankruptcy

Continued from page B1
that in total there are between 1,000 and 5,000 creditors.
LIV said it has entered into a restructuring support agreement with BC Partners, the British investment firm, and other potential investors to recapitalize the organization

when it emerges from bankruptcy. PIF is also providing a \$49.6 million loan to fund the chapter 11 proceedings.
“This process gives us the structure and time to pursue a landmark transaction and begin the next chapter of LIV Golf,” LIV chief executive Scott O’Neil said. “We believe deeply in LIV Golf’s future.”
LIV’s bankruptcy filing had been widely expected in the aftermath of PIF’s about-face this spring. Since then, LIV had canceled two tournaments and allowed bills to pile up. Several vendors sued LIV this year for failing to pay them,

and the company conducted mass layoffs in August.
Still, LIV is angling to play on in 2027 and beyond under what it’s calling “LIV 2.0.” O’Neil has been seeking some \$300 million in outside investment to keep the league afloat. Even if LIV continues, its era of poaching elite players with giant paydays is likely over.
“I still have a contract with LIV 1.0 that I’m more than willing to fulfill,” Rahm told the BBC earlier Tuesday.
Under O’Neil’s proposed new model, LIV players would become its majority owners, with equity stakes replacing the enormous checks that originally coaxed them to join. What remains unclear is whether superstars such as Rahm and DeChambeau will find that palatable or seek a path back to the PGA Tour—potentially spelling the end for LIV. As creditors, the players stand to get a fraction of what they were initially promised.
The filing caps a stunning downfall for a league that sowed chaos in professional golf from its inception. Initially led by legendary Australian golfer Greg Norman, the league attracted the likes of six-time major winner Phil Mickelson, and those who joined faced blowback from the golf establishment, including Tiger Woods. LIV’s players were accused of helping Saudi Arabia whitewash its global reputation after incidents such as the killing of journalist Jamal Khashoggi. LIV always said its only mission was to grow the sport globally.
Its launch instantly divided the industry. LIV and the PGA Tour sued each other, with Tour commissioner Jay Monahan calling the rival a “foreign monarchy that is spending billions of dollars in an attempt to buy the game of golf.” So it was shocking when the Tour and PIF agreed to drop their litigation to work together in 2023. The pivot was so jarring that there was a Senate hearing on the matter.
Yet, despite interventions from President Trump, a deal between the two sides to stitch the sport back together never materialized. And in the time since, LIV continued to face the problem that dogged the league from the outset: It failed to latch on with fans.

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BUSINESS NEWS

GameStop Posts Higher Earnings

Videogame retailer also lifts its outlook for fiscal year as collectibles sales rise

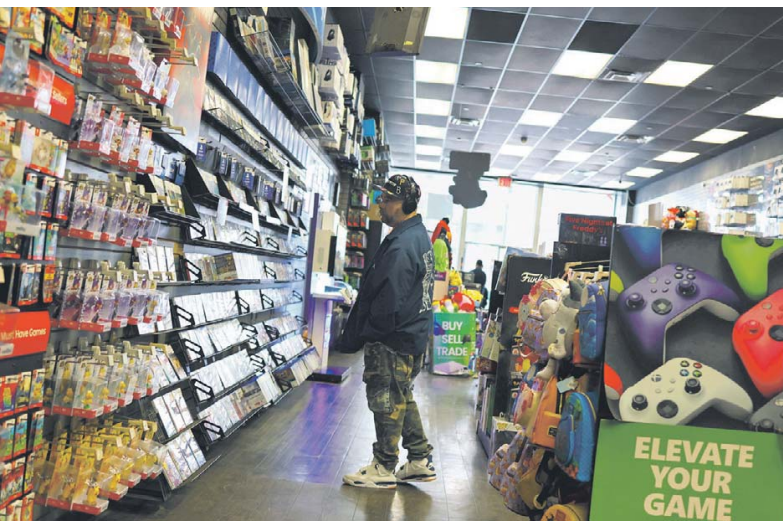
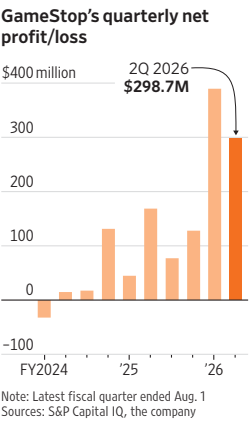
By Kelly Cloonan

GameStop reported higher profit in its latest quarter, boosted by an increase in collectibles sales, and raised its full-year outlook.

The videogame retailer on Tuesday posted a second-quarter profit of \$298.7 million, or 51 cents a share, compared with \$168.6 million, or 31 cents a share, a year earlier. Adjusted earnings per share were 27 cents.

The company's net income came within the forecast range it had given last month. At the time, the company said the guidance factored in about \$238 million of net gains related to its stake in **eBay**.

GameStop's Chief Executive Ryan Cohen earlier this year made an unsolicited offer to buy eBay for about \$56 billion,



The Nintendo Switch 2's launch in the year-ago quarter contributed to a slide in overall sales.

saying he saw a path to make the e-commerce company a much bigger competitor to **Amazon.com**. eBay later rejected Cohen's proposal, though Cohen has said he will keep trying to pursue a deal.

GameStop's second-quarter revenue fell to \$790.2 million from \$972.2 million in the year-ago quarter. Sales declined in the company's video-

games segment and preowned and refurbished division, offsetting growth in collectibles.

The company attributed the overall top-line decrease to lapsing the launch of the Nin-

tendo Switch 2 in the year-ago quarter, as well as a dent from store closures of the divestiture of its operations in France.

For the fiscal year, GameStop now expects ad-

justed earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization in excess of \$650 million, compared with its prior outlook from June for more than \$600 million.

Novartis Logs Another Trial Setback, Sending Its Shares Sharply Lower

By Adria Calatayud

Novartis shares finished Tuesday's trading in Switzerland 11% lower after the drug-maker said an experimental neuromuscular treatment failed a late-stage clinical trial, the latest blow to its efforts to replenish its pipeline of new medicines.

The Swiss pharmaceutical group said Tuesday that the drug, called del-desiran, didn't show a significant improvement compared with a placebo in a study for genetic neuromuscular disease myotonic dystrophy type 1. The trial

measured how long it took patients with the condition to open their hand after gripping.

The failure is the third trial setback for Novartis in the space of a week and comes at a time when the company is seeking to bolster its growth prospects ahead of patent expirations for some of its top-selling medicines.

Novartis said Friday that a closely watched cholesterol drug called pelacarsen failed to reduce the risk of severe cardiovascular events including deaths, heart attacks and strokes in a trial. The com-

pany also said last week that it had paused eight trials of an experimental cell therapy for autoimmune and neurological disorders in late August, after three patients died.

The company has recently reported positive study results for a multiple-sclerosis pill.

Novartis has turned to dealmaking to revive its pipeline, including the \$12 billion acquisition of Avidity Biosciences, its biggest deal in a decade that was completed in February.

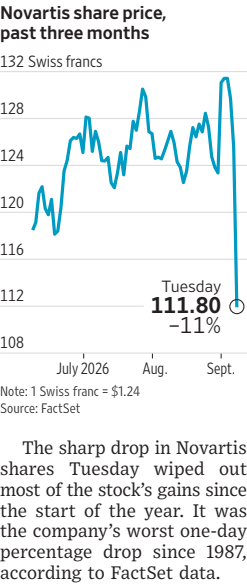
Del-desiran was the most advanced drug candidate Novartis acquired from Avidity.

The company is still advancing two other experimental drugs it added through the deal.

All three medicines are so-called antibody oligonucleotide conjugates, designed to deliver RNA therapy to muscle cells.

Despite the setback, Novartis reiterated its guidance for annual sales growth of 5% to 6% over the 2025-30 period.

However, the trial failure means investors' concerns about the company's growth beyond 2030 will re-emerge, analysts at Jefferies wrote in a note to clients.



Boston Scientific Warns on Guidance

By Colin KellaHer

Boston Scientific said it likely won't meet its financial guidance due to the cyberattack that has disrupted its operations, sending shares of the medical-technology company down sharply.

Boston Scientific on Tuesday said it continues to make progress in restoring many of its systems that were affected by the hack, including substantial restoration of its distribution network, but that it expects to miss its sales and adjusted per-share earnings guidance for the third-quarter and full year.

Shares of the company slid nearly 6% to \$44.98.

Boston Scientific last month reported unauthorized activity on some of its systems that have affected its ability to manufacture and to process and ship customer orders.

The company said its major distribution centers are now processing and shipping customer orders at or above normal operating levels, and that its sterilization facilities are operational, with manufacturing resumed across most plants around the world.

The company said it expects to recover some of the lost revenue as it continues to ramp operations, fulfill customer orders and reduce remaining backlogs.

Boston Scientific in late July said it was expecting sales growth of 3% to 5% in the third quarter and 5.5% to 6.5% for the full year. The company also forecast adjusted earnings of 80 cents to 82 cents a share for the quarter and \$3.28 to \$3.32 a share for the year.

Analysts polled by FactSet, on average, are expecting adjusted profits of 81 cents a share for the third quarter and \$3.30 a share for the year.

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BUSINESS NEWS

Mistral AI Valuation Leaps

French AI startup’s new value tops \$24 billion; it will expand model development

By MAURO ORRU

Mistral AI completed a new funding round led by South Korea’s **Samsung Electronics** that lifted its valuation above \$24 billion, giving it additional firepower to invest in model development and grow its customer base. The French artificial-intelligence startup said it had raised 3 billion euros, equivalent to \$3.48 billion, from a pool of existing investors like Samsung and Dutch chip-equipment giant **ASML Holding** as well as new backers such as **Advent**, funds and accounts managed by **BlackRock** and the Grand Duchy of Luxembourg. The announcement comes about a year after Mistral AI closed an ASML-led round that gave it an €11.7 billion valuation. The latest round, co-led by Samsung, **EQT**-managed Scaleup Europe Fund and existing investor PSG Equity, brings its valuation above €21 billion, or \$24.39 billion.



Advertisements for Mistral AI in the Grand Central subway station in New York City.

Johan Bergqvist, who joined Mistral AI earlier this year as chief financial officer, said that this was the largest equity fundraising round yet completed by a European tech company, and that support from ASML and Samsung showed how big tech groups continued to see promise in Mistral AI about three years after its launch.

“That’s a reflection of the growing confidence in what we can offer,” he said, noting that Mistral AI would leverage the freshly raised capital to fund a big expansion of its models, for which the company sees growing appetite. Mistral AI has been a supporter of open-weight AI models—those that are publicly available for anyone to down-

load and modify—saying they give users the flexibility to tailor them to their needs while protecting their data and intellectual property. Despite investor support, Mistral AI remains significantly smaller compared with U.S. rivals like Anthropic and ChatGPT maker OpenAI, whose valuations are nearing \$1 trillion.

Verizon, Corning Ink Broadband Deal

By CONNOR HART

Verizon and **Corning** reached a multibillion-dollar agreement to deploy more than 80 million miles of high-density optical fiber across the U.S. over the coming five years. The companies on Tuesday said the deal will help meet surging demand for consumer broadband and converged services, accelerating Verizon’s push to bring internet access to more homes and businesses across the nation. The deal also will help build out the national long-haul backbone required by AI hyperscalers, supporting emerging artificial-intelligence needs, the companies added. High-density fiber is essential to support the growing scale of large language models, because heavy AI workloads

demand near-zero latency and massive throughput, according to Verizon. By expanding this critical interconnectivity, Verizon said it is cementing its position as a premier infrastructure partner for AI hyperscalers. “Securing this volume of fiber allows us to continue building the network of the future at an unprecedented scale,” said Kyle Malady, chief executive of Verizon Business. The agreement between Verizon and Corning is designed to enable Corning to continue to scale its U.S. manufacturing footprint, while also ensuring that Verizon has the physical materials needed to execute its convergence strategy and expand its long-haul AI corridors. Exact terms of the deal weren’t disclosed.

NextEra Energy Gets Nuclear-Plant Loan

By CONNOR HART

NextEra Energy said it reached a deal with the U.S. Department of Energy, closing on a loan of up to \$1.9 billion to support the restart of the company’s Duane Arnold Energy Center in Iowa. The deal—completed through the Energy Department’s Office of Energy Dominant Financing—marks a step toward restoring Iowa’s only nuclear plant and adding reliable, around-the-clock energy to the regional grid, NextEra said on Tuesday. The Duane Arnold Energy Center is a 615-megawatt nuclear facility in Linn County, Iowa. The plant’s restart is expected to create substantial economic benefits for Iowa and the surrounding region,

NextEra said. NextEra last October announced plans to restart the Duane Arnold Energy Center by the first quarter of 2029, pending regulatory approvals. “By bringing new generation online to serve new demand, we can strengthen the grid, create hundreds of good-paying jobs and help ensure Iowa families and businesses are not asked to bear the costs of growth,” Chief Executive John Ketchum said. “We appreciate the Administration’s leadership in advancing America’s nuclear renaissance and share its commitment to an all-of-the-above energy strategy that expands supply, strengthens energy security and keeps America competitive,” he added.

U.S. Gets Stakes in Quantum Firms

By ADRIANO MARCHESE

The U.S. government is taking minority equity stakes in **D-Wave Quantum**, **Rigetti Computing**, and **Quantinuum** with a combined \$300 million CHIPS Act deal that funds the three companies to scale quantum-computing research. The companies will each receive \$100 million from the U.S. Department of Commerce, structured as a research-and-development grant under the CHIPS Act, the companies said on Tuesday. As part of the grants, the Commerce Depart-

ment will take a minority stake in each of the three companies as it looks to support the development of domestic semiconductor and advanced-hardware supply chains. Quantinuum shares rose 1.7% to \$50.47, while D-Wave shares climbed 6.6% to \$17.70. Rigetti’s stock advanced 4% to \$15.81. Under the terms of Rigetti’s agreement with the Commerce Department, the company will deploy the new funds to address technical bottlenecks in scaling superconducting quantum processors, expanding cryogenic

capacity, and speeding up manufacturing at specialized manufacturing facilities. British Columbia-based D-Wave said it will use the new money to advance microelectronics research and development around prototyping of advanced semiconductor technology for quantum technology and scalable high-performance quantum hardware. For Quantinuum, the award focuses heavily on building out scalable, reliable integrated photonics engines through domestic partnerships. The company said it will

partner with **GlobalFoundries** to fabricate next-generation ion traps and other electronics, and with Monarch Quantum to manufacture integrated lasers and optical components required for its systems. GlobalFoundries also finalized its deal with the U.S. government with its own \$375 million agreement to expand domestic quantum manufacturing capabilities. GlobalFoundries said the funding is aimed at securing critical technologies necessary to build scalable quantum processing units in the U.S.

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TECHNOLOGY

AstraZeneca Touts New COPD Drug

By ADRIÀ CALATAYUD

BARCELONA—**AstraZeneca** said its new drug for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease showed benefits across a broad patient population in late-stage clinical trials, boosting a medicine the company expects to generate multibillion-dollar sales.

The drug, tozorakimab, achieved reductions in moderate and severe COPD exacerbations—or lung attacks—by around 30% compared with the standard therapy in two

late-stage studies, the U.K. pharmaceutical company said Tuesday.

The company said the drug worked across patient subgroups, with a 43% reduction for those with the highest level of blood cells known as eosinophils, and a 23% decline for those with lower eosinophils.

In addition to reducing exacerbations, the drug also reduced mucus plugging in lungs, AstraZeneca said. Tozorakimab was generally well tolerated, it added.

“What we have seen in the

data is what we classify as a scientific breakthrough,” AstraZeneca’s biopharmaceuticals unit president, Ruud Dobber, said.

The trial results, published in the New England Journal of Medicine and presented at the European Respiratory Society Congress in Barcelona, could help AstraZeneca turn a page on a challenging few weeks. The failure of a heart-disease trial and takeover speculation hit its stock. The company declined to comment on the takeover reports.

AstraZeneca recently upgraded its annual peak sales estimate for tozorakimab to more than \$5 billion and said the medicine is set to be its largest respiratory product.

The COPD treatment market generated \$11.6 billion in sales for the pharma industry last year and is expected to grow to \$14.8 billion in 2033, according to data provider Evaluate. Tozorakimab is forecast to become the No. 3 COPD drug globally by sales in the early 2030s, according to Evaluate data.

GE Aerospace to Buy CPP for \$11.75 Billion

By COLIN KELLAHER
AND DREW FITZGERALD

GE Aerospace agreed to buy metal-castings provider Consolidated Precision Products for \$11.75 billion, placing a large bet on the materials needed to keep its advanced engines cool.

The engine maker said its purchase from private investment firms **Warburg Pincus** and **Berkshire Partners** will help the Evendale, Ohio, company meet surging demand for its engines. About 60% of CPP’s revenue came from commercial aerospace customers, with the remainder from defense, power and other markets.

GE Aerospace said it plans to fund the acquisition, slated to close in the second half of 2027, with \$7 billion in cash on hand and the remainder in new debt, adding that the deal doesn’t change its capital-allocation plans.

Engine makers like GE Aerospace, **RTX**’s Pratt & Whitney and others are struggling to keep up with growing orders for both commercial aircraft and military jets.

Soaring investment in artificial intelligence infrastructure also is spurring demand



GE Aerospace says the Consolidated Precision Products deal will help it meet engine demand.

for turbines to power data centers.

CPP’s airfoil technology helps keep engine surfaces cooler, which helps efficiency and durability. Airlines have struggled with engine-wear issues in recent years that have cut into their planes’ availability between shop visits.

“We’ve been working very hard with the engine suppliers to get those engines im-

proved so that they’re on-wing as long as the airlines have expected,” Boeing Chief Executive Kelly Ortberg said in a recent interview.

Cleveland-based CPP is one of four major makers of precision castings. Its purchase will help GE Aerospace build next-generation engines, shorten development cycles and ensure its plants are ready to meet demand, Sheila Kahyaoglu, an analyst at in-

vestment bank Jefferies, wrote in a note to clients.

SpaceX has meanwhile started work on a new factory to forge turbine parts for its own needs. But the market is hard to break into without significant capital.

“Once the equipment is in place, reaching mature manufacturing yields of 75%+ can take years, up to decades” for some advanced technology, Kahyaoglu wrote.

Google Cloud Joins Accenture to Better Integrate AI Tools

By ISABELLE BOUSQUETTE

Google Cloud and **Accenture** are the latest companies to bet that forward-deployed engineers are key to unlocking business value from generative AI.

The two companies have formed Accenture Gemini Enterprise Business Group, a new unit at the professional-services firm aimed at helping customers deploy Google Cloud’s agentic AI platform.

As part of the arrangement, **Alphabet**’s Google Cloud will help train up to 1,000 Accenture forward-deployed engineers, or FDEs, who will work with clients on-site to plan and build AI applications on the Gemini Enterprise platform. The group will also include other experts from Accenture who will help scale FDE solutions and a small group of Google Cloud FDEs for limited engagements with top-tier customers.

“There’s a need for experts who can go and do these [things] for customers,” said Google Cloud Chief Executive Thomas Kurian.

News Corp, owner of The Wall Street Journal, has a commercial agreement to supply content on Google platforms.

It’s the latest in a series of bets made by AI companies that embedding their technologists directly inside customers’ offices—a business model initially popularized by **Palantir**—is the best way for enterprises to achieve meaningful returns on AI investments.

“Clients want clear value and they’re stuck,” said Accenture CEO Julie Sweet.

Companies today are looking for growth, investment capacity and real impact on their bottom line, Sweet said. “We promised AI can do that. And they’re like, ‘We get it, except it’s not happening, help us make it happen.’”

Nearly four years after the debut of ChatGPT, the return on investment on enterprise adoption continues to be hit or miss, driven in part by companies’ struggles to integrate AI tools into corporate systems and customize them for specific business needs.

On a deeper level, said Kurian, companies also struggle with understanding how their business processes can be redesigned with AI, and how to make organizational and labor

changes as a result.

The new group is designed to help with that, he said.

Before the formalization of this new group, Sweet said Accenture already had FDEs. The company has typically deployed one or multiple “pods” into an organization. Those pods contain not only FDEs, responsible for building actual solutions, but also industry, process and data experts, who work both with the company’s internal IT department as well as, increasingly, with functional heads, like chief financial officers.

The Accenture Gemini Enterprise Business Group enters a crowded market as tech companies are under pressure to speed up adoption.

Isabelle Bousquette writes for WSJ Leadership Institute’s CIO Journal.

CRAFTING CAPITAL

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THE PROPERTY REPORT

San Francisco’s Comeback Has Big Hole

The city’s largest and once-thriving mall, closed this year, is on market

By KATE KING AND JIM CARLTON

SAN FRANCISCO—This city has a 1.5-million-square-foot hole in its AI-fueled renaissance: the downtown site of what was its biggest mall.

Not long ago, San Francisco Centre was a thriving retail destination, with a luxury day spa, nine-screen movie theater and department stores Nordstrom and Bloomingdale’s drawing huge crowds. But the mall got sucked into a downward spiral during the pandemic. A surge in crime and homelessness followed.

The Market Street property closed earlier this year. A proposed sale collapsed in July.

Now, the mall is back on the market, with bids due Wednesday. Brokers expect it to sell for no more than \$130 million—a shockingly meager sum compared with its \$1.2 billion valuation a decade ago.

“It was such a trophy mall,” said Vince Tibone, head of U.S. retail and industrial research at real-estate analytics firm Green Street. “It’s had quite the demise.”

Today, tall wooden boards topped with wire block off the San Francisco Centre’s beaux-arts-style front entrance. The sidewalk is stained with urine.

The mall’s struggles contrast sharply with most of the rest of the city, where investment in artificial intelligence is powering much of the comeback. The retail scene, housing market and office sector are flourishing. Job postings and venture-capital fundraising are way up. Rents



The San Francisco Centre mall is expected to sell for up to \$130 million, far less than its valuation of \$1.2 billion a decade ago.

in San Francisco are now back to the highest in the U.S.

Before Covid struck, San Francisco Centre was one of the top shopping destinations in the Bay Area. Annual sales of more than \$1,000 a square foot put it in the top tier of mall-sales performance at a time when many other of these properties had fallen out of favor.

The mall was closed intermittently for seven months in 2020. When it reopened, shoplifting and homelessness kept the crowds away. They never returned.

In 2022, total sales at the mall were 35% below 2019 lev-

els. Nordstrom delivered a critical blow in 2023 when it announced it would close, kicking off an exodus of retailers from the center, including Bloomingdale’s. The mall’s owner, **Unibail-Rodamco-Westfield**, said six weeks later that it would stop making loan payments and turn the shopping center over to its lenders.

By last year, the nine-level complex looked more like a ghost town: 93% of its more than 1.5 million square feet were vacant. It was losing millions of dollars a year.

The mall’s lenders, who were owed \$558 million when

the former owner walked away, reached a \$130 million deal in March with two local firms to buy and redevelop the mall. But it fell through in July after the buyers decided the mall would be too complicated to redevelop.

San Francisco officials and retail analysts expect the mall will be repurposed into something else. Real-estate services firm **CBRE** is marketing the property for sale.

One potential bidder, local developer Urban Land Development, is exploring opening a multilevel sports complex in the former Nordstrom store that would include volleyball

and soccer facilities as well as the basketball training program 94 Feet of Game, founded by NBA assistant coach and Bay Area native Phil Handy.

The previous deal fell through after the firms, Presidio Bay and Prado Group, spent months on due diligence and concluded the mall’s complicated ownership structure and required approvals from city officials and others would make the urban mall too difficult to redevelop.

The former Bloomingdale’s space, for example, is owned by the department store’s parent company, **Macy’s Inc.**

Presidio Bay and Prado Group had reached a deal to purchase Bloomingdale’s space, but further complications remained. A portion of the land underneath the mall is owned by the San Francisco Unified School District, which has been leasing it to the mall’s owners.

“These mall redevelopments are so complex, requiring so many different parties to be on board,” said Tibone, of Green Street.

Many of the streets surrounding San Francisco Centre are faring better. A new **Ross Stores** was bustling with customers on a recent afternoon.

Apparel chain Uniqlo is returning with a new flagship after leaving the city five years ago. Mi Cocina, the kitchenware and outdoor-accessories retailer, left the mall and is reopening nearby this month.

“The market is healthy,” said Alex Sagues, a senior vice president at CBRE. “Would it be better if the mall was open and operating? Yes, definitely.”

Still, there are some positive signs for the mall’s future. The school district has agreed to extend, through options, the property’s ground lease through 2082, a move expected to reassure potential buyers.

And mall prices are up 13% over the past year, according to Green Street, as more investors become convinced that malls aren’t as risky and ill-fated as previously feared.

But the clock is ticking for San Francisco Centre, which costs millions of dollars a year to maintain, even while closed, and will likely run out of cash within months, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Blackstone’s Head of Real Estate Is Leaving the Company

By CRAIG KARMIN AND PETER GRANT

Blackstone’s global head of real estate is leaving the firm, according to people familiar with the matter, latest in a recent wave of departures from one of the world’s largest and most successful commercial-property investors.

Nadeem Meghji is stepping down from his position, Blackstone confirmed, less than a year after taking sole control of Blackstone’s real-estate business. Previously, Meghji was co-head of global real estate with Kathleen McCarthy, who left in 2025 after 15 years

at Blackstone.

About a dozen senior managing directors have departed Blackstone’s real-estate group over the past three years or so. Blackstone has 45 senior managing directors in the real-estate group, with an average tenure of 14 years.

Meghji, who was at Blackstone for nearly 20 years, is leaving for personal reasons and to spend more time with his family, said people familiar with the situation.

In his place, Blackstone has elevated two other veteran real-estate executives to take over as co-heads of the business. They are David Levine

who was head of Blackstone’s real estate group in the Americas, and Giovanni Cutaita, who was president of the real-estate business. Each has been at Blackstone for at least 12 years.

With a global real-estate portfolio valued at more than \$600 billion, Blackstone has for years been one of the world’s largest real-estate investors. The New York firm has said it employs more than 800 real-estate professionals across about a dozen global offices for property investments.

Blackstone today manages more than \$1.3 trillion in businesses including private eq-

uity, infrastructure and hedge funds. But the firm made one of its earliest splashes in real estate partly by buying distressed assets following the recession of the early 1990s.

The firm built its reputation on some of the industry’s biggest deals, including its acquisitions of Hilton Hotels, the Bellagio hotel and casino in Las Vegas and the sky-scraping Willis Tower in Chicago. More recently, it has poured billions of dollars into data centers and rental housing, two of its largest investment themes.

Meghji joined Blackstone in 2008 and rose through the

ranks to become head of real estate for the Americas in 2017. He was promoted to global co-head of real estate in 2024, overseeing the business alongside McCarthy, and later became global head.

Over the years, Blackstone’s real-estate business has notched a series of industry milestones. In 2023, it closed a \$30.4 billion global real-estate fund, the largest real-estate or private-equity drawdown fund ever raised.

About one year earlier, Blackstone sold the Cosmopolitan of Las Vegas for \$5.65 billion, generating about \$4.1 billion in profit, including cash

flow from operations, in what the firm called its most profitable single-asset real-estate sale ever.

Blackstone’s real-estate group also has weathered some turbulence. Beginning in late 2022, investors rushed to pull money out of its giant Blackstone Real Estate Income Trust, known as Breit, forcing the fund to limit withdrawals for more than one year.

Those pressures have since eased. Breit began satisfying all redemption requests in early 2024, and in the second quarter of this year, it recorded its first positive net inflow in four years.

New Highs and Lows

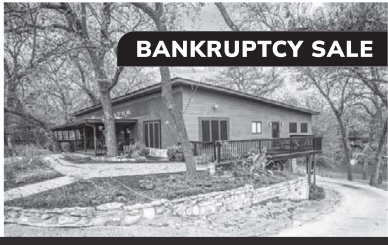
The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % **CHG**-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Tuesday, September 8, 2026											
Stock	52-Wk %			Stock	52-Wk %			Stock	52-Wk %		
	Sym	Hi/Lo	Chg		Sym	Hi/Lo	Chg		Sym	Hi/Lo	Chg
Highs											
AdamisPDE	ADAM	25.73	0.4	ArtesianRscsA	ARTNA	36.98	1.1				
AlgonquinN2079	AQNB	26.39	...	AtrtCure	ATRC	55.72	4.4				
AmOutdoorBrands	AOUT	16.09	2.0	AttiViaTherap	ATTO	28.00	-7.4				
ArceclonMittal	MT	79.68	-2.0	BUUU	BUUU	45.25	9.7				

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Sold Individually or in Any Combination

Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg	Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg	Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg	Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg	Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg	Stock	Sym	52-Wk % Hi/Lo Chg
Continental	FRO	47.22 1.1	Nomura	NMR	10.79 -0.2	Terium	TX	58.73 0.2	Arbor Realty Pfd	ARBRE	15.31 -0.1	ChampionsGate	CHPR	0.10 -0.1			
bioAffinity9	GIX	10.00 0.1	NorthStrive	NSAI	9.88	TXO Partners	TXO	15.35 0.2	Assurant	NTS261	AIZN	17.85 0.1	ClearmindMed	CHMD	0.92 -11.2		
Blossum Hill	GBTG	9.56	OceansOfKane	EKO	72.75 -2.1	Team	TSI	28.05 -3.3	AtumTherap	RNA	10.75 -20.0	Cleco	CLIN	3.60 -4.0			
CSMTECH	GLP	53.74 0.8	Oppenheimer	A	125.88 0.2	TechResources	BTEK	72.56 4.2	B&G Foods	BGS	3.23 0.3	CN Finance	CNF	1.94 -8.6			
CSLM Digital	DINO	109.86 2.8	OpenEnergySys	OESX	30.75 22.1	Torm	TRMD	35.58 0.7	Bio-key	BKEY	2.65 -5.0	CollegiumPharm	COLL	23.11 -0.7			
CVR Energy	HCAC	10.11 0.3	PeaceAcq	PECE	10.02 0.1	TraillabzerAcq	BLZR	10.24 -0.1	BardMedivnt	WV	0.04 -18.8	ColumbusAcq	COLA	10.00 -3.1			
CalacaAcq	ALIS	10.40 0.2	Pharvatis	PHVS	43.25 7.3	UltraparPart	UPP	750.23	BankofAmPfdH	BACPH	23.10 -0.3	ConevanceSciences	CSNA	1.65 -5.8			
CastorMaritime	HSCS	4.35 9.4	Phillips66	PSX	26.100 1.6	UnitedHartline	USA	3.16 -3.0	BankofAmPfdL	BACPL	18.78 -0.3	ConstBrands	A	STZ	120.43 -5.6		
HennessyCapVII	HSV	18.86 -1.0	PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	26.00 1.0	ValeroEnergy	VLO	384.26 3.3	BankofAmPfdH	BACPH	18.78 -0.3	Coupage	CPNG	14.70 -3.1			
Humana	IDT	70.00 -0.7	PonoCapFour	PONO	10.09 ...	Vodafone	VOD	17.35 2.4	BarfieldFood	BRFH	1.19 -1.6	Curis	CRIS	1.26 -5.9			
ING Groep	ING	37.52 -1.1	PrivateBncpAmer	PRAM	91.43	WesternAllanco	WAL	25.13 0.1	Beneficient	BNF	1.78 -23.0	CKAP	CKAP	3.14 -7.9			
IntlSeaways	INSW	106.73 -0.7	ProemAcqntv	PRACV	0.50 4.3	VNAcpl	VNA	12.00 0.2	BeyondAir	BG	3.32 -4.2	DOC Enterprise	DOC	0.29 -3.0			
IoncDigital	IOND	85.00 7.6	QuanexBldg	NG	23.33 -3.1	YorkvilleCap	YIC	9.98 0.1	BlnahCapital	BRC	1.20 -7.7	DHL Holdings	DHLH	3.93 -2.9			
IrisAcqntl	IRAB	10.08 -0.1	RangCapItAcqntl	RNGT	10.19 -0.1	ZimintShipping	ZIM	30.40 5.2	BioRestorative	BRTX	2.70 -5.5	DTE Energy	DTE	15.56 -0.9			
JamesHardie	JHX	31.43 -1.7	RedRiverBscht	RRBI	104.65 -0.2				BraggGaming	BRAG	1.28 -3.0	DTE Energy	DTE	15.51 -1.1			
K2CapitalAcq	K2AC	10.10 ...	RhinebeckBncp	RBNB	13.23 2.0				BrightSpire	BSP	4.61 -1.1	Decoy Therap	DCOY	2.63 -2.2			
LakeShoreBancorp	LSBK	18.13 3.6	RileyOpn	REK	43.27 2.1				BrookWealth	BWT	39.27 -2.3	DigitalCurx	DCX	0.50 1.5			
LandmarkBncp	LARK	32.72 0.7	RiverCityBank	RCBC	54.88 -0.1	Amerisafe	AMSF	24.82 -4.2	CDT Equity	CDT	0.58 -1.3	DigitalRealty	DTK	21.55 -0.7			
Lincolntel	LCIN	19.55 -1.1	RivernorthOppst	RNV	0.44 700.0	AdCo	ADCA	16.65 -0.6	CEA Inds Wt	BICW	0.01 -55.1	Dominari	DOMH	2.02 -3.8			
MainStreetBscht	MSBS	25.87 0.7	RoivantSciences	ROIV	42.50 18.7	AlcoHealth	AHG	0.80 -3.7	CMSEnerBldg	CEB	0.03 -22.3	DukeEnergy	DUK	0.43 -0.5			
MarathonPetrol	MPC	39.62 2.3	SCIAcqua	SCI	10.15 0.1	Amberint	AMBR	0.83 7.5	CardenalTherap	CTH	0.31 -5.0	ECONOV	ECOV	0.03 -22.3			
Marex	MRX	79.11 -2.0	SachemCapPfdA	SCPA	22.47 2.2	Armentum	AMTM	19.68 0.4	CalMedica	CALC	1.99 -6.9	EGAN	EGAN	5.13 -0.8			
Materialise	MTLS	7.67 1.3	SaratogaNts31	SAX	25.00 0.3				CanadaGoose	GOOS	7.74 -4.8	Enbridge	ENBD	4.25 -0.2			
WestflowAcqntv	WESH	0.55 1.4	Shell	SHL	95.81 2.5	AmorStratvnt	NYC	5.82 -0.3	CarlyleNts206	CGBL	15.84 -0.1	Equifax	EFXA	19.75 -0.2			
WestflowAcqntv	WESH	10.13 0.3	SidellAcq	SHD	10.53 0.2	AntibioBiotech	ANBN	6.20 -0.9	CarriageSvcs	CSV	32.94 -2.7	ElionPower	ELPW	2.80 -5.7			
NMP Acqntv	NMP	10.37 0.3	Star	SHG	29.42 4.5	AnnovisBio	ANVS	1.30 -6.5	Cato	CTO	2.54 -2.2	ElongWorkPfd	ELWP	2.80 -5.7			
NSTS Bancorp	NSTS	14.14 0.6	SunocoCorp	SUNC	82.05 2.5	Apartmentv	AIV	2.48 -3.1	CaysonAcqntv	CAPNR	0.99 -52.6	Energyservice	EREC	7.49 0.9			
NaviosMaritime	NMM	92.70 -2.1	Swiwi	SWVL	6.87 30.2	ApimedPharm	APUS	2.25 -5.0	Cerenome	CPR	7.49 0.9	Continued on Page 10					

Continued on Page B10

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or “physical” commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

Tuesday			Tuesday			Tuesday		
Energy			Food			Food		
Coal,C,Apic,12500Btu,1.2502-r,w	81.000		BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, >99.5%-v/w	23150		Beef,carcass equiv, index		
Coal,Pwdr,RvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8502-r,w	14.500		BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, >56.5%-v/w	21050		choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	345.76	
Metals			BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5%-v/w	10132		select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	324.66	
			BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v/k	4381		Broilers, National comp wtd, avg.-u,w	1.1640	
			BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, >100 Mesh, 94-95%-v/m	425		Butter, AA Chicago-d	1.4025	
Fibers and Textiles						Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	153.25	
Gold,per troy oz	4415.00		Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-v,w	1.2800		Cheddar cheese,bk,Chicago-d	146.25	
Engelhard industrial	n.a.		Cotton,11/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.7889		Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	189.25	
Kruggerand,wholesale-e	n.a.		Cooklook 'A' Index-t	*96.00		Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.0113	
Maple Leaf-e	n.a.		Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.		Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.6721	
American Eagle-e	n.a.		Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.		Eggs,large white,Chicago-y,w	0.6550	
Mexican peso-e	n.a.					Flour,hard winter KC-p	20.15	
Austria crown-e	n.a.					Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.	
Austria phil-e	n.a.					Hogs,Iowa-S0, Minnesota-t	86.37	
Grains and Feeds						Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	2.0066	
Engelhard industrial	66.9000		Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	140		Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.0794	
Handy & Harman base	66.2150		Corn,No.2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	4.9900		Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.	
Handy & Harman fabricated	82.7690		Cottonseed meal-u,w	320		Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	n.a.	
Coins,wholesale \$1,000 face-a	47066		Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	120				
Other metals			Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	443				
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1859.0		Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u,w	3.8000				
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1386.0		Rice,Long Grain Mills, No.2 AR-u,w	30.13				
Aluminum,LME, % per metric ton	*3310.0		SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,urai,ton48%-u,w	350.20		Degummed corn oil, crude wtd, avg.-u,w	n.a.	
Copper,Comex spot	6.7390		Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	12.9100		Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.7100	
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*100.1		Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u,w	8.9900		Lard,Chicago-h	0.7201	
Steel,HRCS,USA, FOB Midwest Mills-	*n.a.		Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u,w	6.9450		Soybean oil,crude,Cent IL-u,w	0.7600	
Battery/EV metals			Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) \$ per bu-u	7.8500		Tallow,bleach,Chicago-h	0.7600	
			Wheat-No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.8000		Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.	

COMMODITIES

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Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures							
	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest	
Copper-High (CMX) -25,000 lbs.; \$ per lb.							
Sept	6.7100	6.7825	6.7085	6.7390	0.1420	2,496	
Dec	6.7055	6.8730	6.7020	6.8235	0.1410	168,842	
Gold (CMX) -100 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.							
Sept	4401.90	4406.10	4384.40	4393.90	-35.90	419	
Oct	4421.20	4453.70	4348.60	4405.20	-36.70	45,504	
Nov	4441.20	4469.90	4379.00	4422.70	-37.20	743	
Dec	4451.60	4488.80	4381.00	4439.00	-37.60	319,343	
Jan'27	4467.70	4469.10	4460.00	4458.40	-37.90	545	
Feb	4492.40	4522.50	4418.00	4474.50	-38.10	32,697	
Palladium (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.							
Sept	1399.50	1404.00	1390.00	1355.60	-34.50	4	
Dec	1406.50	1423.50	1360.00	1369.10	-34.80	16,060	
Platinum (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.							
Sept	1853.00	1887.90	1853.00	1848.20	27.20	36	
Oct	1839.70	1860.00	1819.90	1853.20	27.20	41,955	
Silver (CMX) -5,000 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.							
Sept	65.915	65.935	65.830	66.297	0.250	402	
Dec	66.820	67.835	66.140	67.000	0.252	86,671	
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM) -1,000 bbls.; \$ per bbl.							
Oct	92.69	94.73	▲	91.82	93.03	1.55	231,068
Nov	89.54	91.44	▲	89.04	90.19	1.62	197,229
Dec	86.25	88.10	▲	85.98	87.14	1.68	203,637
Jan'27	83.48	85.21	▲	83.27	84.46	1.68	120,326
June	74.99	76.00	▲	74.87	75.72	1.02	127,311
Dec	71.40	71.93	▲	71.28	71.70	0.47	167,135
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.							
Oct	4.6704	4.7369	▲	4.5599	4.5678	0.0276	62,008
Nov	4.5014	4.5620	▲	4.3914	4.4195	0.0358	50,963
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.							
Oct	3.2246	3.3269	▲	3.2180	3.2525	0.0379	96,353
Nov	3.0205	3.1093	▲	3.0203	3.0653	0.0518	74,494
Natural Gas (NYM) -10,000 MMBtu.; \$ per MMBtu.							
Oct	2.964	3.014	2.863	2.916	-0.059	304,684	
Nov	3.090	3.122	2.995	3.041	-0.054	282,739	
Dec	3.523	3.555	3.461	3.511	-0.018	178,430	
Jan'27	3.909	3.924	▼	3.840	3.893	-0.009	183,059
March	2.912	2.934	2.881	2.929	0.022	163,563	
April	2.779	2.798	2.758	2.792	0.025	129,493	
Agriculture Futures							
Corn (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Sept	512.75	515.50		509.75	511.00	-1.00	1,259
Soybeans (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Sept	356.00	356.00		356.00	350.25	6.75	
Dec	367.75	377.25		366.50	375.00	6.25	2,903
Soybean Meal (CBT) -5,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	1298.00	1298.25		1297.75	1302.50	8.75	68
Nov	1315.25	1321.25		1304.00	1316.25	6.50	487,000
Soybean Meal (CBT) -100 tons; \$ per ton.							
Sept	344.50	344.50		340.80	341.80	-3.50	47
Dec	355.10	355.80		348.00	349.80	-5.30	325,378
Soybean Oil (CBT) -60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	68.66	68.74		68.42	70.10	1.40	177
Dec	69.67	70.82		69.14	70.70	1.43	253,479
Rough Rice (CBT) -2,000 cwt.; \$ per cwt.							
Sept	15.19	15.19		15.14	15.48	.10	75
Nov	15.85	15.96		15.70	15.94	.07	11,721
Wheat (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Sept	730.00	730.00		728.00	730.25	14.25	151
Dec	746.50	763.00		736.50	747.00	13.00	261,571
Wheat (KC) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Sept	806.00	806.00		797.50	804.75	18.00	73
Dec	817.00	831.75		807.00	819.00	16.75	170,615
Cattle-Feeder (CME) -50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	325.50	329.250		324.90	328.875	4.050	6,301
Oct	321.250	325.850		320.200	325.450	5.300	24,048
Cattle-Live (CME) -40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Oct	213.500	217.100		213.175	217.025	4.075	98,514
Dec	215.500	219.400		215.200	219.225	4.500	85,270
Hogs-Lean (CME) -40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Oct	82.625	84.500		82.550	84.250	1.950	122,335
Dec	72.775	75.700		72.550	75.500	2.575	83,064
Lumber (CME) -27,500 bd. ft. \$ per 1,000 bd. ft.							
Sept	566.50	577.50		565.00	571.00	2.50	1,021
Nov	566.50	569.50		557.50	568.00	1.50	8,629
Milk (CME) -20,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	16.18	16.18	▼	16.07	16.11	-0.07	5,884
Oct	16.30	16.40	▼	16.12	16.19	-0.20	7,428
Cocoa (ICE-US) 10 metric tons; \$ per ton.							
Sept	6,080	6,080		6,080	5,886	-196	132
Dec	6,119	6,237		5,730	5,913	-275	77,154
Coffee (ICE-US) -37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	313.80	313.80		313.80	318.45	-5.80	57
Dec	295.80	296.30		286.60	291.30	-4.30	85,307
Sugar-Wato (ICE-US) -112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Oct	18.17	18.45		17.89	18.10	.03	415,014
March'27	19.10	19.39		18.87	19.09	.04	429,217

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%)	Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices						
2238.64	-0.4	U.S. Aggregate	5.060	4.160	5.070	
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices						
3422.88	-0.6	U.S. Corporate	5.560	4.680	5.560	
3386.52	0.2	Intermediate	5.280	4.330	5.280	
4340.24	-2.4	Long term	6.190	5.370	6.230	
634.48	-2.0	Double-A-rated	5.460	4.410	5.460	
942.88	-0.2	Triple-B-rated	5.720	4.860	5.720	
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA						
632.72	2.5	High Yield Constrained	7.320	6.489	7.668	
631.99	0.6	Triple-C-rated	14.484	11.478	14.484	
4209.80	2.2	High Yield 100	6.545	5.828	7.136	
551.14	2.7	Global High Yield Constrained	7.072	6.317	7.438	
401.41	1.6	Europe High Yield Constrained	5.821	4.820	6.198	
U.S. Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices						
1966.93	0.4	U.S. Agency	4.700	3.830	4.700	
1746.77	0.6	10-20 years	4.640	3.750	4.640	
3655.68	-1.5	20-plus years	5.390	4.580	5.400	
3036.91	-0.04	Yankee	5.210	4.320	5.210	

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds

**EMBI Global Index

*In local currency \$ Euro-zone bonds

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%)	Latest(●)	1	2	3	4	5	6	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points	Latest	Prev	Year ago
4.125	U.S. 2	4.396	▲							4.379	4.203	3.494				
4.625	10	4.805	▲							4.783	4.657	4.045				
2.250	Australia 2	4.815	▼							4.819	4.571	3.364	■	40.9	44.7	-13.3
4.250	10	5.199	▲							5.190	4.993	4.290	■	39.1	40.1	24.7
2.400	France 2	3.169	▼							3.191	2.911	2.161	■	-122.8	-118.1	-133.6
3.700	10	4.226	▼							4.251	3.918	3.410	■	-58.2	-53.8	-63.4
2.700	Germany 2	3.006	▼							3.012	2.756	1.937	■	-140.0	-136.1	-156.1
3.000	10	3.380	▼							3.400	3.148	2.646	■	-142.8	-138.9	-139.7
2.650	Italy 2	3.173	▼							3.167	2.916	2.161	■	-125.8	-120.5	-133.6
3.800	10	4.177	▲							4.203	3.897	3.470	■	-63.1	-58.6	-57.3
1.700	Japan 2	1.850	▼							1.856	1.609	0.831	■	-255.6	-251.6	-266.6
2.700	10	2.896	▼							2.933	2.802	1.568	■	-191.2	-185.6	-247.5
2.400	Spain 2	3.011	▼							3.027	2.788	2.012	■	-139.5	-134.5	-148.5
3.400	10	3.793	▼							3.825	3.566	3.168	■	-101	-96.4	-87.5
4.375	U.K. 2	4.481	▲							4.466	4.285	3.885	■	7.5	9.4	38.8
1.125	10	5.106	▼							5.106	4.927	4.609	■	29.8	31.7	56.6

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points		
					Current	One-day change	Last week
Sumitomo Mitsui Banking	---	4.936	4.90	Sept. 10, '29	47	-68	n.a.
Oracle	ORCL	5.375	7.31	July 15, '40	252	-5	256
TWDC Enterprises 18	---	7.000	5.01	March 1, '32	44	-1	42
Intesa Sanpaolo	---	6.625	5.48	June 20, '33	69	-1	68

...And spreads that widened the most

Svenska Handelsbanken	---	4.625	4.95	June 11, '31	38	7	36
NatWest Markets	---	4.174	4.79	Nov. 6, '28	40	6	44
SBA Communications	SBAC	4.875	5.21	Jan. 15, '30	76	6	73
Mizuho Financial Group	---	2.564	5.56	Sept. 13, '31	98	4	94
Banco Santander	---	5.439	5.25	July 15, '31	69	4	64
Skandinaviska Enskilda Banken	---	4.375	5.06	March 12, '31	50	4	53
John Deere Capital	---	4.200	5.01	March 10, '31	44	3	44
Coca-Cola	KO	1.650	4.77	June 1, '30	23	3	18

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value		
					Current	One-day change	Last week
AAdvantage Loyalty IP	---	5.750	5.75	April 20, '29	100.000	0.06	100.048
...And with the biggest price decreases							
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.750	6.91	July 1, '36	98.873	-0.23	99.747
Occidental Petroleum	OXY	6.450	5.77	Sept. 15, '36	105.117	-0.11	105.616
Rakuten Group	---	9.750	6.09	April 15, '29	108.661	-0.08	109.000
Paramount Global	---	6.875	7.97	April 30, '36	92.710	-0.04	93.097

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt; change in spread shown is for Z-spread. Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

	Contract						Open	
	Open	High	Low	Settle	Chg		interest	
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US) -112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.								
Nov	37.00	37.00	37.00	38.00	...	639		
Cotton (ICE-US) -50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.								
Oct	84.02	84.02	82.31	82.64	.22	180		
Dec	86.40	87.48	85.56	86.32	-0.1	187,518		
Orange Juice (ICE-US) -15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.								
Sept	132.60	132.60	132.60	132.60	-5.55	95		
Nov	154.80	157.65	147.25	150.60	-5.55	8,277		
Interest Rate Futures								
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - \$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%								
Sept	110-080	111-030	110-060	110-090	-10.0	13,113		
Dec	110-000	110-220	109-180	109-270	-10.0	2,385,261		
Treasury Bonds (CBT) - \$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%								
Sept	109-020	109-140	109-010	108-290	-10.0	4,519		
Dec	108-150	109-040	108-060	108-120	-10.0	1,800,339		
Treasury Notes (CBT) - \$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%								
Sept	107-200	107-270	107-170	107-185	-5.0	45,268		
Dec	107-115	107-190	107-080	107-100	-5.0	5,190,795		
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT) - \$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%								
Sept	105-200	105-237	105-192	105-190	-3.2	21,608		
Dec	105-150	105-200	105-127	105-140	-3.2	6,295,956		
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT) - \$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%								
Sept	102-235	102-244	102-221	102-222	-1.0	61,289		
Dec	102-177	102-194	102-164	102-169	-1.1	4,296,884		
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT) - \$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.								
Sept	96.3025	96.3050	96.3000	96.3025	.0000	241,034		
Dec	96.2150	96.2200	96.2100	96.2150	.0000	649,719		
Three-Month SOFR (CME) - \$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.								
June	96.3525	96.3550	▼ 96.3500	96.3500	-0.0025	1,335,309		
Dec	95.9400	95.9600	▼ 95.9300	95.9350	-0.0050	1,742,223		
Currency Futures								
Japanese Yen (CME) - ¥12,500,000; \$ per 100¥								
Sept	.6482	.6544	.6478	.6511	.0106	285,303		
Dec	.6528	.6590	.6524	.6557	.0107	203,520		
Canadian Dollar (CME) - CAD 100,000; \$ per CAD								
Sept	.7241	.7270	.7241	.7259	.0030	264,061		
Dec	.7271	.7300	.7271	.7289	.0031	72,669		
British Pound (CME) - £62,500; \$ per £								
Sept	1.3543	1.3563	1.3521	1.3546	.0032	186,097		
Dec	1.3546	1.3564	1.3524	1.3548	.0032	130,061		
Swiss Franc (CME) - CHF 125,000; \$ per CHF								
Sept	1.2363	1.2388	1.2322	1.2368	.0015	79,322		
Dec	1.2491	1.2516	1.2449	1.2496	.0015	70,202		
Australian Dollar (CME) - AUD 100,000; \$ per AUD								
Sept	.7218	.7230	.7205	.7221	.0019	298,132		
Dec	.7207	.7219	.7194	.7212	.0020	152,847		
Mexican Peso (CME) - MXN 500,000; \$ per MXN								
Sept	.05906	.05912	.05883	.05909	-0.00005	259,031		
Dec	.05861	.05870	.05842	.05866	-0.00006	77,522		
Euro (CME) - €125,000; \$ per €								
Sept	1.1628	1.1639	1.1611	1.1631	.0017	718,617		
Dec	1.1669	1.1679	1.1652	1.1672	.0017	156,415		
Index Futures								
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT) - \$5 x index								
Sept	53137	53185	52758	52832	-608	87,057		
Dec	53538	53590	53174	53243	-614	1,014		
Mini S&P 500 (CME) - \$50 x index								
Sept	7710.00	7725.75	7672.25	7680.50	-41.50	1,974,716		
Dec	7776.25	7792.75	7740.00	7747.25	-62.50	99,202		
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME) - \$50 x index								
Sept	3783.90	3793.90	3760.30	3762.60	-24.50	39,212		
Dec	3806.80	3806.90	3790.10	3791.30	-24.70	31		
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME) - \$20 x index								
Sept	29611.50	29764.75	29424.75	29538.75	-26.50	290,819		
Dec	29904.25	30061.25	29725.00	29834.25	-26.50	5,913		
Mini Russell 2000 (CME) - \$50 x index								
Sept	2970.60	2977.90	2954.70	2963.60	-13.00	422,342		
Dec	2992.40	2999.70	2976.80	2985.50	-13.10	1,616		
Mini Russell 1000 (CME) - \$50 x index								
Sept	4189.50	4191.40	4178.50	4181.10	-26.10	5,781		
Dec	...	...	...	4224.10	-27.30	15		
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US) - \$1,000 x index								
Sept	98.81	99.00	98.70	98.78	-3.37	35,362		
Dec	98.55	98.74	98.46	98.53	-3.37	19,516		
Source: FactSet								

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables							
The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.							
Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.							
Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was \$2 or higher.							
Footnotes: 1-New 52-week high; 1-New 52-week low; dd -Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.							
Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.							
Tuesday, September 8, 2026							
Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg	Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A B C							
AES	AES	14.83	0.04	Boeing	BA	210.73	-1.52
Aflac	AFL	115.16	-2.05	Booking	BKNG	180.30	-12.99
AGCO	AGCO	127.31	-6.09	BorgWarner	BWA	66.26	-1.28
AGNC Invnt	AGNC	10.68	0.03	BostonSci	BSX	44.98	-2.82
APA	APA	43.55	0.78	BridgBioPharma	BBIO	74.76	-0.08
ASE Tech	ASX	39.79	2.28	BrightSpring	BTSG	62.56	1.83
ASML	ASML	174.85	49.97	BrinkerInt'l	EBT	222.49	-7.73
AST Space T	ASTS	66.12	3.81	BristolMyers	BMRY	64.69	-1.31
ATI	ATI	20.32	-3.33	BritishAmBot	BTI	55.15	-0.20
AbbVie	ABBV	248.78	-7.68	Broadcom	AVGO	368.56	10.67
Abiavx	ABVX	118.95	4.16	BroadridgeFinl	BR	168.62	-4.26
Accenture	ACN	179.03	-6.99	BrookfieldAsset	BAM	48.87	-1.73
Acuity	AYI	325.46	-8.59	BrookfieldFinl	BFP	37.26	0.13
Adobe	ADBE	257.26	-9.25	BrookWearth	BNT	39.30	-0.94
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	133.67	-2.09	Brown&Brown	BRO	68.18	-3.24
AgriaEagleMines	AGS	288.72	7.82	Brown-Forman	BFB	26.39	-0.34
AirProducts	APD	291.71	-3.56	Bullish	BLSH	35.53	-0.47
Airbnb	ABNB	176.54	-7.40	BungeGlobal	BG	123.89	5.18
AkamaiTech	AKAM	105.61	0.39	BurlingtonSwp	BURL	255.42	-9.91
AlamosGold	AGI	36.45	-0.52	CACI Intl	CAI	625.31	1.70
Albermarle	ALB	129.57	10.08	CBRE Group	CBRE	142.26	-5.59
Alcoa	AA	51.74	1.77	CDW	CDW	144.48	-7.90
Alcon	ALC	69.12	-1.38	Cf Industries C	CF	134.33	0.98
Alibab	BABA	112.66	-5.87	CGI A	GIB	70.65	-3.00
Alight	ALIG	156.05	-1.08	CH Robinson	CHRW	150.10	2.46
AlliantEnergy	LNT	68.61	0.64	CME Group	CME	278.23	-3.06
AllisonTransm	ALSN	130.56	-0.68	CMS Energy	CMS	68.79	0.33
Allstate	ALL	253.46	-6.11	CNA Fin	CNA	47.77	-0.70
AllyFinancial	ALLY	42.28	-1.45	CNH Indl	CNI	13.60	-0.80
AmylinPharm	ALNY	260.10	-6.01	CRH	CRH	90.61	-3.65
Alphabet C	GOOGL	338.36	-0.10	CSX	CSX	49.00	-0.41
Altria	MO	68.17	-0.71	CVS Health	CVS	96.07	-0.67
Amazon.com	AMZN	256.97	-1.54	CardinalHealth	CAH	240.49	-6.69
Ambev	ABEV	3.04	0.02	Carlisle	CSL	341.48	-10.66
Ammcor	AMCR	44.34	-0.81	Carlyle	CY	45.95	-1.02
AmerSports	AS	28.69	-0.84	Carnival	CCL	23.20	-0.31
Ameren	AEE	106.73	1.01	CarpenterTech	CTP	104.71	-0.98
AmericaMovil	AMX	23.00	...	Cameco	CCO	50.90	0.44
AEP	AEP	125.42	0.92	CdnPacK C	CP	91.13	-0.47
AmerExpress	AXP	326.10	-0.06	CapitaOne	COF	213.96	-5.64
AmerHlthCntr	AFG	140.88	-1.84	CardinalHealth	CAH	240.49	-6.69
AmerHlthCREIT	AHR	54.60	-0.12	Carlsle	CSL	341.48	-10.66
AmfimesARent	AMH	32.30	-0.17	Casale	CAS	101.97	1.23
AIG	AIG	74.68	-1.53	Cencora	CVNA	74.72	0.13
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	175.73	-0.12	CaseyGenStores	CASY	73.49	-22.60
AngloGoldAsh	AWK	140.38	-0.32	Caterpillar	CAT	822.48	8.54
Ameriprise	AMP	556.67	-3.89	Celestica	CLS	329.97	17.62
Ametek	AME	237.76	0.04	ChartersComms	CHTR	145.74	-6.25
Amgen	AMGN	393.17	-44.06	Checkpoint	CHKP	132.90	-4.15
AmkorTech	AMKR	50.72	2.95	CheniereEnergy	LNG	276.02	-5.98
Amphenol	APH	81.76	-1.02	CheniereEnerPtpr	CQP	68.09	-6.14
Amrize	AMRZ	41.95	-1.87	Chevron	CVX	209.80	1.20
AnalogsDevics	ADI	363.20	0.95	Chewy	CHWY	23.27	-0.39
AS Inbev	BUD	79.73	-0.62	ChimeFinl	CHFM	32.31	-1.45
AnnalyCap	NLY	22.72	-0.09	Chipotle	CMG	36.96	...
AnteroMidstream	AM	22.90	0.30	Chubb	CB	336.64	-4.95
AnteroResources	AR	39.08	-0.33	ChungwaTel	CHT	44.23	0.41
Aon	AON	315.79	-7.30	Church&Dwight	CHD	96.54	-2.01

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg	Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg	Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
FactSet	FDS	289.00	-12.96	EchoStar	ECHO	93.42	3.62	GenDigital	GEN	29.81	-0.84
Fair Isaac	FICO	933.30	1.04	Ecobal	ECL	278.11	-1.17	Generac	GNRC	190.21	2.86
Fastenal	FAST	49.38	-0.22	Ecopetrol	EC	17.78	0.53	GeneralDynamics	GD	356.58	-2.81
Federal Realty	FRT	117.25	0.16	EdisonIntl	EIX	59.33	2.56	GeneralMills	GIS	37.69	-0.60
FedEx	FDX	314.13	-8.39	EdwardsLife	EW	86.72	-3.18	GeneralMotors	GM	85.79	-1.97
FedEx Freight	FDX	129.07	-0.38	ElancoAnimal	ELAN	23.97	-0.53	Genmab	GNAB	33.53	-0.07
FergusonEnts	FERG	226.30	-2.11	Elastic	ESTC	38.42	-3.39	GenuineParts	GPC	134.06	-4.02
Ferrari	RACE	405.94	-0.40	ElbitSystems	ESST	208.51	5.23	Gildan	GIL	51.55	-1.85
Ferrovial	FER	57.99	-0.06	ElidoroGold	EGO	43.88	0.86	GileadSciences	GILD	146.64	-4.36
FidNatFinl	FIN	44.65	-1.13	ElvanceHealth	ELV	401.94	5.56	Glaukos	GKOS	185.04	7.57
FidNatInfo	FIG	39.42	-2.47	Embraer	EMBJ	73.91	0.10	GlobalPayments	GPN	89.42	-3.12
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	54.51	-0.36	Emera	EMA	50.76	0.41	GlobalFoundries	GFS	45.09	-0.12
Figma	FIG	22.75	-1.37	EmersionElec	EMR	152.15	-0.67	Globalstar	GSAT	82.22	-0.12
FirstCitizBschA	FCNA	2149.93	-58.56	Embridge	ENB	50.48	-0.39	GlobalLife	GL	170.68	-3.59
FirstHorizon	FHN	24.67	-0.27	EncompassHealth	EH	120.47	-1.32	GlobusMedical	GMD	75.04	-3.25
FirstMajSilver	AG	20.75	-0.22	EnergyTransfer	ET	21.51	-1.01	GoDaddy	GDDY	92.88	-4.43
FirstSolar	FSR	213.25	8.80	FirstRenewable	FLT	77.51	-1.41	GoldFields	GFI	47.19	-0.21
FirstCash	FCFS	225.42	-0.20	Fiserv	FISV	50.86	-2.14	GoldmanSachs	GS	103.63	-2.08
FirstEnergy	FE	46.45	-0.32	FiveBelow	FIVE	254.07	1.87	Grab	GRAB	3.25	-0.17
Fiserv	FISV	50.86	-2.14	Flex	FLEX	114.31	4.80	Graco	GGG	77.03	-0.85
FiveBelow	FIVE	254.07	1.87	Flowserve	FLS	76.98	0.34	Grainger	GWW	1289.17	-35.32
Flex	FLEX	114.31	4.80	Flowerserve	FLS	76.98	0.34	GAP	PAC	205.38	-2.79
Flowerserve	FLS	76.98	0.34	FlutterEnt	FLT	100.70	0.59	GAPCrest	GCR	98.65	-0.30
FlutterEnt	FLT	100.70	0.59	FEMSA	FEM	119.63	-0.78	GuardianHealth	GH	160.98	-0.43
FordMotor	F	14.00	-0.62	Gartner	IT	172.59	-1.35	Guidewire	GW	149.71	-12.71

Borrowing Benchmarks

wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

September 8, 2026

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
July index			
level	June '26	July '25	

U.S. consumer price index	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
All items	333.918	-0.01	3.4
Core	337.133	0.07	2.5

International rates	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low

Prime rates	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
U.S.	6.75	6.75	7.50
Canada	4.45	4.45	4.95
Japan	2.375	2.375	1.875

Policy Rates	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
Eurozone	2.40	2.40	2.15
Switzerland	0.25	0.25	0.50
Britain	3.75	3.75	4.00
Australia	4.35	4.35	3.60

DTCC GCF Repo Index	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
Treasury	3.665	47.100	4.492
MBS	3.687	94.670	4.623

Weekly survey	Week Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.71	6.66	6.50
15-year fixed	6.04	5.98	5.60

Overnight repurchase	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
U.S.	3.65	3.65	4.45

U.S. government rates	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
Discount	3.75	3.75	4.50

Federal funds	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
Effective rate	3.6400	n.a.	4.3300
High	3.7000	n.a.	4.5500
Low	3.5500	n.a.	4.3200
Bid	3.6300	n.a.	4.3200
Offer	3.6400	n.a.	4.3300

Treasury bill auction	Week Latest	-52-Week-High	-52-Week-Low
4 weeks	3.700	3.650	4.175
13 weeks	3.800	3.770	3.940
26 weeks	3.890	3.885	3.945

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CLASS ACTION

IN THE COURT OF CHANCERY OF THE STATE OF DELAWARE

MICHIGAN ELECTRICAL EMPLOYEES' PENSION FUND and GLAZER CAPITAL, LLC, Plaintiffs,

v.

VISTA EQUITY PARTNERS MANAGEMENT, LLC, VEP GROUP, LLC, ONEX CORPORATION, LAURENCE GOLDBERG, MONTI S. SAROYA, HARDEEP GULATI, ZACH LEVITT, JUDY COTTE, BETTY HUNG, and GWEN REINKE, Defendants.

SUMMARY NOTICE OF PENDENCY AND PROPOSED SETTLEMENT OF STOCKHOLDER CLASS ACTION, SETTLEMENT HEARING, AND RIGHT TO APPEAR

TO: All former holders of PowerSchool Holdings, Inc. ("PowerSchool") common stock as of the October 1, 2024 closing of the transaction who received \$22.80 per share in cash in exchange for their shares of PowerSchool common stock (the "Class").

Certain persons and entities are excluded from the Class by definition, as set forth in the full Notice of Pendency and Proposed Settlement of Stockholder Class Action, Settlement Hearing, and Right to Appear (the "Notice"), available at [www.PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#). Any capitalized terms used in this Summary Notice that are not otherwise defined in this Summary Notice shall have the meanings given to them in the Stipulation and Agreement of Settlement, Compromise, and Release dated July 16, 2026 (the "Stipulation"), which is also available at [www.PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#).

PLEASE READ THIS SUMMARY NOTICE CAREFULLY. YOUR RIGHTS WILL BE AFFECTED BY A STOCKHOLDER CLASS ACTION PENDING IN THIS COURT.

YOU ARE HEREBY NOTIFIED, pursuant to an Order of the Court of Chancery of the State of Delaware (the "Court"), that the above-captioned stockholder class action (the "Action") has been certified as a class action on behalf of the Class defined below.

YOU ARE ALSO NOTIFIED that (i) plaintiffs Michigan Electrical Employees' Pension Fund and Glazer Capital, LLC (together, "Lead Plaintiffs"), on behalf of themselves and all other members of the Court-certified Class; (ii) defendants Vista Equity Partners Management, LLC, VEP Group, LLC, Onex Corporation, Laurence Goldberg, Monti S. Saroya, Hardeep Gulati, Zach Levitt, Judy Cotte, Betty Hung, and Gwen Reinke (together, "Defendants"); and (iii) PowerSchool Holdings, Inc. have reached a proposed settlement of the Action for \$26,500,000 (U.S. Dollars) in cash (the "Settlement"). The terms of the Settlement are stated in the Stipulation. If approved by the Court, the Settlement will resolve all claims in the Action.

Absent further order of the Court, a hearing (the "Settlement Hearing") will be held on **November 9, 2026, at 3:15 p.m.**, before The Honorable Lori W. Will, Vice Chancellor, either in person at the Court of Chancery of the State of Delaware, New Castle County, Leonard L. Williams Justice Center, 500 North King Street, Wilmington, DE 19801, or remotely by telephone or videoconference (in the discretion of the Court), to, among other things: (i) determine whether the proposed Settlement should be approved as fair, reasonable, and adequate to Lead Plaintiffs and the other members of the Class; (ii) determine whether the proposed Order and Final Judgment approving the Settlement, dismissing the Action with prejudice, and granting the Releases provided under the Stipulation should be entered; (iii) determine whether the proposed Plan of Allocation of the Net Settlement Fund is fair and reasonable, and should therefore be approved; (iv) determine whether and in what amount any award of attorneys' fees and payment of Litigation Expenses to Plaintiffs' Counsel ("Fee and Expense Award") should be paid out of the Settlement Fund; (v) hear and rule on any objections to the Settlement, the proposed Plan of Allocation, and/or Plaintiffs' Counsel's application for a Fee and Expense Award; and (vi) consider any other matters that may properly be brought before the Court in connection with the Settlement.

Any updates regarding the Settlement Hearing, including any changes to the date, time, or format of the hearing or updates regarding remote or in-person appearances at the hearing, will be posted to the Settlement website, [www.PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#).

If you are a member of the Class, your rights will be affected by the pending Action and the Settlement, and you may be entitled to share in the Net Settlement Fund. If you have not yet received the Notice, you may obtain a copy of the Notice by contacting the Settlement Administrator by mail at PowerSchool Stockholders Litigation, c/o A.B. Data, Ltd., P.O. Box 170500, Milwaukee, WI 53217; or by email at [info@PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#). A copy of the Notice can also be downloaded from the Settlement website, [www.PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#).

If the Settlement is approved by the Court and the Effective Date occurs, the Net Settlement Fund will be distributed on a *pro rata* basis to Eligible Class Members in accordance with the proposed Plan of Allocation stated in the Notice or such other plan of allocation as is approved by the Court. Pursuant to the proposed Plan of Allocation, each Eligible Class Member will be eligible to receive a *pro rata* share of the Net Settlement Fund equal to the product of (i) the number of Eligible Shares held by the Eligible Class Member and (ii) the "Per-Share Recovery" for the Settlement, which will be determined by dividing the total amount of the Net Settlement Fund by the total number of Eligible Shares held by all Eligible Class Members. As explained in further detail in the Notice, pursuant to the Plan of Allocation, payments from the Net Settlement Fund to Eligible Class Members will be made in the same manner in which Eligible Class Members received payment for their shares of PowerSchool common stock upon the Closing of the Acquisition. Eligible Class Members do *not* have to submit a claim form to receive a payment from the Settlement.

Any objections to the proposed Settlement, the proposed Plan of Allocation, or Plaintiffs' Counsel's application for a Fee and Expense Award must be filed with the Register in Chancery in the Court of Chancery of the State of Delaware and delivered to Lead Counsel and Defendants' Counsel such that they are *received no later than October 19, 2026*, in accordance with the instructions set forth in the Notice.

Please do not contact the Court or the Office of the Register in Chancery regarding this Summary Notice. All questions about this Summary Notice, the proposed Settlement, or your eligibility to participate in the Settlement should be directed to the Settlement Administrator or Lead Counsel.

Requests for the Notice should be made to the Settlement Administrator:

PowerSchool Stockholders Litigation
c/o A.B. Data, Ltd.
P.O. Box 170500
Milwaukee, WI 53217
Telephone: 877-777-9248
Email: [info@PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#)
Website: [www.PowerSchoolStockholdersLitigation.com](#)

Inquiries, other than requests for the Notice, should be made to Lead Counsel:

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Email: [DAAlbert@ktmc.com](#)

BY ORDER OF THE COURT OF CHANCERY OF THE STATE OF DELAWARE

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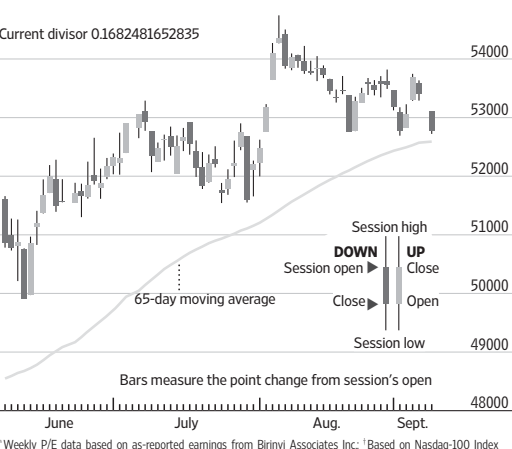
EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

52786.07 ▼628.18, or 1.18%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

Trailing P/E ratio 21.49 25.03
P/E estimate * 20.29 21.87
Dividend yield 1.50 1.61
All-time high 54349.12, 08/05/26



* Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Biringi Associates Inc.; * Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	High	Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	High	Low	% chg	YTD	3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	53110.45	52721.62	52786.07	-628.18	-1.18	54349.12	45166.64	15.5	9.8	15.1
Transportation Avg	21007.20	20797.26	20800.70	-211.03	-1.00	23933.14	15067.87	33.3	19.8	11.0
Utility Average	1099.37	1083.67	1092.54	9.76	0.90	1190.23	1048.33	1.6	2.3	7.8
Total Stock Market	76273.22	75836.17	75896.07	-450.00	-0.59	77313.23	62750.36	17.6	12.4	19.5
Barron's 400	1643.94	1630.68	1631.30	-16.44	-1.00	1685.46	1318.70	18.4	15.5	18.2

Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	26542.14	26341.17	26421.41	-85.58	-0.32	27093.90	20794.64	20.8	13.7	24.3
Nasdaq-100	29655.73	29400.70	29507.70	-36.46	-0.12	30660.60	22953.38	23.8	16.9	24.5

S&P										
500 Index	7717.81	7666.99	7673.52	-45.08	-0.58	7798.99	6343.72	17.8	12.1	19.8
MidCap 400	3787.66	3757.78	3758.89	-26.10	-0.69	3926.98	3109.89	15.1	13.7	13.4
SmallCap 600	1764.28	1749.42	1750.09	-15.00	-0.85	1828.54	1364.94	22.0	19.2	13.9

Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2975.48	2958.64	2960.20	-15.44	-0.52	3068.42	2305.11	24.3	19.3	16.9
NYSE Composite	24639.25	24469.95	24473.06	-166.19	-0.67	24821.68	20912.89	15.5	11.2	15.5
Value Line	682.28	674.96	675.06	-7.220	-1.06	702.60	590.50	7.1	7.4	6.7
NYSE Arca Biotech	9430.68	9167.51	9256.56	-174.12	-1.85	9539.76	6043.49	50.0	29.4	21.2
NYSE Arca Pharma	1266.85	1225.71	1226.64	-40.20	-3.17	1315.38	925.18	28.3	8.9	10.2
KBW Bank	189.36	187.32	187.37	-2.21	-1.16	193.91	143.23	25.1	14.1	32.6
PHLX® Gold/Silver	414.01	407.04	407.28	-1.64	-0.40	470.37	262.81	55.0	19.0	53.3
PHLX® Oil Service	107.45	105.11	105.13	-1.05	-0.99	109.24	60.27	64.7	43.4	2.9
PHLX® Semiconductor	12023.86	11843.26	11887.87	152.61	1.30	14634.72	5819.82	104.3	67.8	49.4
Cboe Volatility	15.94	15.22	15.72	1.19	8.19	31.05	13.47	4.5	5.2	4.3

⁂ Nasdaq PHLX Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

S&P 500 Index

7673.52 ▼45.08, or 0.58%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

Trailing P/E ratio * 23.61 24.83
P/E estimate * 21.22 24.15
Dividend yield * 1.05 1.21
All-time high 7798.99, 08/13/26



* Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Biringi Associates Inc.; * Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of \$2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
AtaiBeckley	ATAI	25,383.9	7.30	0.02	0.27	7.34	7.28
SS SPDR Ptf S&P 500	SPYM	20,531.2	90.21	0.04	0.04	90.27	90.09
Lloyds Banking Group ADR	LYG	12,633.2	6.00	...	unch.	6.12	6.00
Transocean	RIG	11,072.7	5.79	0.03	0.52	5.87	5.76
Nu Holdings CIA	NU	10,550.8	15.37	0.04	0.29	15.40	15.32
NVIDIA	NVDA	10,110.0	225.64	-0.09	-0.04	238.22	213.00
State Street SPDR S&P 500	SPY	10,106.3	765.82	-0.14	-0.02	766.17	724.23
Coca-Cola	KO	7,259.5	88.40	0.04	0.05	88.54	83.89

Percentage gainers...

InnovAge Holding	INN	78.7	11.67	1.15	10.93	12.36	10.43
Chime Financial	CHYM	326.0	35.56	3.25	10.06	37.49	32.31
Pyxix Oncology	PYXS	316.6	4.20	0.31	7.97	4.40	3.89
Mission Produce	AVO	191.0	13.63	0.76	5.91	15.00	12.78
Definium Therapeutics	DFTX	88.5	40.00	1.77	4.63	41.54	38.21

...And losers

ServiceTitan CIA	TTAN	1,507.6	64.48	-17.10	-20.96	82.00	64.15
Green Circle Decarbonize	GCDT	392,259	20296.1	-3.91	-12.90	32.23	26.20
Brace	BRZE	855.6	26.40	-3.91	-12.90	32.23	26.20
Cassey's General Stores	CASY	138.6	660.50	-72.99	-9.95	742.00	656.00
Cinemark Holdings	CNK	211.1	34.15	-2.02	-5.58	36.30	34.15
Dyne Therapeutics	DYN	154.6	19.74	-0.57	-2.81	20.68	19.32

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume¹	1,211,262,520	18,270,953
Adv. volume²	431,779,416	10,439,563
Decl. volume²	767,504,927	7,736,457
Issues traded	2,831	301
Advances	965	141
Declines	1,778	151
Unchanged	88	9
New highs	52	2
New lows	99	11
Closing Arms¹	0.85	0.27
Block trades³	4,078	169

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume¹	7,714,563,204	301,094,227
Adv. volume²	4,270,675,067	107,214,992
Decl. volume²	3,366,746,040	187,040,638
Issues traded	5,089	2,700
Advances	1,842	771
Declines	3,090	1,874
Unchanged	157	55
New highs	92	84
New lows	193	72
Closing Arms¹	0.47	0.77
Block trades³	41,937	1,322

¹ Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only. ² (TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Close	Net chg	% chg	High	Low	% chg
CEA Industries	BNC	5.25	1.76	50.43	21.00	1.84	...
Wing Yip Food ADR	WYHG	5.88	1.82	44.83	26.17	1.56	...
21Shrs Polkadot Stkg	TDOT	14.90	4.38	41.65	19.53	8.89	...
System1	SST	5.00	1.17	30.55	9.30	1.35	...
Swvl Holdings	SWVL	6.42	1.49	30.22	6.87	1.30	...
17 Educ & Tech ADR	YQ	3.79	0.87	29.79	6.45	1.68	...
Turn Therapeutics	TTRX	12.66	2.86	29.18	26.50	2.57	...
SVRN	SVRN	11.30	2.23	24.59	47.56	3.12	...
Healthy Choice Wellness	HCWC	8.69	1.67	23.79	34.30	5.96	...
Leverage 2X Lg CRWV Dly	CRWG	24.66	4.65	23.24	165.95	10.66	...
Orion Energy Systems	OESX	30.52	5.52	22.08	30.75	7.08	...
VIDA Global	VIDA	2.44	0.44	22.00	6.21	1.80	...
New Era Energy & Digital	NUAI	6.60	1.19	22.00	9.45	0.32	...
YD Bio	YDES	4.25	0.71	20.06	25.00	1.70	...
Katapult Holdings	KPLT	9.47	1.57	19.87	24.34	5.30	...

Volume Movers Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Greenpro Capital	GRNQ	727	4780	18.80	0.53	31.80	5.51
Columbia LC Growth	REGS	260	2272	11.50	-0.37	11.83	9.33
Leverage 2X Lg BIDU Dly	BIDG	1,273	2127	6.91	-14.03	27.47	6.59
Bluemente Divers Incrm	BLUI	247	2037	25.63	0.04	26.06	25.21
Garden Stage	GSIW	327	1963	14.25	-13.64	51.28	8.00
Drugs Made In America	DMAA	520	1907	10.79	0.28	10.79	10.23
Nuveen Intl Agg Bond ETF	NXUS	2,541	1899	24.49	-0.04	25.52	24.35
Meshflow Acquisition	MESH	1,353	1885	10.11	0.25	10.13	9.87
Iris Acquisition II	IRAB	200	1740	10.00	-0.10	10.08	9.81
Curanex Pharmaceuticals	CURX	187	1717	5.04	-0.20	183.59	3.58

* Common stocks priced at \$2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares. † Has traded fewer than 65 days

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Net chg	Latest % chg	YTD % chg
World	MSCI ACWI	1151.47	-6.26	-0.54	13.5
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	488.72	-2.41	-0.49	16.1
	MSCI World	4966.17	-28.83	-0.58	12.1
	MSCI Emerging Markets	1752.11	-4.74	-0.27	24.8
Americas	MSCI AC Americas	2909.34	-16.506	-0.56	12.2
Canada	S&P/TSX Comp	36123.05	-390.75	-1.07	13.9
Brazil	Bovespa	187366.84	2219.69	1.20	18.1
Chile	S&P IPSA	5733.10	-18.83	-0.33	5.7
Mexico	S&P/BMV IPC	65065.56	338.02	0.52	1.2
EMEA	STOXX Europe 600	649.60	-0.30	-0.05	9.7
Eurozone	Euro STOXX	676.06	1.02	0.15	10.4
Belgium	Bel-20	5796.02	-4.90	-0.08	14.1
Denmark	OMX Copenhagen 20	1624.13	-11.80	-0.72	1.0
France	CAC 40	8317.98	11.83	0.14	2.1
Germany	DAX	26007.63	1.10	0.004	6.2
Israel	Tel Aviv	4276.22	-34.79	-0.81	17.8
Italy	FTSE MIB	52177.47	-52.10	-0.10	16.1
Netherlands	AEX	1116.05	0.63	0.06	17.3
Norway	Oslo Bors All-Share	2508.48	11.07	0.44	29.2
South Africa	FTSE/JSE All-Share	117461.57	472.61	0.40	1.4
Spain	IBEX 35	19997.10	-24.70	-0.12	15.5
Sweden	OMX Stockholm	1145.05	3.79	0.33	9.5
Switzerland	Swiss Market	14057.61	-221.77	-1.55	6.0
Turkey	BIST 100	14405.25	253.66	1.79	27.9
U.K.	FTSE 100	10811.66	-10.47	-0.10	8.9
U.K.	FTSE 250	24348.85	-157.83	-0.64	8.4
Asia-Pacific	MSCI AC Asia Pacific	281.94	-2.49	-0.88	23.8
Australia	S&P/ASX 200	8920.80	-90.09	-1.00	2.4
China	Shanghai Composite	3940.55	7.85	0.20	-0.7
Hong Kong	Hang Seng	25317.18	-95.94	-0.38	-1.2
India	BSE Sensex	75577.58	-555.23	-0.73	-11.3
Japan	NIKKEI 225	65269.33	-1130.51	-1.70	29.7
Singapore	Straits Times	5767.45	-24.83	-0.43	24.1
South Korea	KOSPI	6954.52	-40.87	-0.58	65.0
Taiwan	TAIEX	47105.78	-220.49	-0.47	62.6
Thailand	SET	1621.89	3.07	0.19	28.8

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest session			52-Week		
		Close	Net chg	% chg	High	Low	% chg
Lianhe Sowell Intl	LHSW	1.32	-3.18	-70.67	47.52	0.90	...
Focus Universal	FCUV	5.91	-11.09	-65.24	210.00	1.79	...
bioAffinity Technologies	BIAF	8.93	-6.34	-41.52	202.50	4.56	...
Lexaria Bioscience	LEXX	9.37	-4.78	-33.78	23.25	4.21	...
GRI Bio	GRI	2.00	-0.88	-30.56	80.36	1.36	...
CBL International	BANL	6.47	-2.54	-28.19	16.40	3.46	...
Turbogen	TRBG	5.31	-2.04	-27.72	33.99	5.20	...
Modular Medical	MODD	2.82	-0.86	-23.37	30.00	1.72	...
Beneficient	BENF	1.80	-0.54	-22.96	12.48	1.78	...
RTB Digital	RTB	8.89	-2.55	-22.29	20.75	3.25	...
SANGRIX	SGRX	1.64	-0.46	-21.90	166.71	1.63	...
Cyclerion Therapeutics	CYCN	3.36	-0.89	-20.94	8.48	1.01	...
Atrium Therapeutics	RNA	11.35	-2.84	-20.01	16.77	10.75	...
Shengfeng Development	SWFL	11.43	-2.82	-19.80	19.20	8.47	...
NeOnc Technologies Hldgs	NTHI	4.07	-0.96	-19.09	12.99	3.01	...

Continued From Page B6				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %				52-Wk %												
Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg									
EntergyBtPdg	ENO	20.68	0.3	FutureGenTech	FTFT	122.19	6	HouseofDoge	HODO	0.19	-8.3	KALA BIO	KALA	0.49	6.0	McDonalds	MCD	254.28	...	Novonix	NVX	2.66	-8.3	PublicStorageP	PSA	18.85	-1.0	SamsEnergyWt	SNOW	0.20	-13.0	StarlightersSpace	SIET	2.62	-6.1	22ndCentury	XXII	2.25	-6.5					
EnterByPdg	ENB	22.33	-0.4	GCGlobalWt	GLCW	122.19	6	HubCityEnergy	HUBC	0.60	-1.8	KorumaSys	KRMD	3.12	-2.5	MetLifePfd	METL	20.65	0.6	Ohmyhome	ONH	25.10	-2.6	PublicStorageP	PSA	17.32	-0.6	SatogateWt	SATG	25.00	...	StarlightersSpace	SIET	20.17	-0.1	UpdatsSoftware	UPLD	3.40	-5.4					
EntFinVspPdg	EFSP	17.82	-1.2	GEMXRobotics	GEMX	0.63	-14.5	Inm Cannabis	IMCX	1.85	-1.1	KaryopharmWt	KPTI	1.70	-3.9	MicroCloudWt	MCLW	0.03	-18.4	Onholding	ONH	27.10	-2.6	PublicStorageP	PSA	14.36	-0.2	ScageFuture	SCAG	0.22	-11.9	StitchFix	SFIX	2.92	-2.6	Vici Prop	VICI	25.23	-0.6					
EquigraPdg	EQHA	18.20	0.3	GTCP	4.91	-13.0	GTCP	4.91	-13.0	InfectionPrt	INFT	0.04	-7.1	Kestrel	KXG	6.72	-7.9	MagicalPrt	MFGC	1.92	-4.7	Onfolio	ONF	1.05	-2.7	Pulsenmore	PLSM	0.31	-0.4	SenesTech	SNES	0.84	-1.9	StranWt	SNW	0.00	-3.5	ValironBio	VBCI	24.23	-0.7			
Eschalgo	ESGO	1.03	-3.7	GalaStaAcqnlWt	LATAW	0.20	-0.2	Inogen	INGN	5.20	-3.5	Kestrel	KXG	6.72	-7.9	MargalPrt	MGP	24.81	0.1	OpenderWZ	OPWZ	0.10	-2.1	Q&T Techs	QCT	0.21	-0.3	SenesTech	SNES	0.84	-1.9	StranWt	SNW	0.00	-3.5	ValironBio	VBCI	24.23	-0.7					
Eshaltgo	ESHO	1.03	-3.7	GalaStaAcqnlWt	LATAW	0.20	-0.2	IntelligentPrt	INTG	2.41	-13.6	Kestrel	KXG	6.72	-7.9	NardiA	NARD	1.98	-4.8	OpenderWZ	OPWZ	0.10	-2.1	RainEnTech	RAIN	0.75	-0.4	Shutterstock	STSK	0.56	-1.9	SunCarTechA	SCTA	0.43	-14.5	VideotSats	SEAT	5.06	-14.1					
EverCommerce	EVCM	6.94	-9.3	GTCP	4.91	-13.0	Intellinetcs	INIL	5.00	0.5	Libangint	LBGI	2.06	-9.2	NerdyA	NRDY	8.95	-4.1	OpenderWZ	OPWZ	0.10	-2.1	RapidRmn	RPD	1.22	-6.9	SiliconTenet	SLTN	0.34	-2.0	SunPowerWt	SPWR	1.05	-0.9	Webio	WBO	6.66	-0.3						
FangdNetwork	FND	0.52	-8.6	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	Intrac	INTR	0.61	0.5	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FedAgriMtpPdg	FAPG	AGNG	17.24	-0.4	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4
FifthTrndPrt	FTPT	17.70	-0.7	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FlanaThorPdg	FLNA	0.75	-2.8	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FirstHorizonPdg	FHNE	23.10	0.5	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FlowersFoods	FLO	6.10	0.8	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FormSciener	FMSI	0.90	-6.0	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
Founder	FGL	7.00	-18.6	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	
FreightTech	FRGT	0.96	-4.7	GvexLabsWt	GVOX	0.46	-3.1	IronAcq	IACQ	9.98	-0.3	LaneHoswell	LHSG	0.90	-7.0	NewtonPhamWt	NPHW	12.62	-4.5	PG&G P61Pdg	PGP	0.50	-0.5	RebornCoffee	REBN	0.65	-32.9	SilverBoxWt	SBOW	0.08	-2.4	SunScoutA	SNSC	1.02	-0.6	Well FargoPdg	WFGP	21.35	...	WorlWt	WW	17.56	-0.4	

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds, latest session.										ETF				ETF				ETF				ETF				ETF								
Tuesday, September 8, 2026				ETF				ETF				ETF				ETF				ETF				ETF										
Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg	YTD (%)			
AvantisUSValue	AVUV	125.32	-0.95	22.9	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
CapGrpDivV	CDV	49.91	-0.34	14.4	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	45.38	-0.74	14.6	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
FitTotalBd	FBND	44.67	-0.09	-3.0	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsVas100	QQQM	295.76	-1.00	-16.9	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsVas200	QQQ	718.36	-0.08	-16.9	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsVas500EW	RSP	216.73	-1.04	13.1	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsBitcon	IBIT	44.39	-1.86	-10.3	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsBrdUSDHYCPbd	USHY	36.60	-0.03	-2.1	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsCoreDivGrwth	DGRO	78.37	-0.96	12.9	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	100.49	-0.58	12.3	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsCoreMSCIEM	IEEM	83.70	0.06	26.5	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsMSCIIndv	IEV	92.99	-0.55	12.6	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8
InsMSCITotInt	IXUS	98.32	-0.40	16.2	iSharesCoreS&P500	IVV	769.20	-0.61	12.3	iSharesUS	IUSX	110.95	-0.79	15.2	JPMorganE&F	JPMF	56.87	-0.61	-0.6	SSSPDRSP500	SPY	121.11	-0.48	13.5	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8	VanguardStarLarC	VGLT	35.08	-0.02	13.8

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

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HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Does Your Portfolio Need Inflation Tax Break?

Inflation can be taxing—literally. Say you invest \$10,000 in a stock that pays no dividend. It returns 10% a year, and you sell it after 20 years. You’ll have made a capital gain of \$57,275.

If inflation averaged 3% during that span, though, then half of your profit can be traced to that increase in prices (the difference between compounding at 7% and 10%.) Why, the argument goes, should people then be expected to pay taxes on that “phantom gain” from which they derived no real boost to their wealth?

There have been occasional calls from Congress, most recently this year, to redefine capital gains so as to index them to prices. But what sounds reasonable and fair would

create wild distortions.

For example, how much more yield would people then demand for owning bonds when appreciating assets like stocks are shielded? And what would governments and companies then have to pay to borrow? Long-term interest rates are already near multidecade highs worldwide.

Contributing to a tax-deferred account such as a 401(k), beyond snagging a company match, might no longer make sense either. Withdrawals are taxed like ordinary income, inflation included. Older Americans who have spent decades building nest eggs in those accounts would feel like chumps.

So would lower-income people who have little in the way of re-

tirement assets to begin with. Capital gains already get favorable tax treatment compared with wage income. The Tax Foundation estimated that the top fifth of taxpayers would receive a boost to after-tax income more than 10 times as great as the lowest fifth if gains were indexed to prices.

It’s unlikely to happen with so much red ink already flowing in Washington. The Yale Budget Lab calculated that indexing capital gains would cost Uncle Sam \$1 trillion over a decade if applied retroactively.

Even so, the conversation over inflation’s drag is worth having. The bull market of the past several years may have left savers feeling rich, but it got a boost from gains

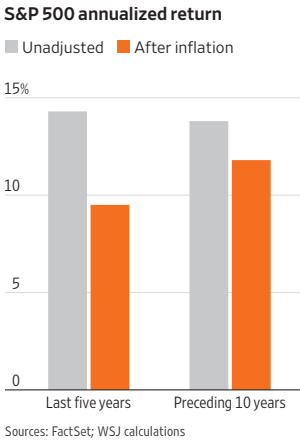
that don’t translate into nearly as much bread, gasoline or college tuition.

The S&P 500’s annualized return over the past five calendar years falls from 14.3% to 9.5% when adjusted for buying power. Inflation ran above the Federal Reserve’s target for nearly that entire span.

The preceding 10 years looks less impressive at first glance with a headline annualized gain of just 13.8%. But investors kept much more of it with an inflation-adjusted return of 11.8%.

Even before accounting for capital gains, “the cruelest tax” sneakily picks thrifty people’s pockets with no act of Congress required.

—*Spencer Jakab*



Although AI is disrupting corporate software, Salesforce and other incumbents are mounting a defense.

The Death of Software Is Exaggerated

Continued from page B1

IT systems provides another bulwark against AI disruption. Most large companies have a tangle of software from different providers that they have knit together over time. To replace existing software with their own AI-generated code, companies must handle integrating it themselves, which is no easy engineering task.

“Most buyers of technology are not engineering organizations—they are operators,” said Arun Chandrasekaran, a Gartner analyst who focuses on AI. “And there is a world of difference between building something versus operating something.”

Sheer inertia also is giving software giants more time to adapt to AI’s march. OpenAI Chief Executive Sam Altman said on a recent podcast that disruption of the software industry hadn’t happened as quickly as he thought it would. A big part of the reason was that habits don’t easily change, he said.

Even as their shares got pum-

meled, software companies have been showing their financial strength.

Salesforce last month reported better-than-projected sales and profits and raised its outlook, citing an AI tailwind. It also debuted an expanded partnership with Anthropic to integrate its Claude AI model with Salesforce’s software. Initially, a plug-in will allow Salesforce users to apply Claude’s reasoning capabilities to their corporate data and automate certain sales functions, the companies said. For Anthropic, the deal brings Claude “into the systems where much of the world’s commercial activity happens,” Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei said in a statement.

That provides a preview of what could become a model for collaboration with AI heavyweights where Salesforce remains relevant. Its shares rose more than 22% the day following its earnings.

Other big software companies also have reported strong results this summer. **ServiceNow**, which helps companies handle IT support and automates business tasks, reported better-than-expected sales growth in July. **Snowflake**, a software and data-storage company, cited AI in lifting its full-year sales forecast last week. **Human-resources** software player **Workday** also reported strong results last month as adoption of its AI agents grew.

Of course, corporate software’s re-

silience doesn’t mean it can’t be disrupted. One fear is that Anthropic and OpenAI may see corporate software as lucrative new ground for themselves—especially as they court investors in their coming IPOs with grand growth visions.

Gil Luria, an analyst at D.A. Davidson, said in a recent note that corporate software might be too small for Anthropic to dip into given that it already generates more revenue than Salesforce. Working with Salesforce may help it keep customers from embracing a bigger threat—cheaper, open-weight models that are gaining traction in businesses.

For software’s incumbents, the biggest challenge ahead may be new software-as-a-service companies that are built from the ground up with AI in mind. That, Chandrasekaran suggested, could lead software incumbents to accede to client demands for shorter contract terms and pricing that is tied more directly to business goals.

Against that backdrop, Salesforce’s stock looks like an especially good bargain. Even after its post-earnings rise, its shares are trading at only around 15 times forward earnings—well below its 10-year average of 43 times, and the average of 24 times for an S&P index of software companies.

AI is making the corporate-software business more difficult. That is entirely different than killing it off.

How Shopify’s Push Into AI Is Working Out

Want to know whether going all in on AI works for a large business? Watch **Shopify**.

Most established companies have come at AI with a dip-your-toes-in-the-water approach. They fear being disrupted by AI-infused competitors. But they are also wary of changing IT systems and business philosophies that have worked for decades.

Shopify and its chief, Tobias Lütke, have instead plunged in.

Shopify was quick to develop AI tools for customers, announcing an AI assistant called Sidekick in 2023. But the company also has looked inward at its use of AI. Early last year, Lütke wrote a memo to employees that explicitly made using AI a “baseline expectation” at the company, which makes software that helps retailers set up websites, process transactions and analyze their businesses.

That meant a few things. Employees’ performance evaluations would include questions about their use of AI. The prototyping phases of new projects would be dominated by AI-aided exploration. And before hiring new employees, teams would have to demonstrate that they couldn’t get the job done with AI instead.

Those moves may sound unremarkable now, but they were controversial at the time. The prevailing wisdom had been that companies should provide employees with AI tools to experiment with. Integrating AI deeply into daily work largely hadn’t been a strict requirement.

So what have the results been? Shopify’s stock hasn’t done well lately—it is down more than 15% this year, including a slide of more

than 7% Tuesday amid a broader software selloff. And it is pricey, trading at around 57 times forward earnings.

From a business perspective, though, there have been gains. When AI began to take off in 2023, Shopify brought in about \$7 billion of revenue. Analysts project revenue will reach more than \$15 billion this year as the company grows its footprint in the U.S. and internationally. Shopify also has reduced its workforce over that time, from around 11,600 at the end of 2022 to 7,600 at the end of last year.

These days, Lütke is looking further into the future, preparing for a shift toward so-called agentic commerce where AI agents instead of humans search for and recommend products.

Shopify is positioning itself at the center of that shift by offering a catalog of products offered by its merchants that OpenAI, Anthropic and other AI developers can easily tap in to for recommendations.

While it is still early days, Shopify President Harley Finkelstein said on an analyst call last month that AI-driven traffic and orders to Shopify stores had tripled year over year in the second quarter.

Lütke said in a post on X in April that his memo a year earlier on embracing AI was evident in the company’s products and how fast they were moving. “Everyone has agents as exoskeletons for their own creativity now and knows how to use them,” he said.

Whether Lütke’s all-in approach continues to work looks like a good barometer of AI’s business-transforming potential.

—*Asa Fitch*

Shopify is positioning itself for a shift toward agentic commerce.

MONEY & INVESTING

Stock Spotlight

Amgen, Novartis, Eli Lilly
Shares of biotechnology company Amgen, a major contributor to the Dow Jones Industrial Average, shed 10%. The move came after Swiss drugmaker Novartis said Friday that an experimental medicine failed to reduce cardiovascular risk in a late-stage clinical trial. Amgen and Eli Lilly are working on rival treatments. Lilly stock fell 2.2%; Novartis, which reported another trial setback Tuesday, tumbled 11% in Switzerland, and its American depositary receipts fell nearly 14%.

Intel
The chip maker’s stock rose 9%, aided by an analyst upgrade and reports that the company is planning to raise prices on CPUs.

Qualcomm, Amazon.com
Semiconductor company Qualcomm’s stock jumped 3.2% after it announced a

new collaboration with Amazon. The e-commerce giant’s shares edged down 0.6%.

D-Wave Quantum, Rigetti Computing, Quantinuum
The U.S. government is taking minority stakes in the quantum-computing companies with a combined \$300 million CHIPS Act deal. D-Wave Quantum shares climbed 6.6%, Rigetti rose 4% and Quantinuum gained 1.7%.

Bloom Energy, Nike
The fuel-cell maker is among the companies that will join the S&P 500 later this month, S&P Dow Jones Indices said Friday; Bloom’s shares rose 9.6% Tuesday. Nike will be deleted from the S&P 100. It slipped 0.8%.

Coinbase Global, Robinhood Markets, Strategy
Shares of companies tied to cryptocurrencies declined as bitcoin slipped 1.2% to trade below \$78,500. Coinbase fell 3.1%, Robinhood 3.9% and Strategy 4.4%.

WEDNESDAY’S EVENTS:
Economic data: ADP weekly employment report

U.S. Treasury auction: 10-year note

EARNINGS EXPECTED:
Jersey Mike’s Subs
American Eagle Outfitters
Chewy
AeroVironment
Cooper Cos.

On This Day In Market History

On this day in 1974, after President Gerald R. Ford pardoned Richard Nixon for the Watergate scandal, the Dow Jones Industrial Average plunged 2.2% on fears that the pardon wouldn’t bring closure or allow Ford to handle economic problems. The Dow, however, soared by 25% over the next year.

Copper Remains On Record Run

Copper’s record-setting run is showing no signs of dulling. Prices for the metal climbed to records in London and New York on Tuesday, fueled by a combination of supply-and-demand challenges and tariff fears.

Copper futures in New York climbed 2.15% to \$6.7390 a pound, bringing their year-to-date gains to nearly 20%.

Futures on the London Metal Exchange touched an intraday high of \$14,635. The metal is up nearly 17% this year.

This year’s copper rally has been fueled in part by expectations of voracious demand for the metal for years to come amid expanding needs for data-center construction, power-grid upgrades, electric vehicles, and renewable-energy installations.

However, the increasing demand has collided with supply challenges: Production has declined in some of the world’s biggest mining coun-

Copper futures price



tries.

Adding extra fuel to the price surge are fears that President Trump could place new import taxes on refined copper. While the refined metal was carved out of copper tariffs announced last summer, the Commerce Department previously proposed a 15% tariff on refined copper imports effective January 2027, escalating to 30% in 2028.

—*Caitlin McCabe*

Goldman Warns Of \$120 Oil

Brent crude could surge above \$120 a barrel because of intensified attacks on shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and Red Sea, Goldman Sachs warned in a new oil price forecast.

“Markets are increasingly pricing a prolonged Mideast conflict,” the bank’s analysts said in a research note Monday evening.

Goldman said its baseline assumption is now that Mideast shipping disruptions would continue into next year. It predicted that \$120 oil could become the norm in 2027 under its most pessimistic scenario for Middle East crude production.

In its baseline scenario, Goldman raised its December 2026 forecast for Brent to \$85 a barrel. The bank noted that growing supplies from the U.S. and other producers outside the Mideast could help offset the impact of disruptions in the region.

—*Alexander Osipovich*

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